TechNova HR & Payroll — User Guide

This guide covers every workflow in the TechNova HR & Payroll prototype. Each section follows the same structure: purpose, who can use it, navigation, steps, the expected result, a screenshot of the real application and a link to the matching walkthrough video.

> **About this prototype.** It is a frontend-only demo. All records are sample data for *TechNova Solutions (Pvt) Ltd.*, stored in your browser. Payroll uses illustrative LKR values, EPF/ETF rates and APIT brackets — they are examples, not current legal rates. The AI assistant is a rule-based simulation, not a live AI model. Screenshots were captured with the demo clock set to **Friday, 30 October 2026, 10:30 (Asia/Colombo)**, so dates in your copy will differ.

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1. Login and demo role selection

Signing in with a demo account

Purpose: Open the workspace as one of five demo personas so you can explore what each role sees.

Who can use it: Everyone.

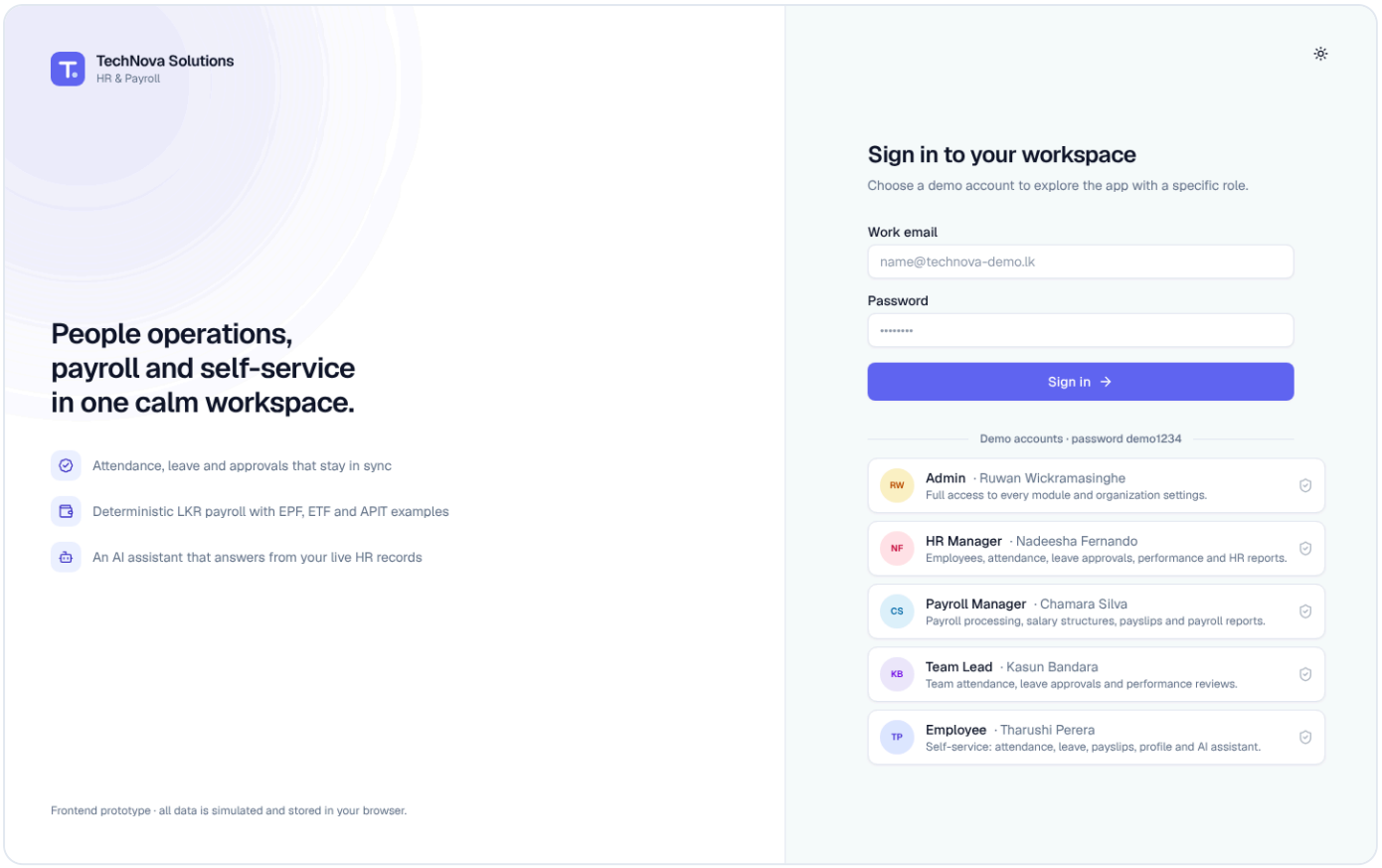
Navigation: `http://localhost:3000` → Login

Steps:

1. Open the application. You are taken to **Sign in to your workspace**.
2. Under **Demo accounts**, click a role — Admin, HR Manager, Payroll Manager, Team Lead or Employee. The email and password fields are filled in.
3. Click **Sign in**.
4. A "Welcome back" notification appears and you land on that role's dashboard.

Expected Result: You are signed in and the sidebar shows only the modules your role can open.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 01 — Application overview

Notes:

- Every demo account uses the password `demo1234`. Wrong credentials show an error message; empty fields show inline validation.
- Opening a protected page while signed out redirects to the login page and returns you there after signing in.

Switching roles and signing out

Purpose: Compare roles quickly without retyping credentials.

Who can use it: Everyone.

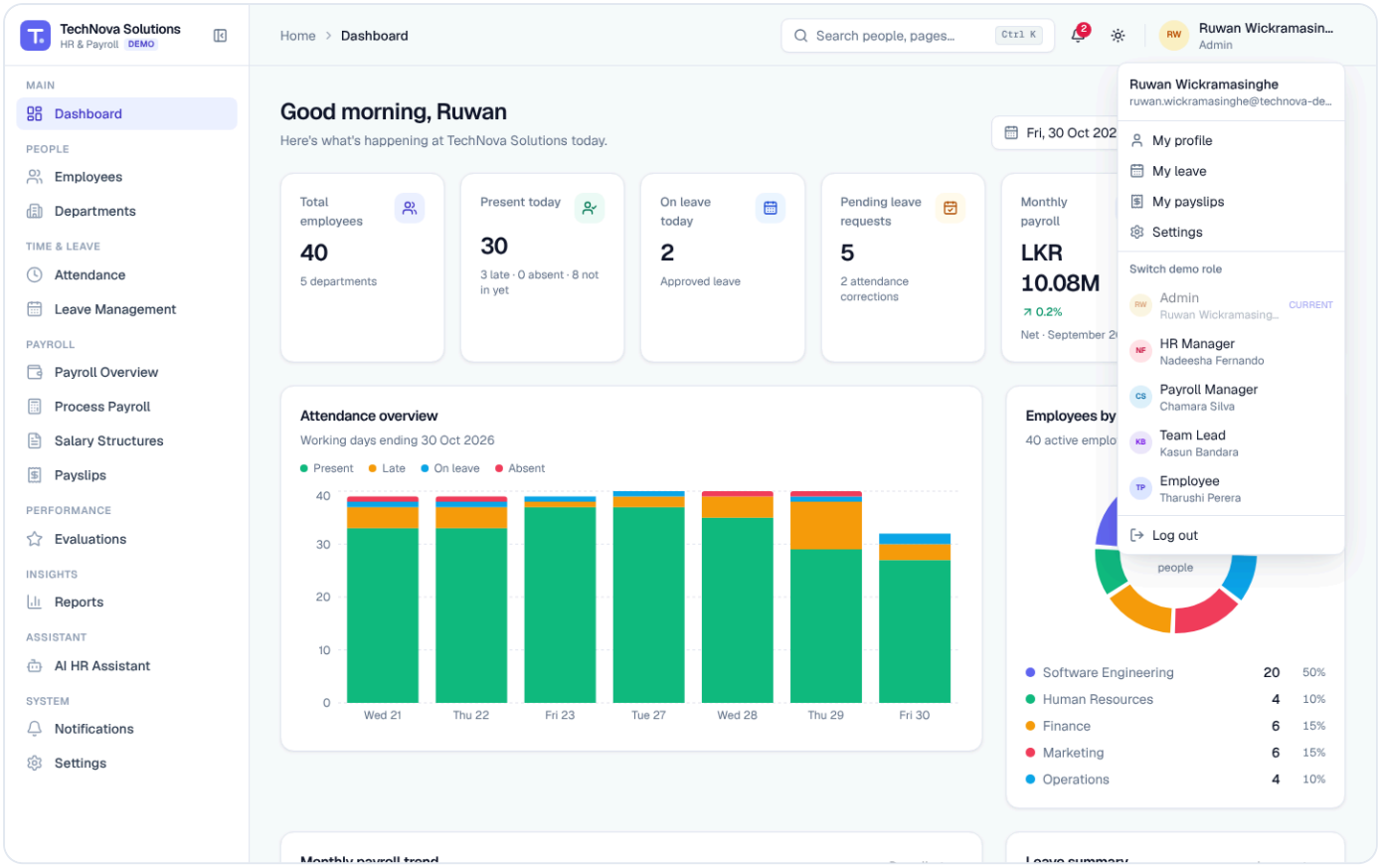
Navigation: Profile menu (top-right) → Switch demo role

Steps:

1. Click your name and avatar in the top-right corner.
2. Under **Switch demo role**, click the role you want (your current role is marked *Current*).
3. To sign out, open the same menu and click **Log out**.

Expected Result: You are redirected to the new role's dashboard and a confirmation toast appears. Logging out returns you to the login page.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 04 — Leave management (switches between Employee and Team Lead)

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2. Navigation

Sidebar, breadcrumbs and search

Purpose: Move around the application quickly.

Who can use it: Everyone (items depend on role).

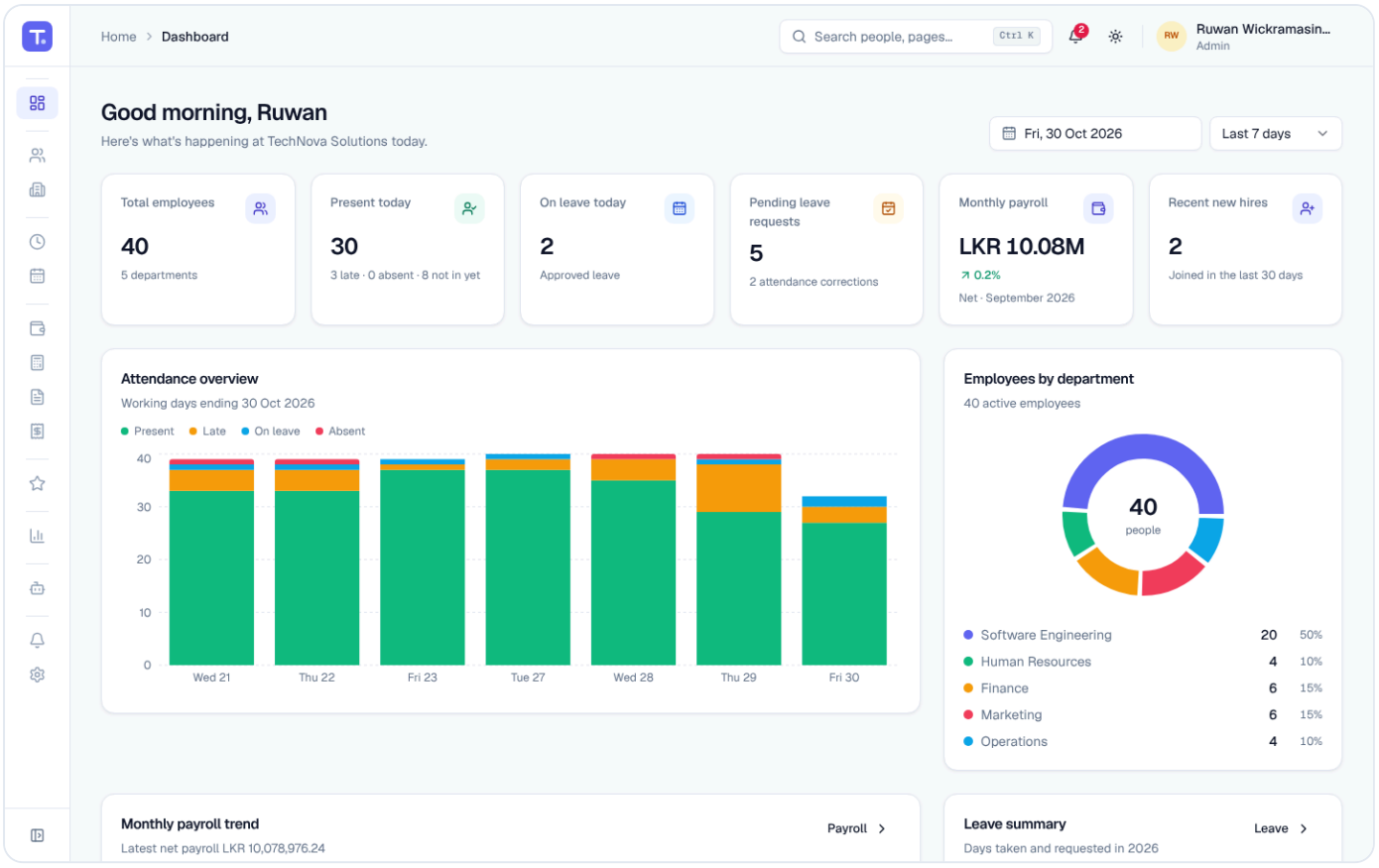
Navigation: Left sidebar, header

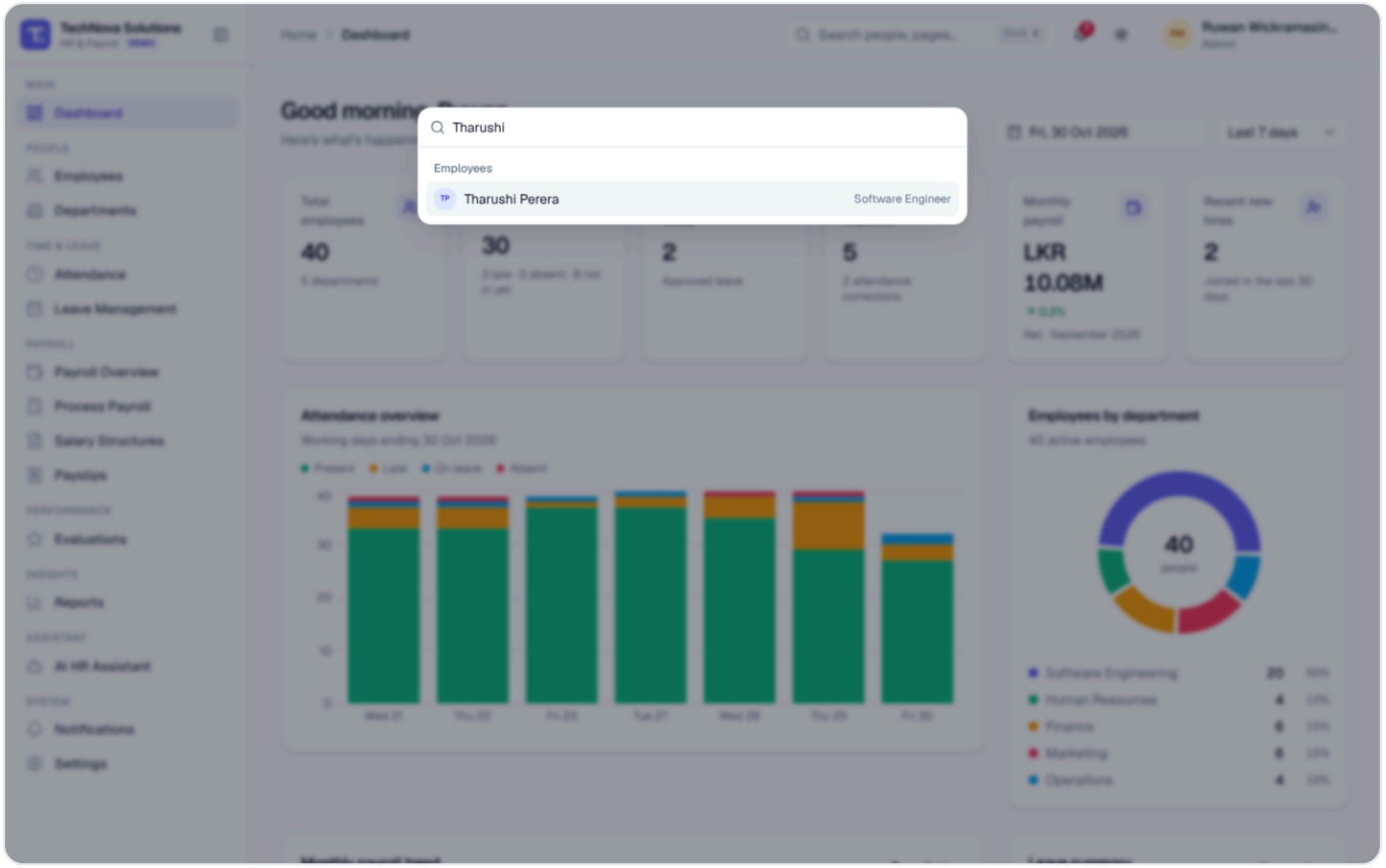
Steps:

1. Use the **sidebar** sections (Main, People, Time & Leave, Payroll, Performance, Insights, Assistant, System). The current page is highlighted.
2. Click the **collapse** button next to the company name to shrink the sidebar to icons; hover an icon to see its label. Click **Expand sidebar** at the bottom to restore it.
3. Use the **breadcrumbs** in the header to go back up a level.
4. Click **Search people, pages...** or press **Ctrl K** (⌘K on macOS) to open the command palette. Type a page name, an action ("apply leave") or an employee's name and press Enter.
5. Inside modules, use the **tab row** under the page title (for example Overview · Calendar · Corrections · My Attendance) to switch between related pages.

Expected Result: The selected page opens and the sidebar highlight follows the current route.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: 01 — Application overview

Notes: Employees get a simplified sidebar: My Dashboard, My Profile, My Attendance, My Leave, My Payslips, My Performance, AI Assistant, Notifications and Settings. Opening a page your role can't use shows an "access" message instead of the page.

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3. Dashboard

Organisation dashboard

Purpose: See today's headcount, attendance, leave, approvals and payroll at a glance.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager (HR figures), Payroll Manager (payroll figures).

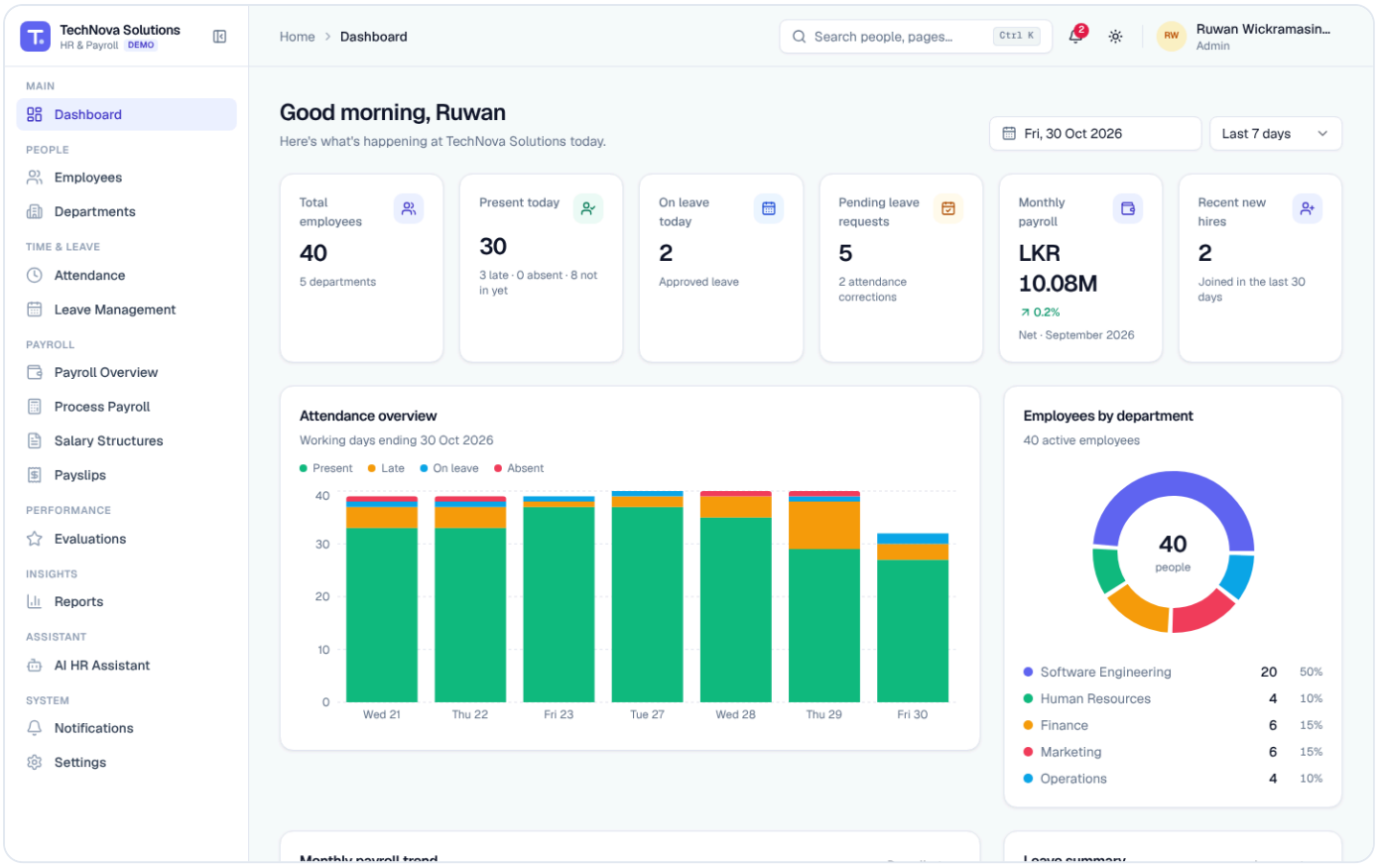
Navigation: Sidebar → Dashboard

Steps:

1. Review the KPI cards: **Total employees**, **Present today**, **On leave today**, **Pending leave requests**, **Monthly payroll** and **Recent new hires**. Each card is a link to the related module.
2. Use the **Dashboard date** picker to view attendance and leave for an earlier day, and the range selector (Last 7 / 14 / 30 days) to change the attendance chart.
3. Hover over any chart to see tooltips: Attendance overview, Employees by department, Monthly payroll trend and Leave summary.
4. Work through **Pending approvals**, read **Recent HR activity**, and check **Upcoming birthdays** and **Work anniversaries**.
5. Use **Quick actions** (Add employee, Review leave, Process payroll, New evaluation, Apply for leave) or the **AI HR Assistant** shortcuts.

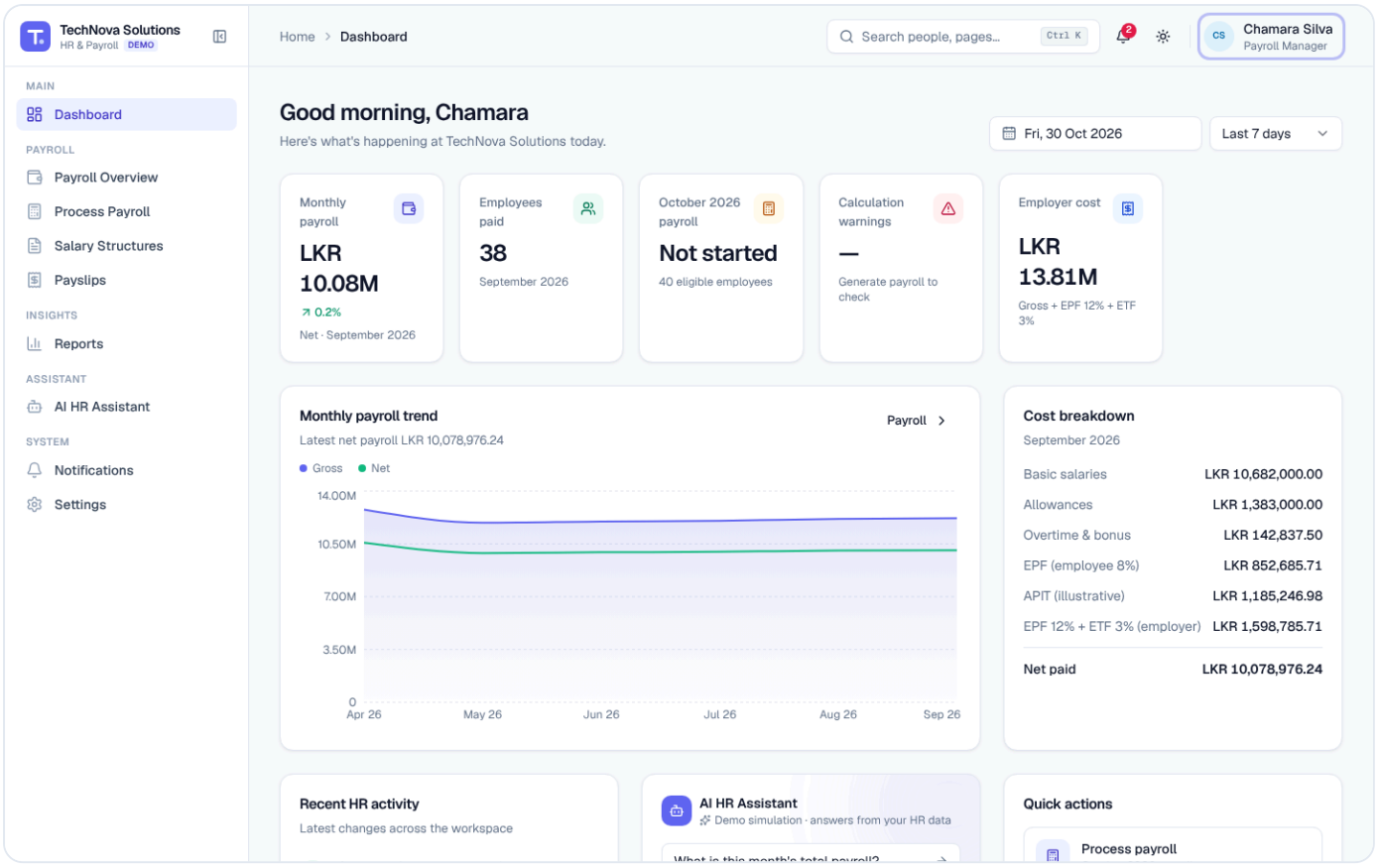
Expected Result: All figures come from the live demo records — for example approving a leave request or processing payroll updates the dashboard immediately.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 01 — Application overview

Notes: The Payroll Manager dashboard focuses on payroll (monthly payroll, employees paid, current period status, calculation warnings, employer cost and a cost breakdown) and hides HR metrics:



Team lead dashboard

Purpose: Monitor your direct reports.

Who can use it: Team Lead.

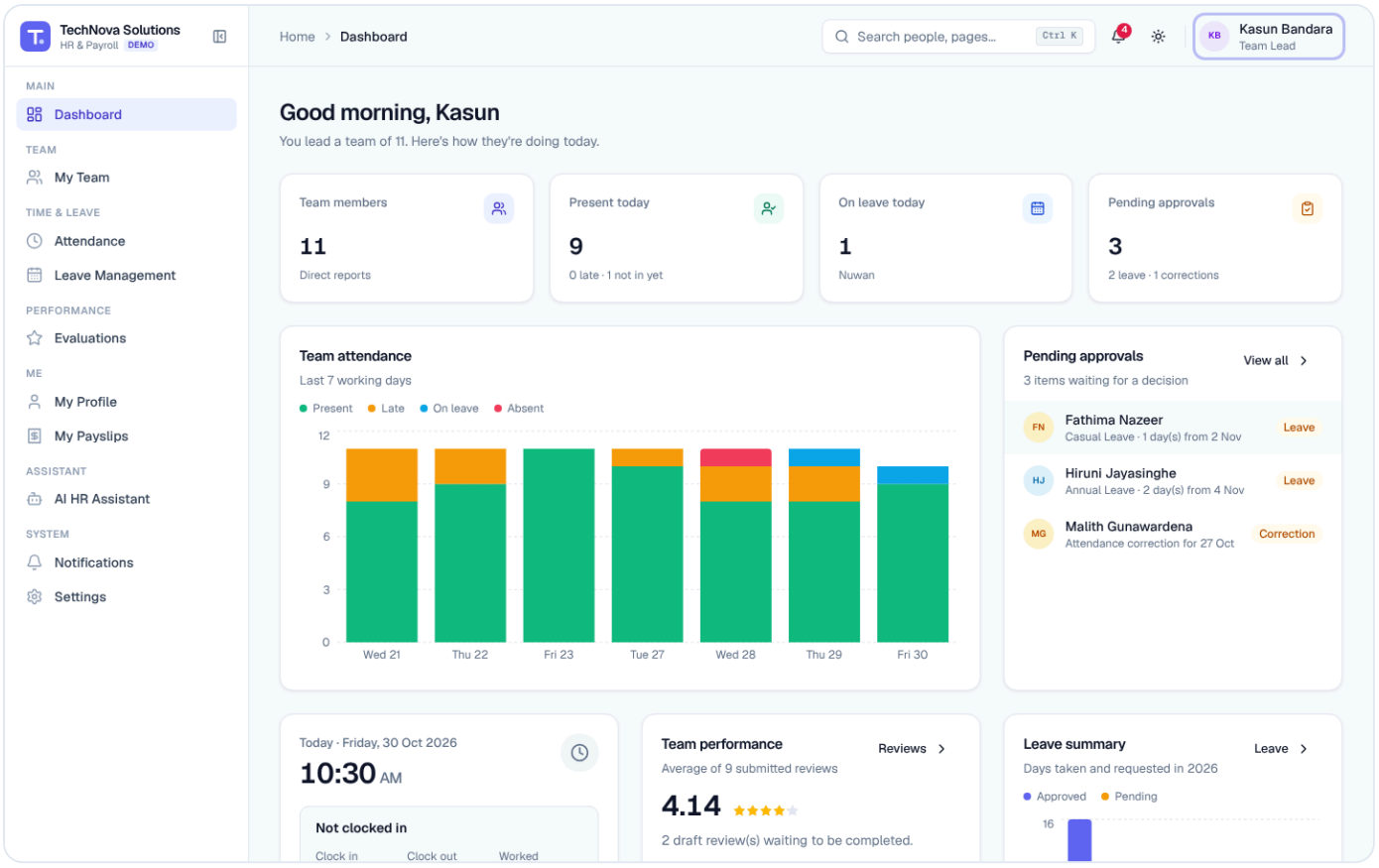
Navigation: Sidebar → Dashboard

Steps:

1. Check **Team members**, **Present today**, **On leave today** and **Pending approvals**.
2. Review the **Team attendance** chart for the last seven working days.
3. Open items from **Pending approvals** (leave and attendance corrections from your team).
4. Clock yourself in or out from the clock card, and check your team's average performance rating.

Expected Result: Every figure is limited to employees who report to you.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 04 — Leave management

The employee dashboard is described in Employee self-service.

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4. Employee management

Searching, filtering and sorting the directory

Purpose: Find employees quickly.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager. Team Leads see **My Team** (their direct reports, read-only).

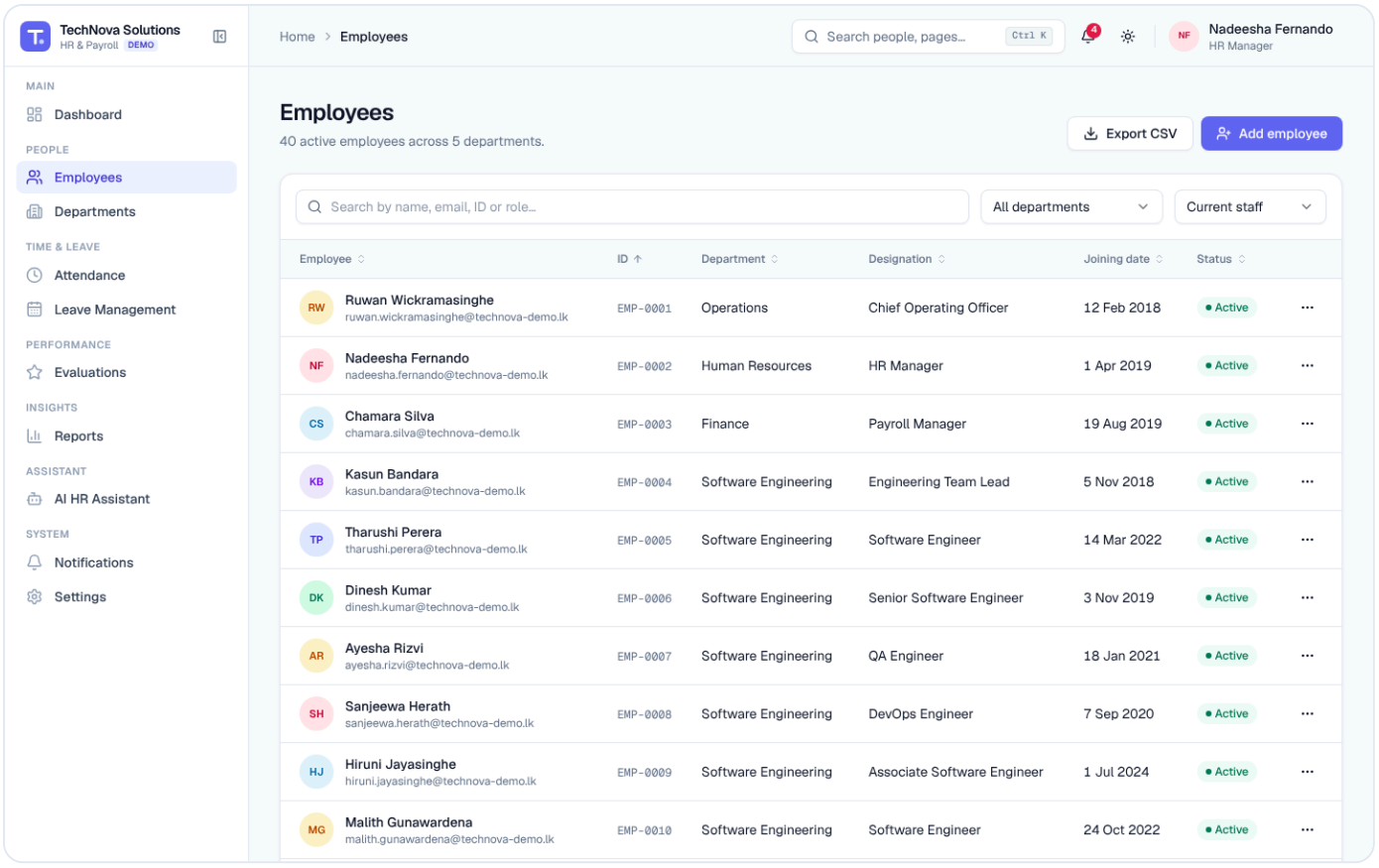
Navigation: Sidebar → Employees

Steps:

1. Type in **Search by name, email, ID or role…**.
2. Use **All departments** to filter by department and **Current staff** to filter by status (Active, Probation, Notice period, Archived, All).
3. Click a column header (Employee, ID, Department, Designation, Joining date, Status) to sort; click again to reverse.
4. Use the pagination controls at the bottom (rows per page, previous/next).
5. Click **Export CSV** to download the filtered list.

Expected Result: The table updates instantly; "Showing 1–10 of 40" reflects the filtered count. If nothing matches, an empty state offers **Clear filters**.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 02 — Employee management

Adding an employee

Purpose: Create a new employee record with personal, employment, salary and additional information.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager.

Navigation: Employees → Add employee

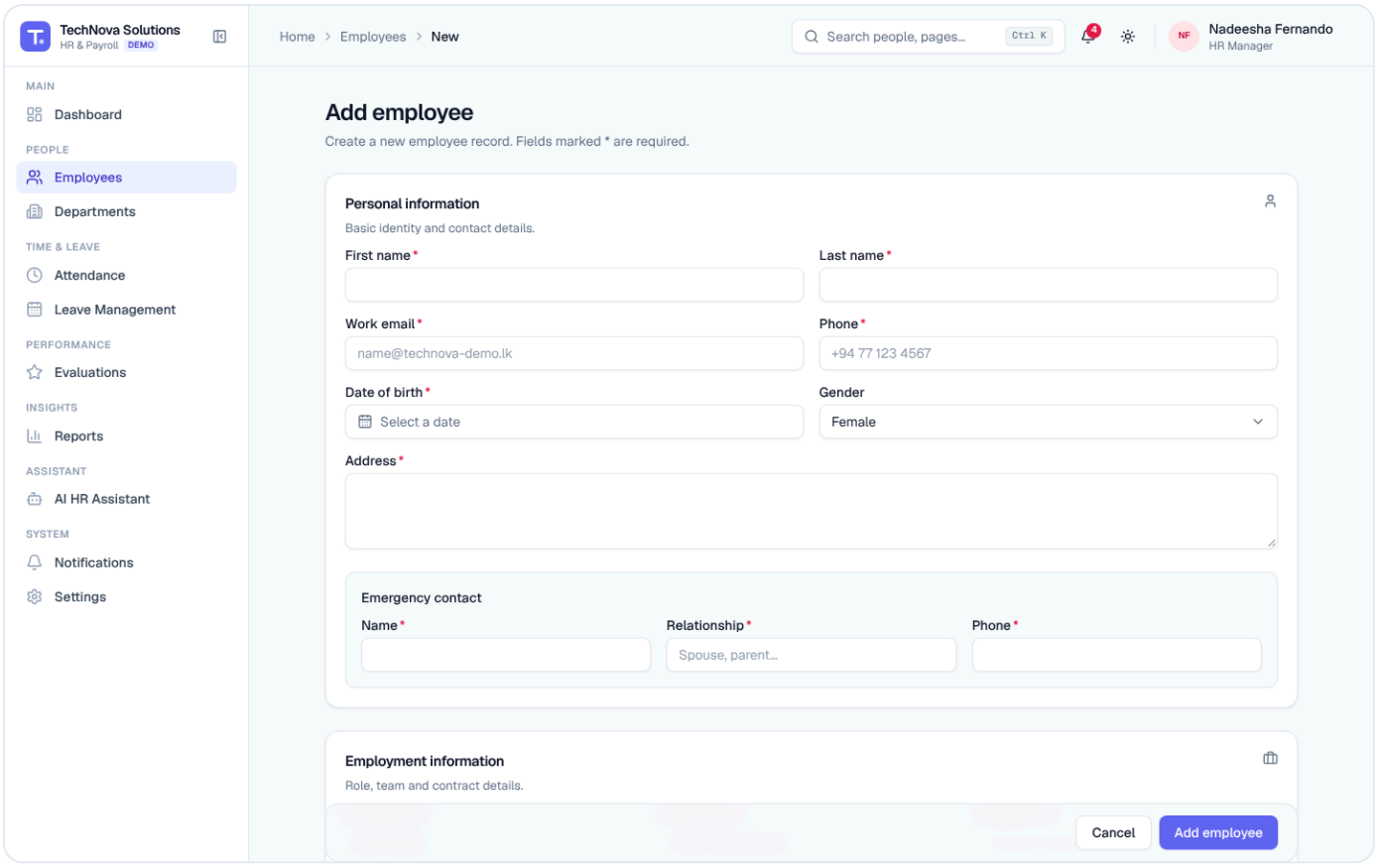
Steps:

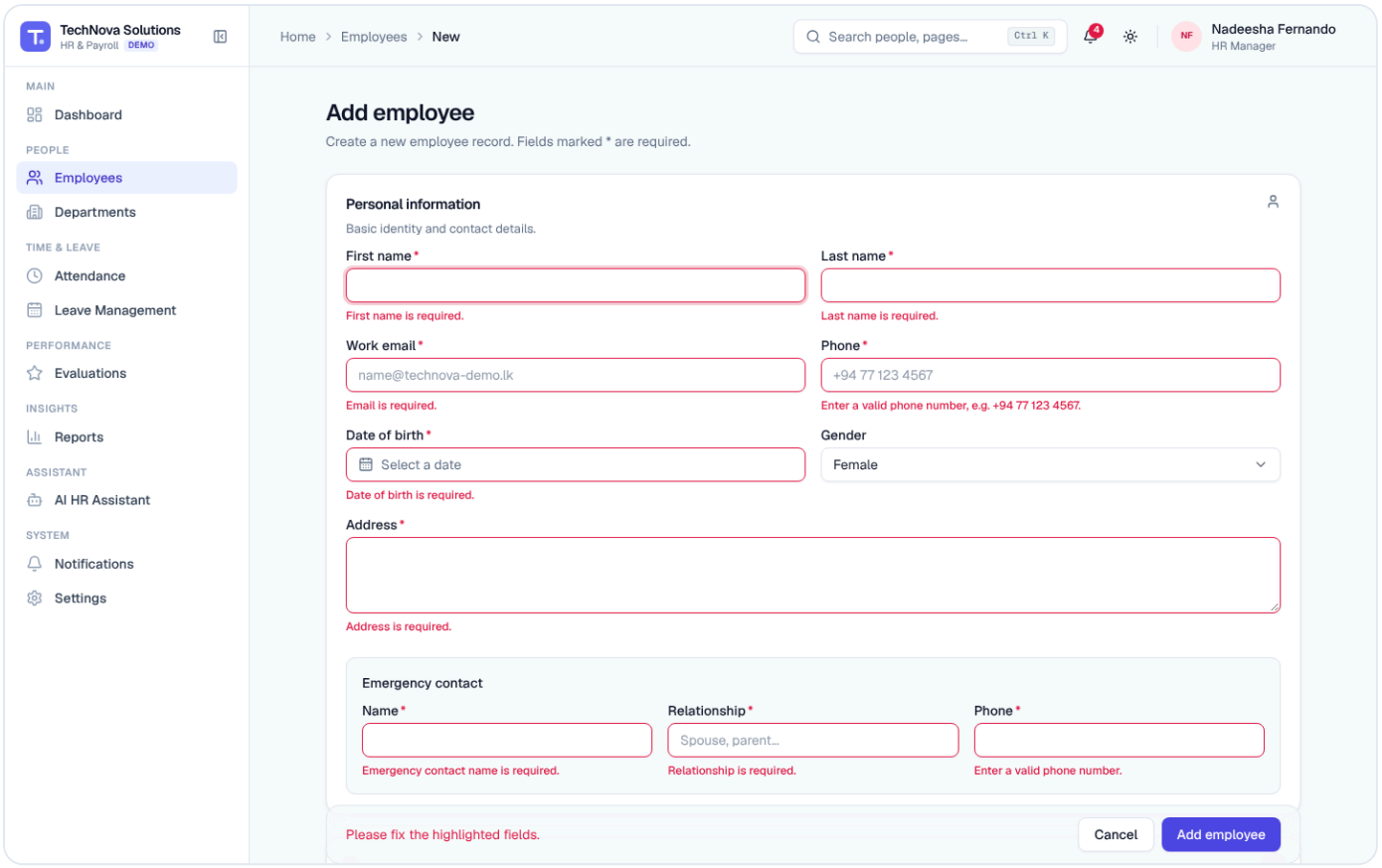
1. Click **Add employee**.
2. **Personal information:** first and last name, work email, phone, date of birth (use the year and month dropdowns in the calendar), gender, address and an emergency contact.
3. **Employment information:** the employee ID is generated automatically (e.g. `EMP-0041`); choose a department, then a designation from that department, a reporting manager (searchable), joining date, employment type and status.
4. **Salary information:** basic salary, transport, meal and other allowances, currency and payment frequency (monthly).

5. **Additional information:** add skills (type and press Enter), notes, and optionally upload a profile photo.
6. Click **Add employee**.

Expected Result: The record is saved, a success toast appears and the new employee's profile opens. The directory count increases, and Admin, the Payroll Manager and the reporting manager receive notifications.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: 02 — Employee management

Notes: Required fields are marked `*`. Email addresses and IDs must be unique, phone numbers must be valid and the date of birth must be before the joining date. If you click **Cancel** with unsaved changes you are asked to confirm before they are discarded.

Viewing an employee profile

Purpose: See everything about one employee in one place.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager, the employee's Team Lead; every employee can see their own profile (**My Profile**).

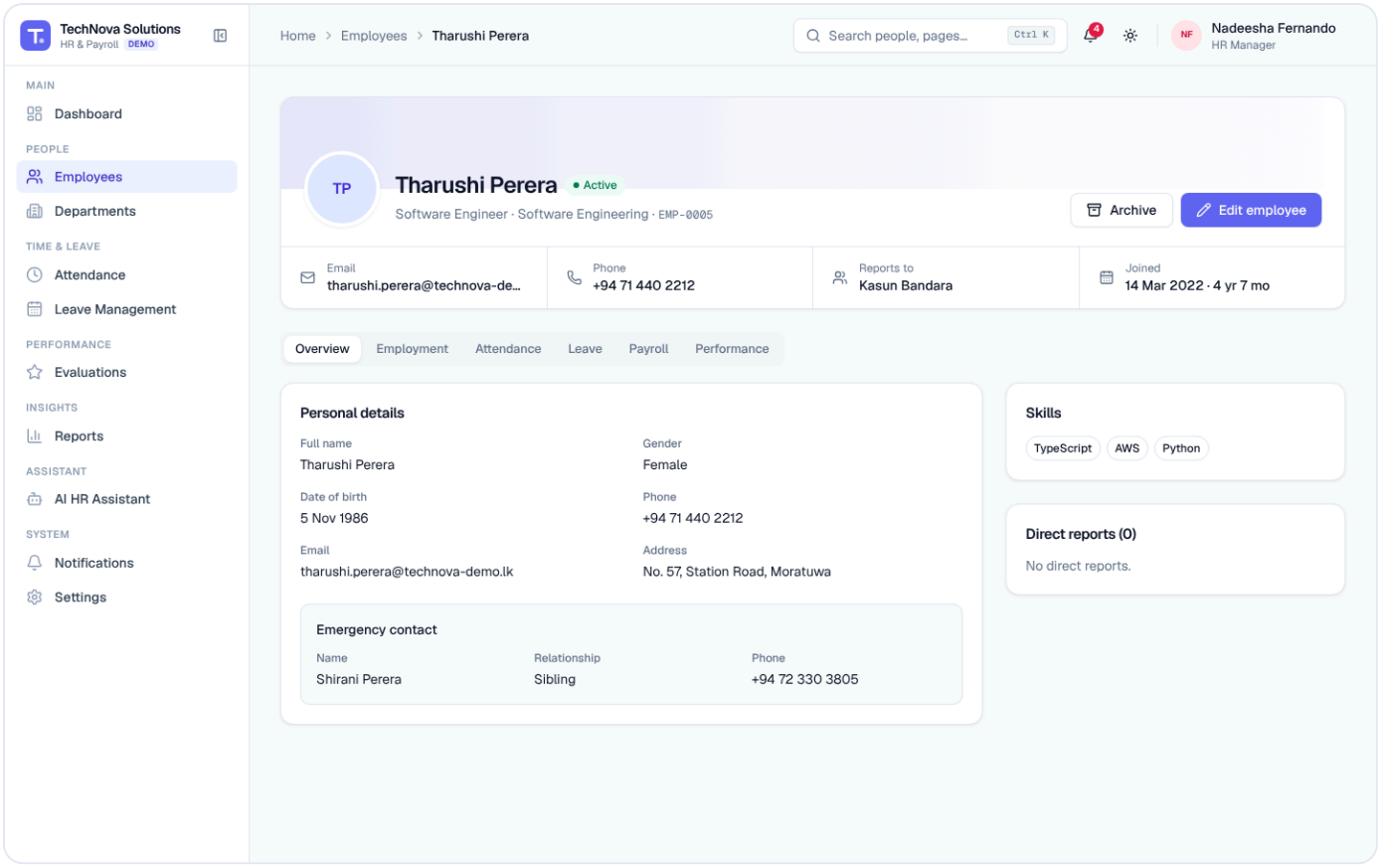
Navigation: Employees → click a name

Steps:

1. Review the header: photo, name, designation, department, status, email, phone, reporting manager and joining date with tenure.
2. Switch between the tabs: **Overview**, **Employment**, **Attendance**, **Leave**, **Payroll** and **Performance**.

Expected Result: Each tab shows that employee's live records — leave balances, attendance history, payslips, evaluations and goals.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 02 — Employee management

Notes: The **Payroll** tab is only visible to roles allowed to see salaries (Admin, HR Manager, Payroll Manager) and to the employee themselves.

Editing an employee

Purpose: Update an employee's details.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager.

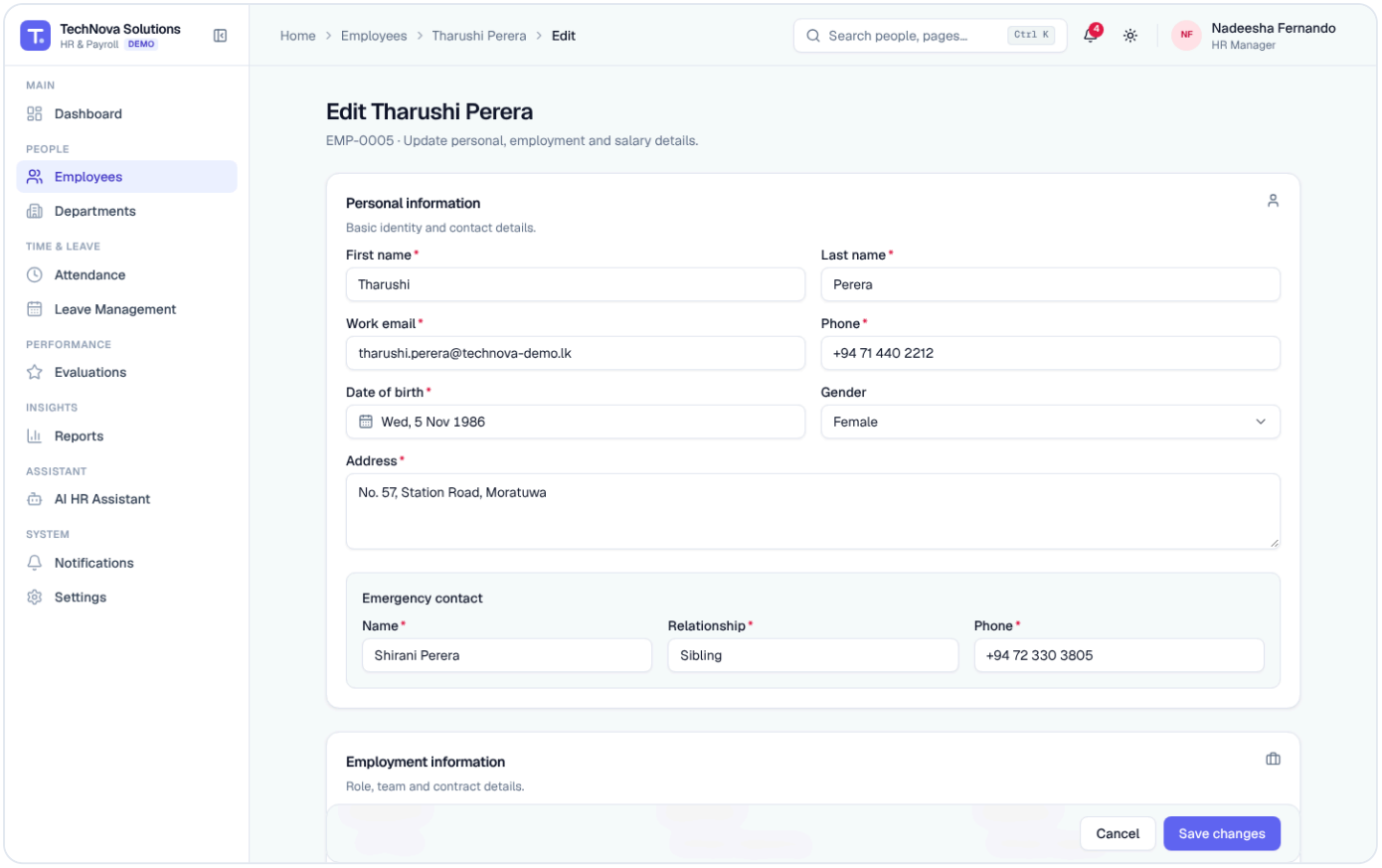
Navigation: Employees → row actions (⋯) → Edit, or profile → Edit employee

Steps:

1. Open the edit form — all fields are pre-filled.
2. Change the details you need.
3. Click **Save changes**.

Expected Result: The profile opens with the new values and a "Employee updated" toast. Changes persist after a page refresh.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 02 — Employee management

Archiving and restoring an employee

Purpose: Remove leavers from the active directory without deleting their history.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager.

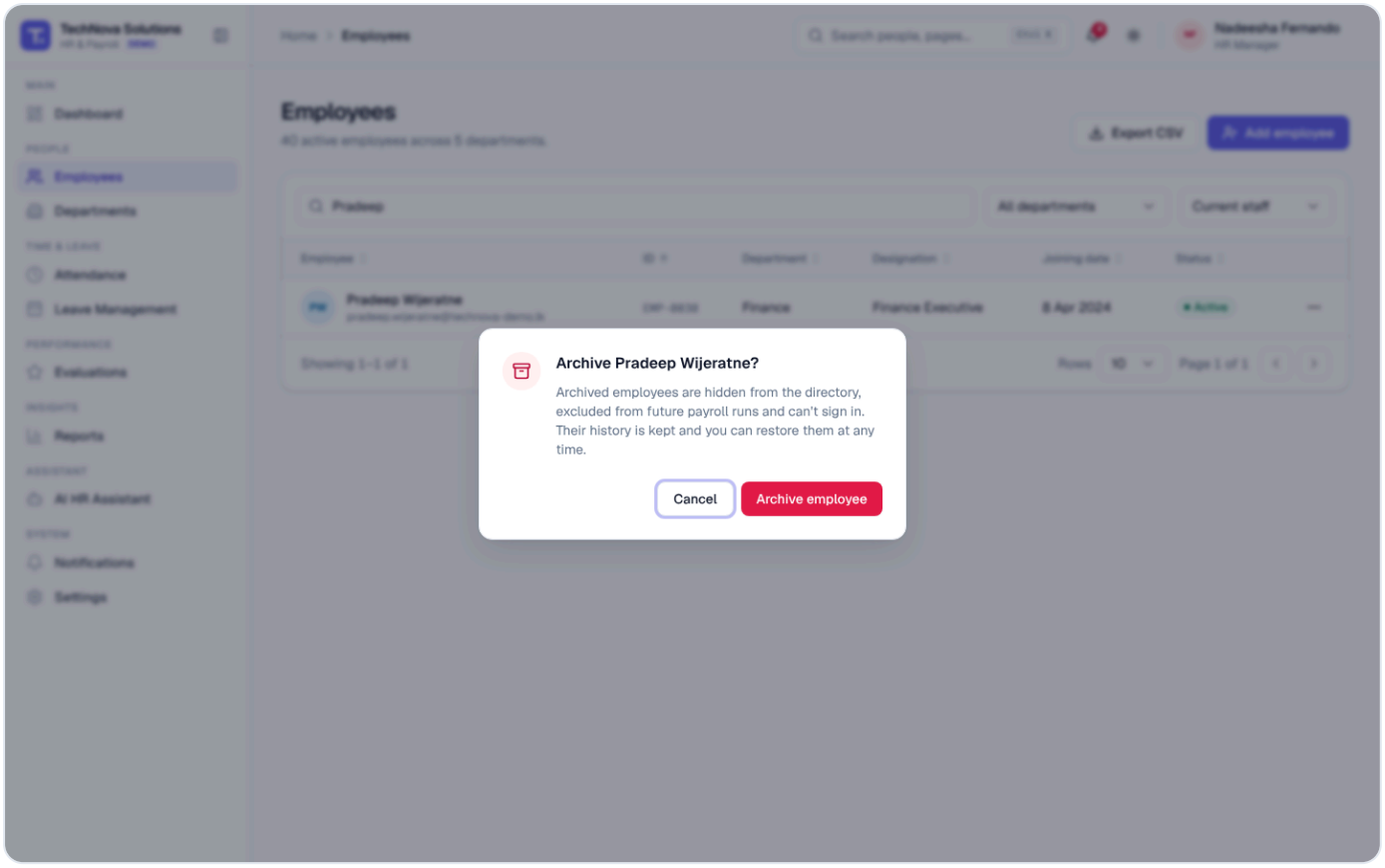
Navigation: Employees → row actions (⋯) → Archive

Steps:

1. Open the row's actions menu and choose **Archive**.
2. Read the confirmation (archived employees are hidden, excluded from future payroll runs and can be restored) and click **Archive employee**.
3. To restore, set the status filter to **Archived**, open the row's actions and choose **Restore**.

Expected Result: The active headcount drops by one; after restoring it returns.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 02 — Employee management

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5. Departments and designations

Managing departments

Purpose: Maintain the organisation structure used across every module.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager.

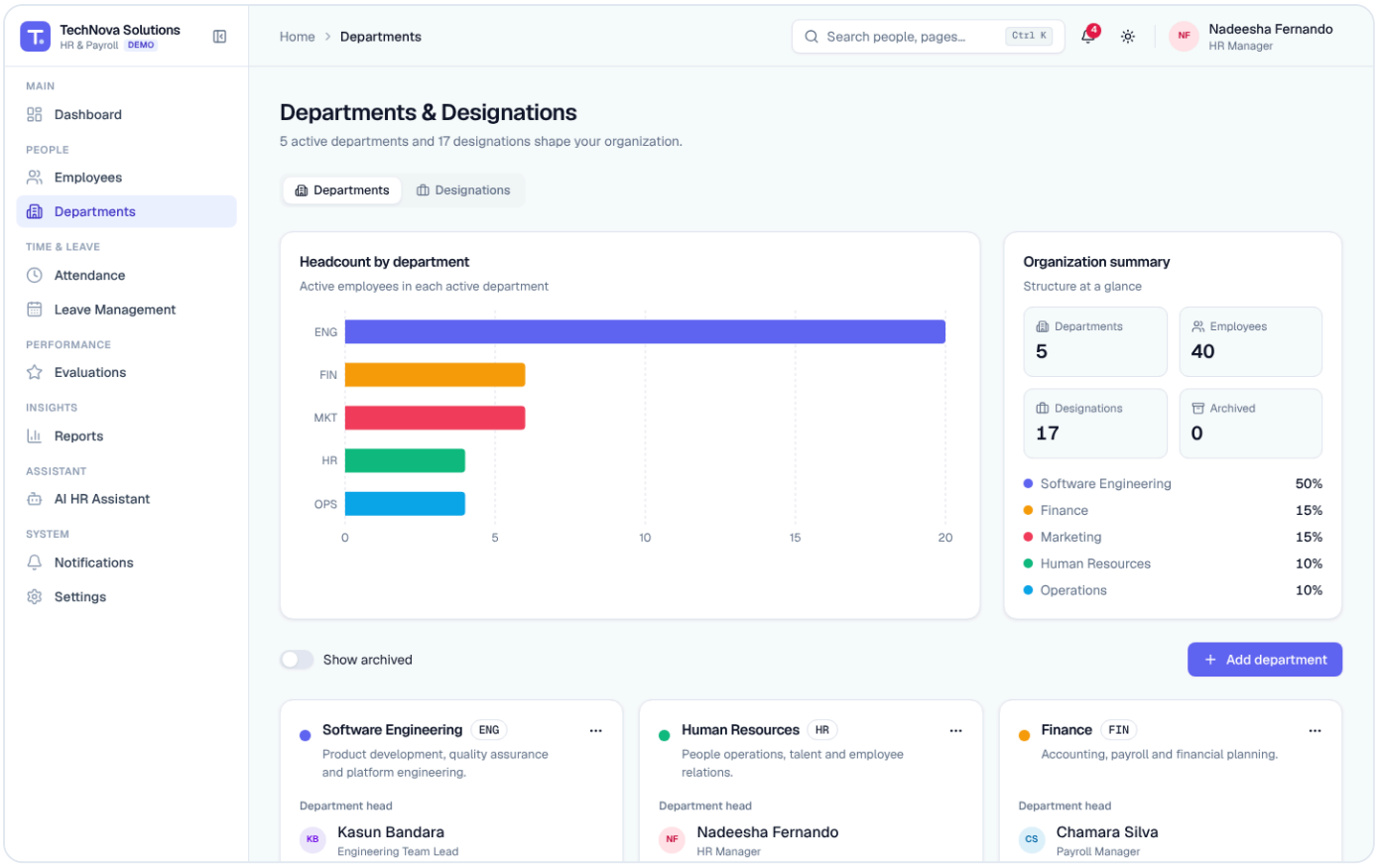
Navigation: Sidebar → Departments (also Settings → Departments)

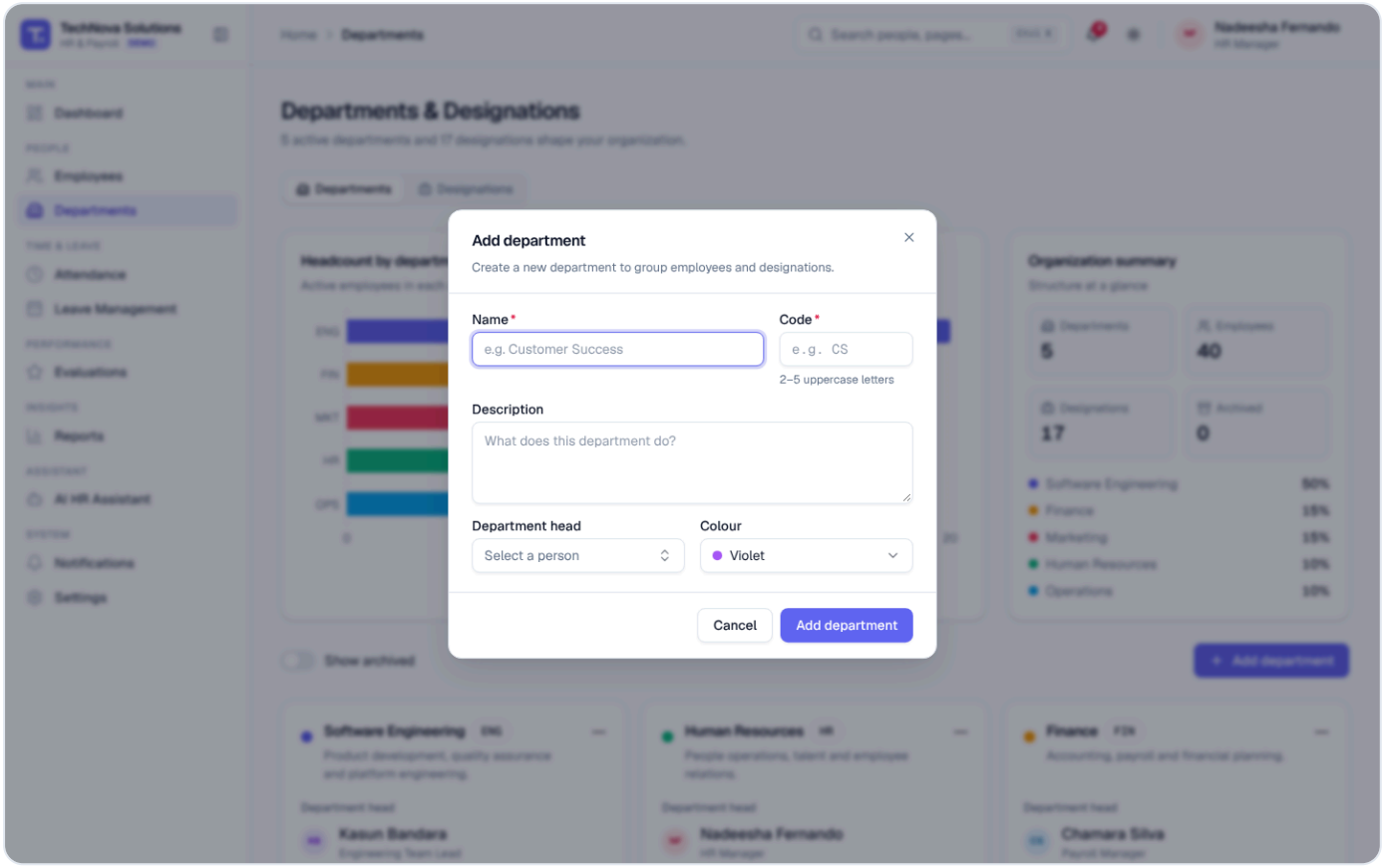
Steps:

1. Review the headcount chart and the department cards (code, description, head, headcount, designations).
2. Click **Add department**, enter a name, a 2–5 letter code, description, department head and colour, then click **Add department**.
3. Use a card's actions menu (⋯) to **Edit** or **Archive** a department.
4. Turn on **Show archived** to see and **Restore** archived departments.

Expected Result: New departments are immediately available in the employee form, filters and reports.

Screenshot:





Notes: Codes must be unique. A department that still has active employees can't be archived — you'll see an explanation instead.

Managing designations

Purpose: Maintain job titles per department.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager.

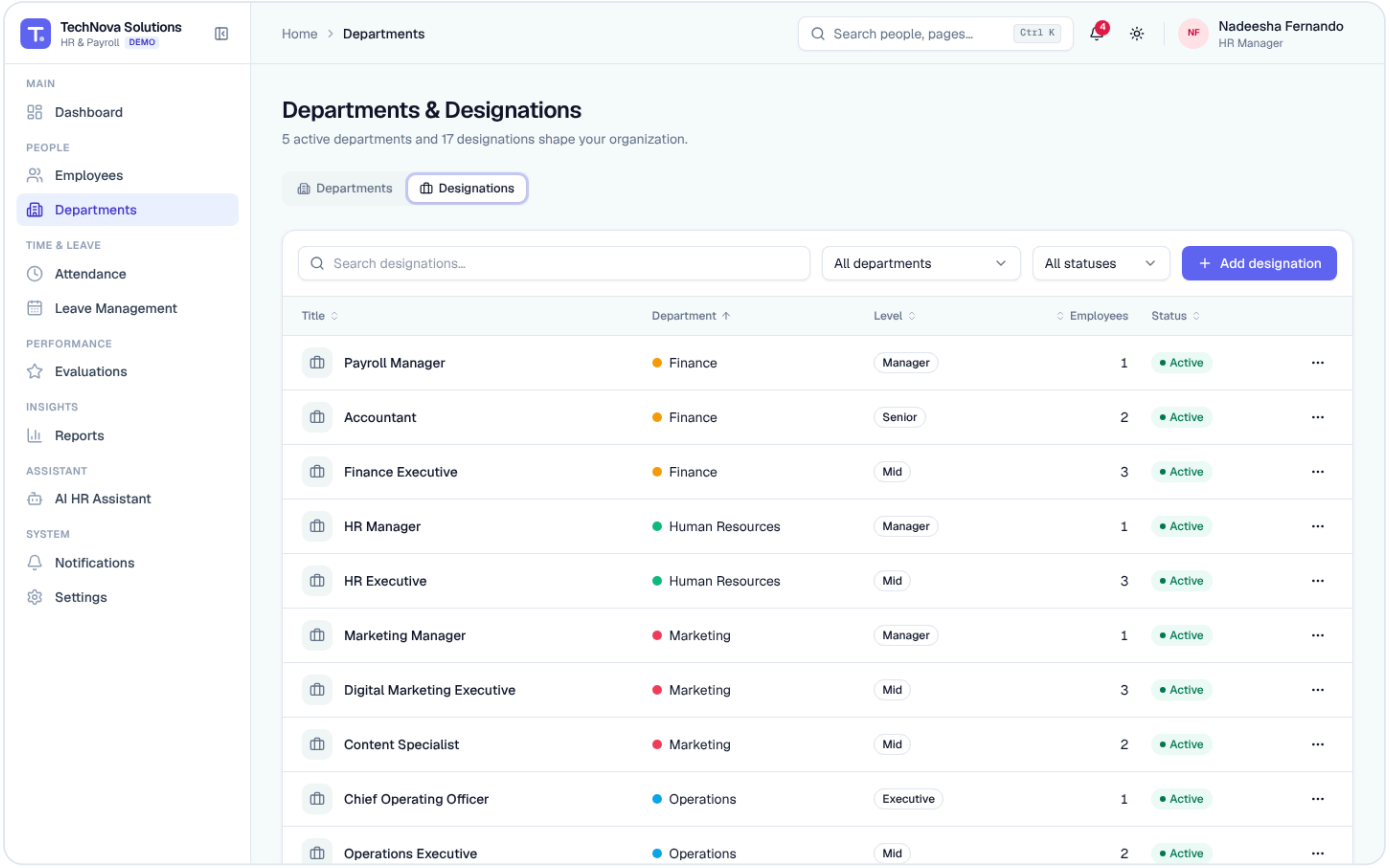
Navigation: Departments → Designations tab

Steps:

1. Search or filter the designation list by department or status.
2. Click **Add designation**, enter the title, department and level, and save.
3. Use the row actions to **Edit**, **Archive** or **Restore**.

Expected Result: Designations appear in the employee form once their department is chosen.

Screenshot:



Notes: Designations that are assigned to employees can't be archived.

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6. Attendance

Clocking in and out

Purpose: Record working time.

Who can use it: Everyone (for themselves).

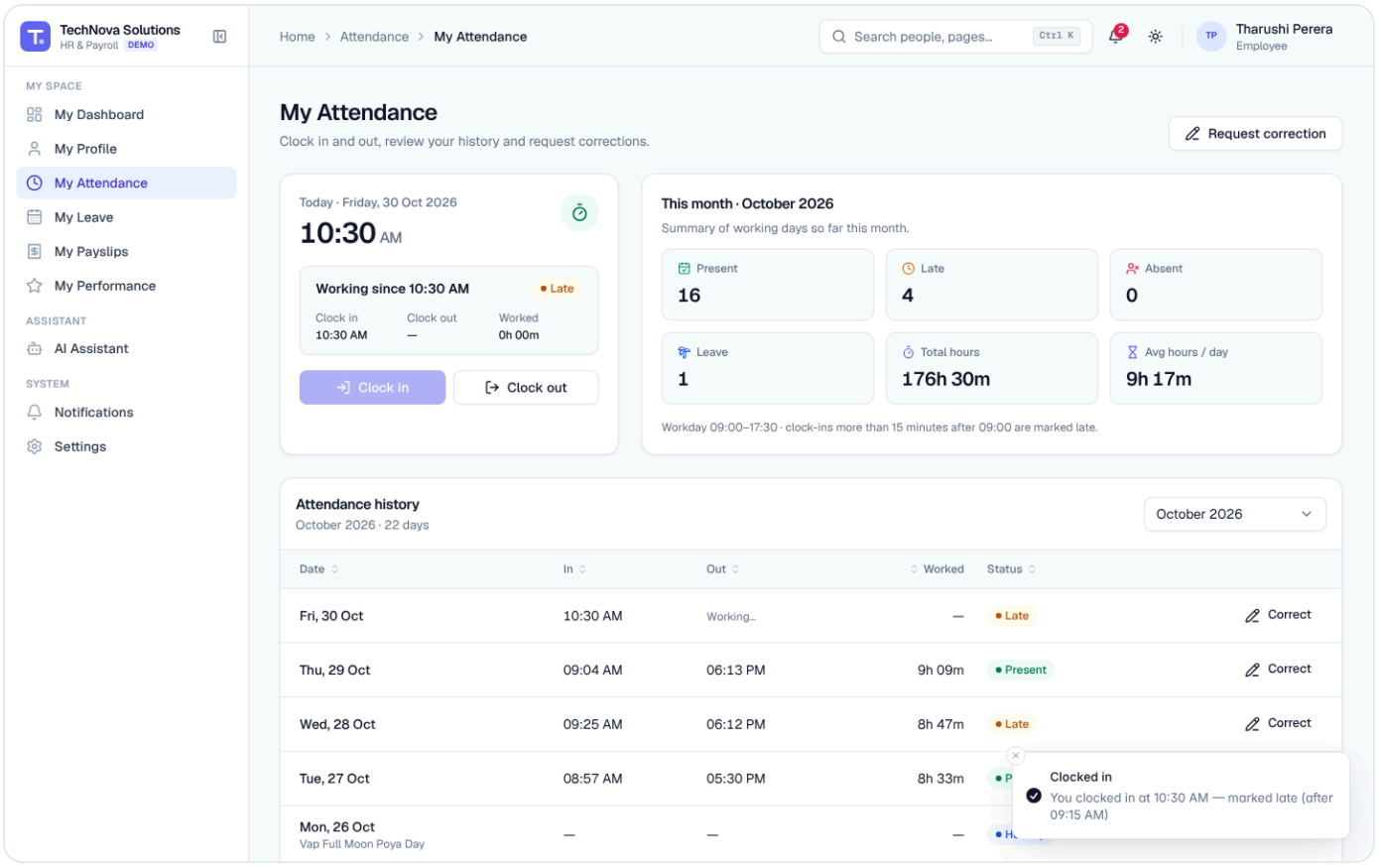
Navigation: Sidebar → My Attendance (or the clock card on the dashboard)

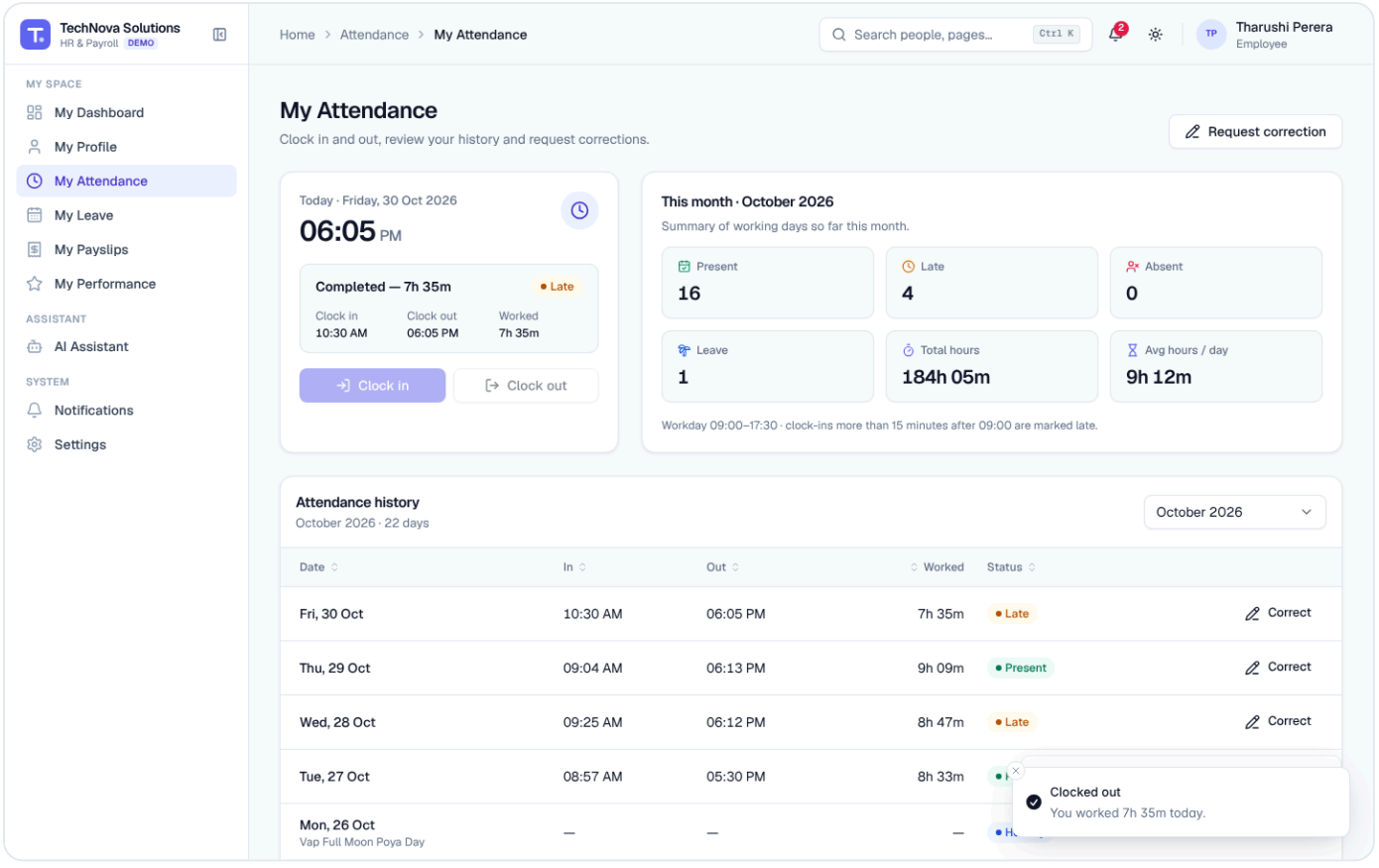
Steps:

1. Check today's card — it shows the current time and your status (*Not clocked in*).
2. Click **Clock in**. Your local time is recorded and the status changes to *Working since …*.
3. At the end of the day click **Clock out**.

Expected Result: A toast confirms each action; after clocking out you see the hours worked (for example *Completed — 7h 35m*) and today's row appears in your attendance history. Arrivals after 09:15 (09:00 + 15 minutes' grace) are marked **Late**.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [03 — Attendance management]

Notes: The buttons are disabled on weekends, public holidays and days you are on approved leave, with an explanation.

Viewing attendance history

Purpose: Review your own attendance.

Who can use it: Everyone.

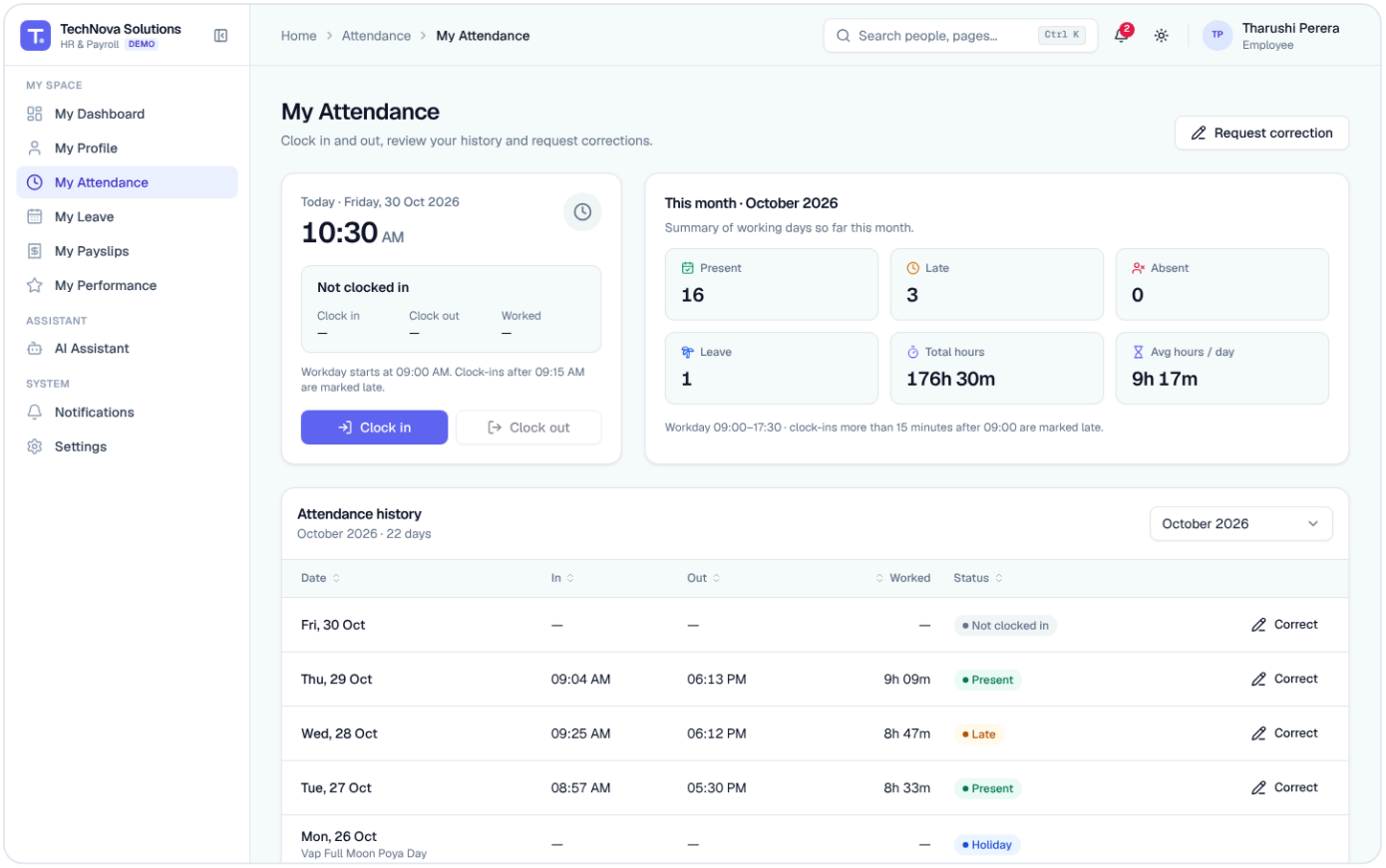
Navigation: My Attendance

Steps:

1. Review this month's summary (present, late, absent, leave, total and average hours).
2. Choose a **Month** to see the history table (date, in, out, worked, status).

Expected Result: The history reflects clock-ins, approved corrections and leave.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 03 — Attendance management

Requesting an attendance correction

Purpose: Fix a missed or wrong clock-in/out.

Who can use it: Everyone (for themselves).

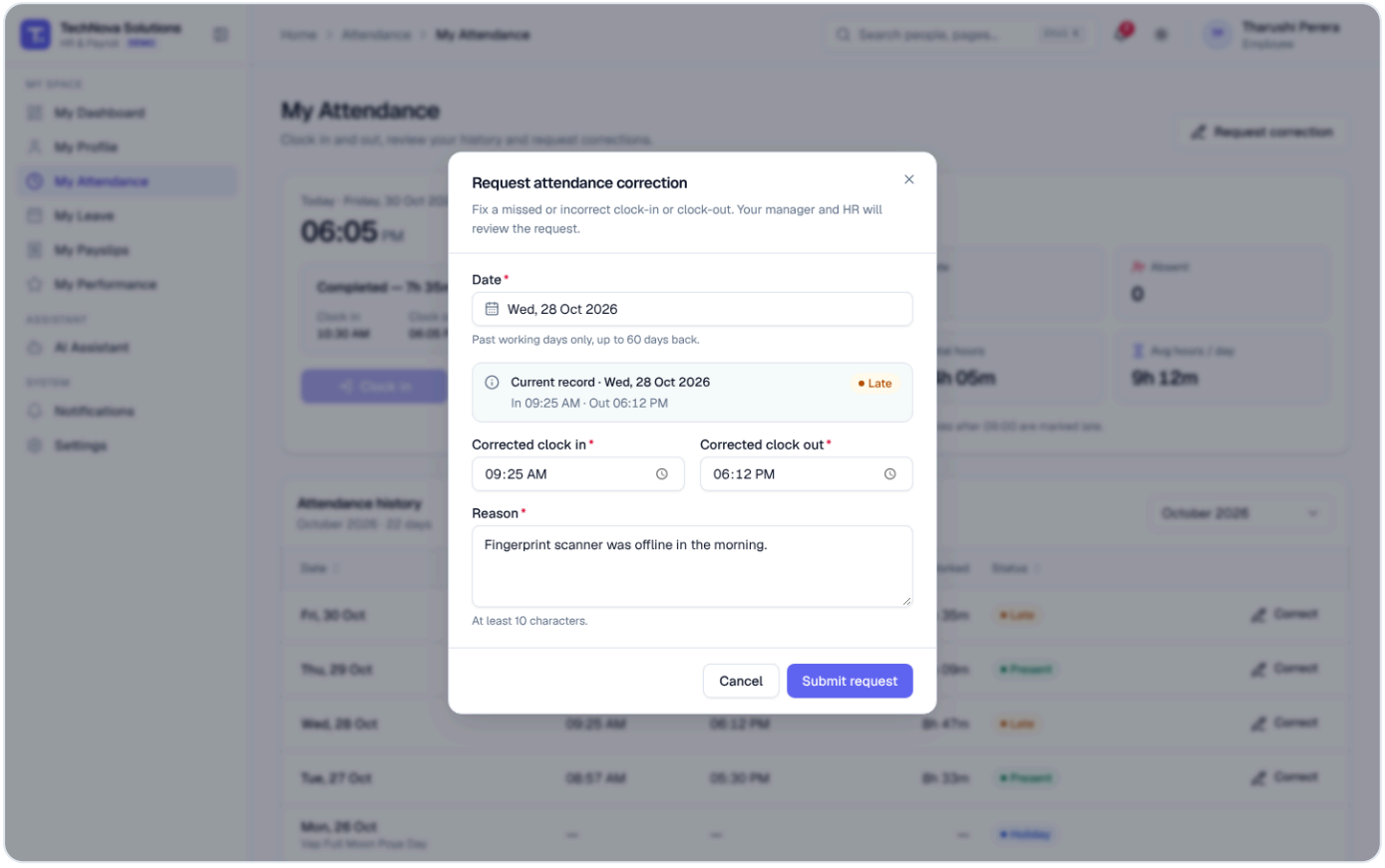
Navigation: My Attendance → Request correction (or **Correct** on a history row)

Steps:

1. Click **Request correction**.
2. Pick the **Date** (past working days only). The corrected times are pre-filled from the existing record.
3. Adjust **Corrected clock in** / **Corrected clock out** and enter a **Reason** (at least 10 characters).
4. Click **Submit request**.

Expected Result: The request appears under *My correction requests* as **Pending**; your manager and HR are notified.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: [03 — Attendance management]

Notes: Clock-out must be after clock-in, and you can't have two pending requests for the same day.

Daily attendance and the department overview

Purpose: See who is in, late, absent or on leave.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager (everyone), Team Lead (team).

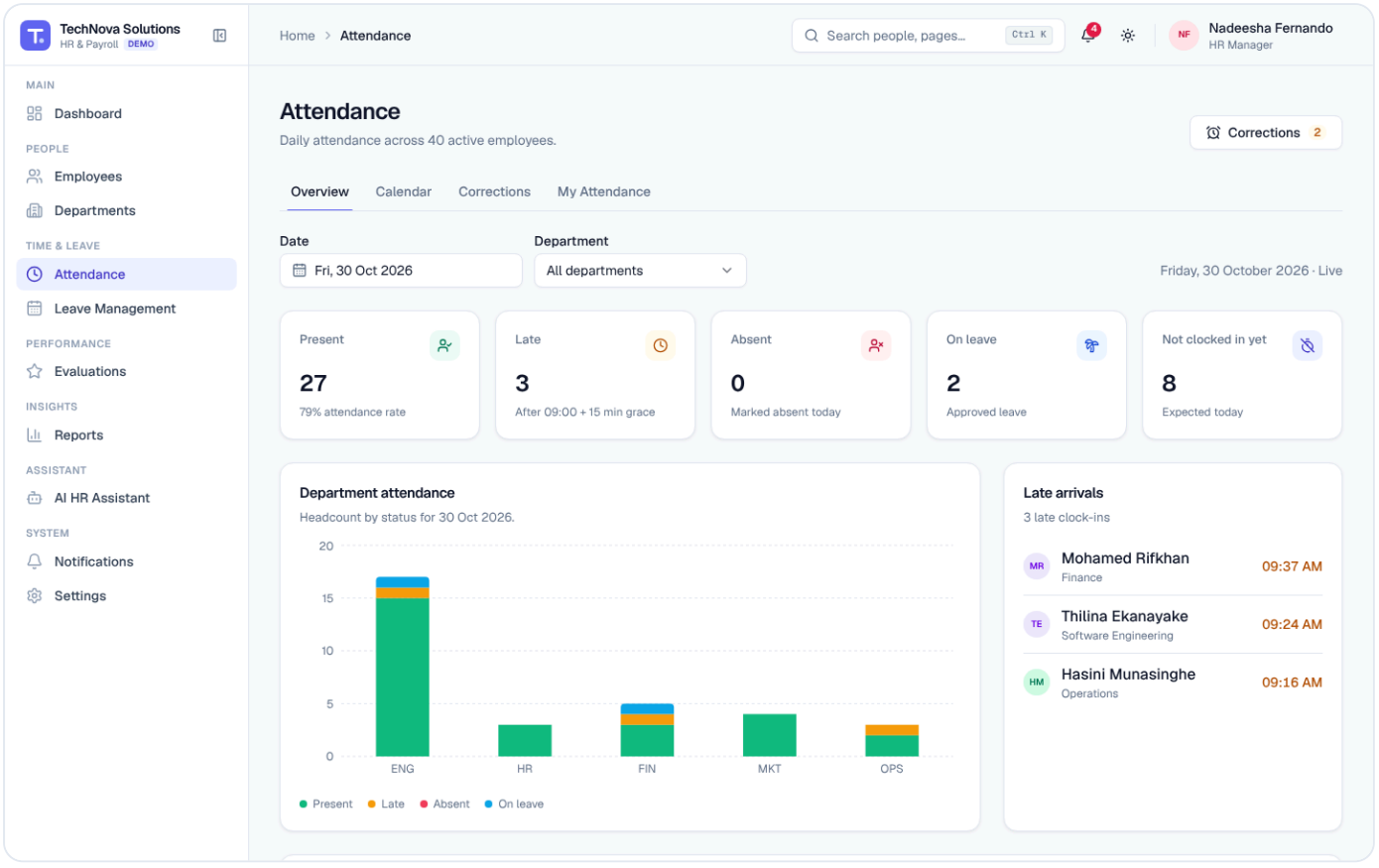
Navigation: Sidebar → Attendance → Overview

Steps:

1. Pick a **Date** (defaults to today).
2. Read the KPI cards (Present, Late, Absent, On leave, Not clocked in yet) and the **Department attendance** chart.
3. Filter the daily table by department or status, or search for a person.

Expected Result: Weekends and holidays show a clear "No working day" message instead of empty data.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 03 — Attendance management

Attendance calendar

Purpose: View one employee's month at a glance.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager, Team Lead.

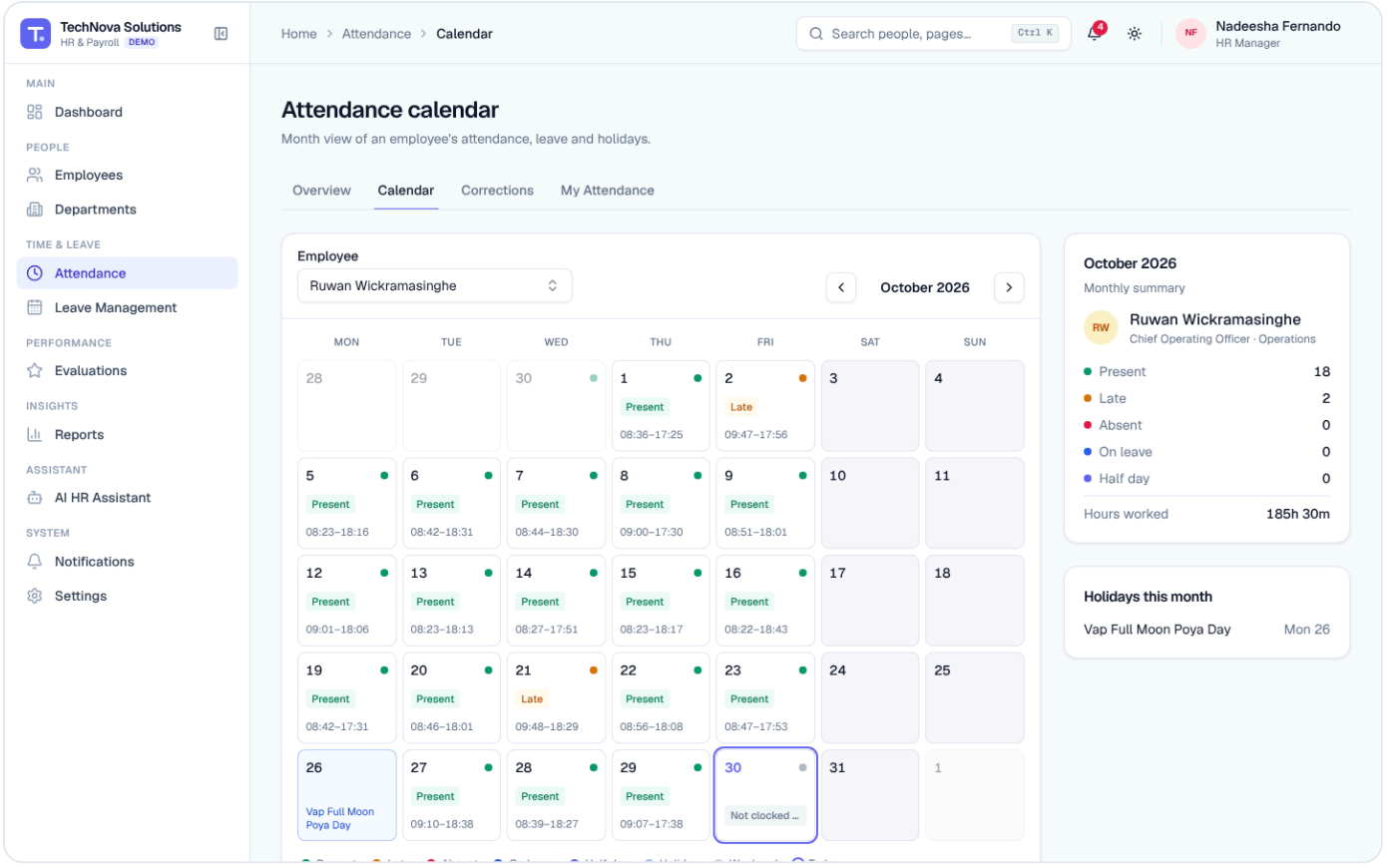
Navigation: Attendance → Calendar

Steps:

1. Choose an **Employee**.
2. Use **Previous month** / **Next month** to move between months.

Expected Result: Each day shows its status colour and clock times; weekends and holidays are shaded and a monthly summary is shown alongside.

Screenshot:



Approving attendance corrections

Purpose: Review correction requests.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager, Team Lead (team only).

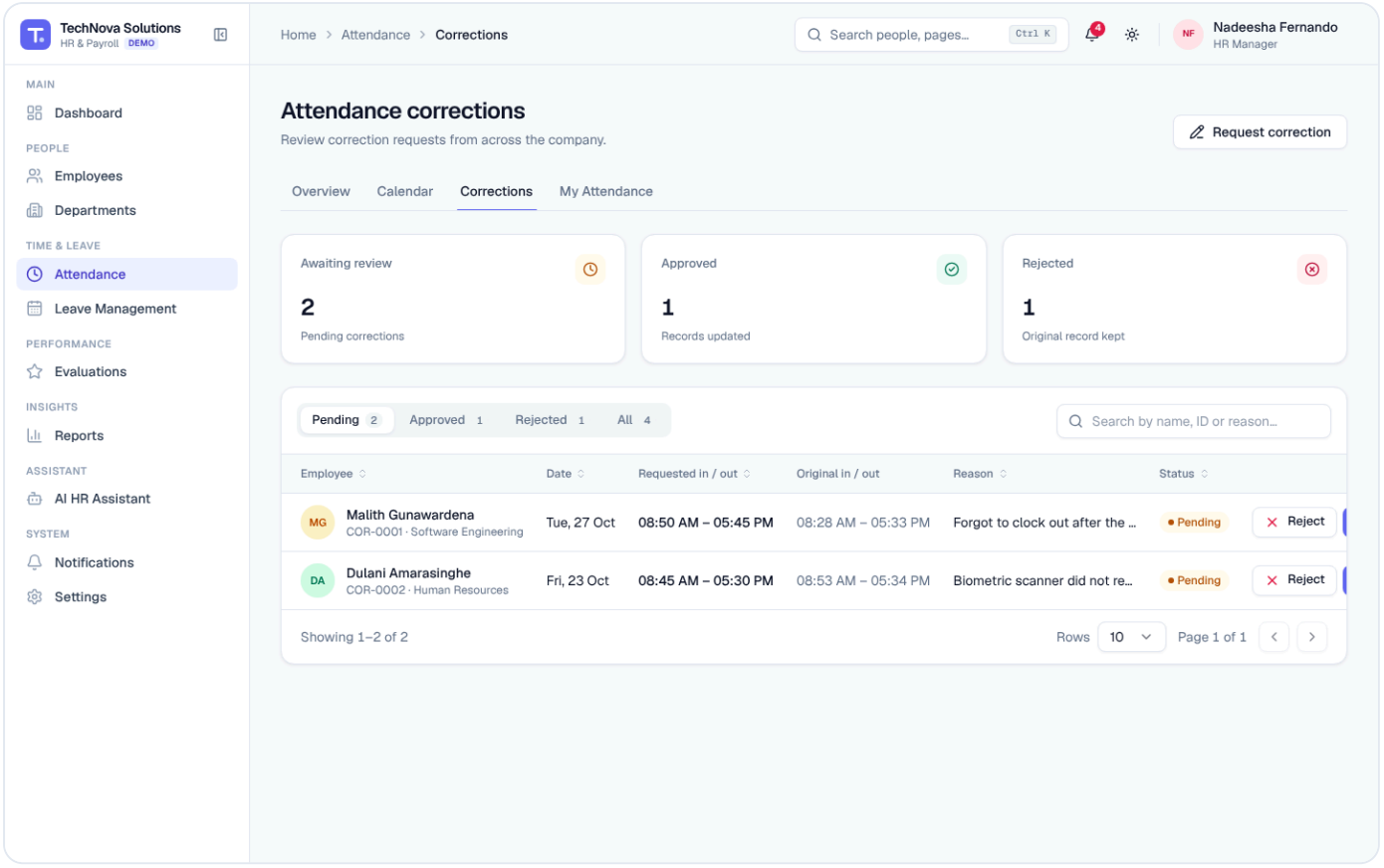
Navigation: Attendance → Corrections

Steps:

1. Open the **Pending** tab.
2. Click **Approve** or **Reject** on a request.
3. Review the requested vs. original times, add a **Comment** (required to reject) and confirm.

Expected Result: Approving updates the employee's attendance record (and its Late/Present status); the employee is notified either way.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 03 — Attendance management

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7. Leave applications

Checking your leave balance

Purpose: Know how much leave you have left.

Who can use it: Everyone.

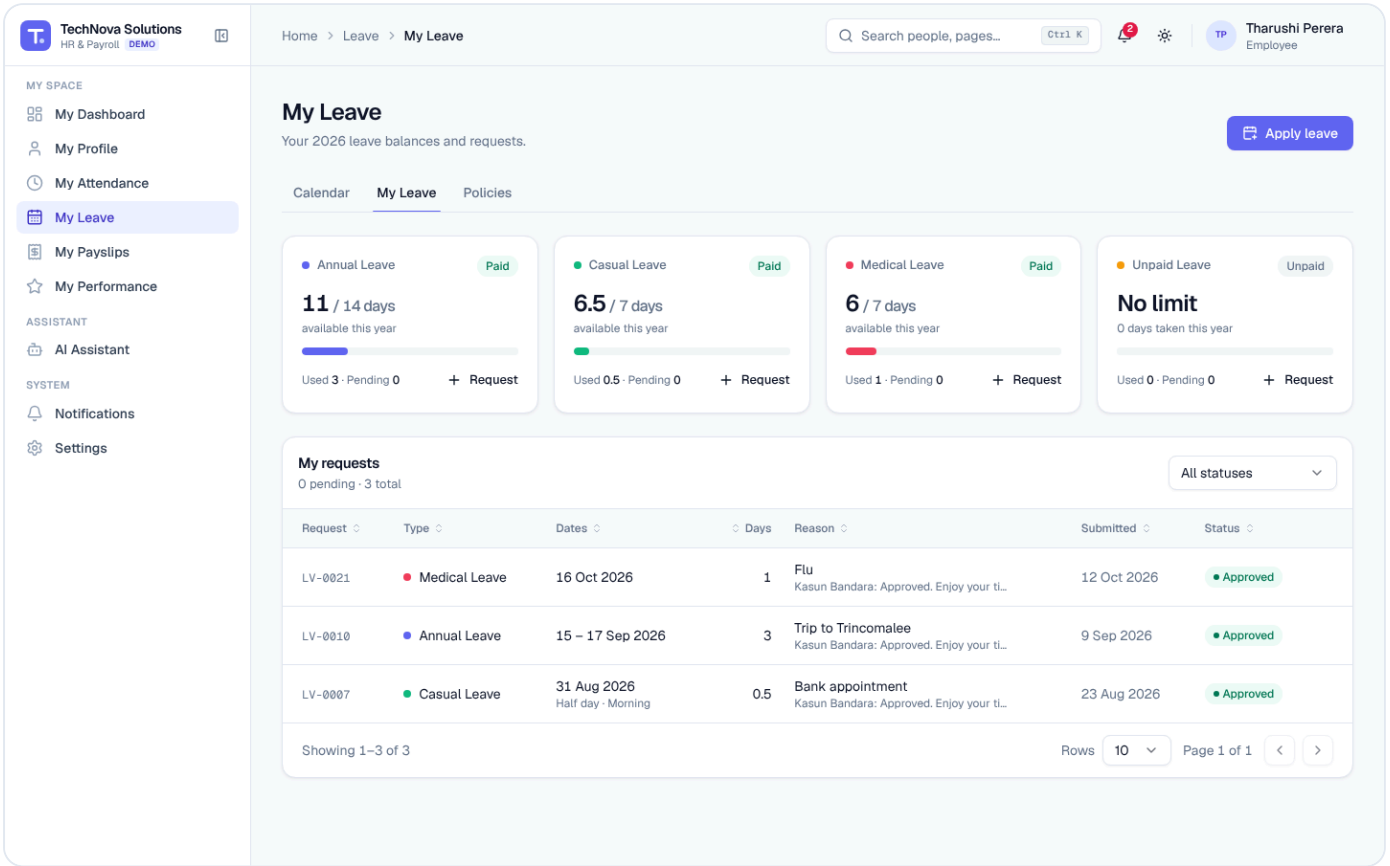
Navigation: Sidebar → My Leave

Steps:

1. Review the balance cards for Annual, Casual, Medical and Unpaid leave (available / allocated, used and pending).
2. Scroll to **My requests** to see your history and filter by status.

Expected Result: Balances already subtract approved *and* pending days, so they always match your requests.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 04 — Leave management

Applying for annual leave

Purpose: Request time off.

Who can use it: Everyone.

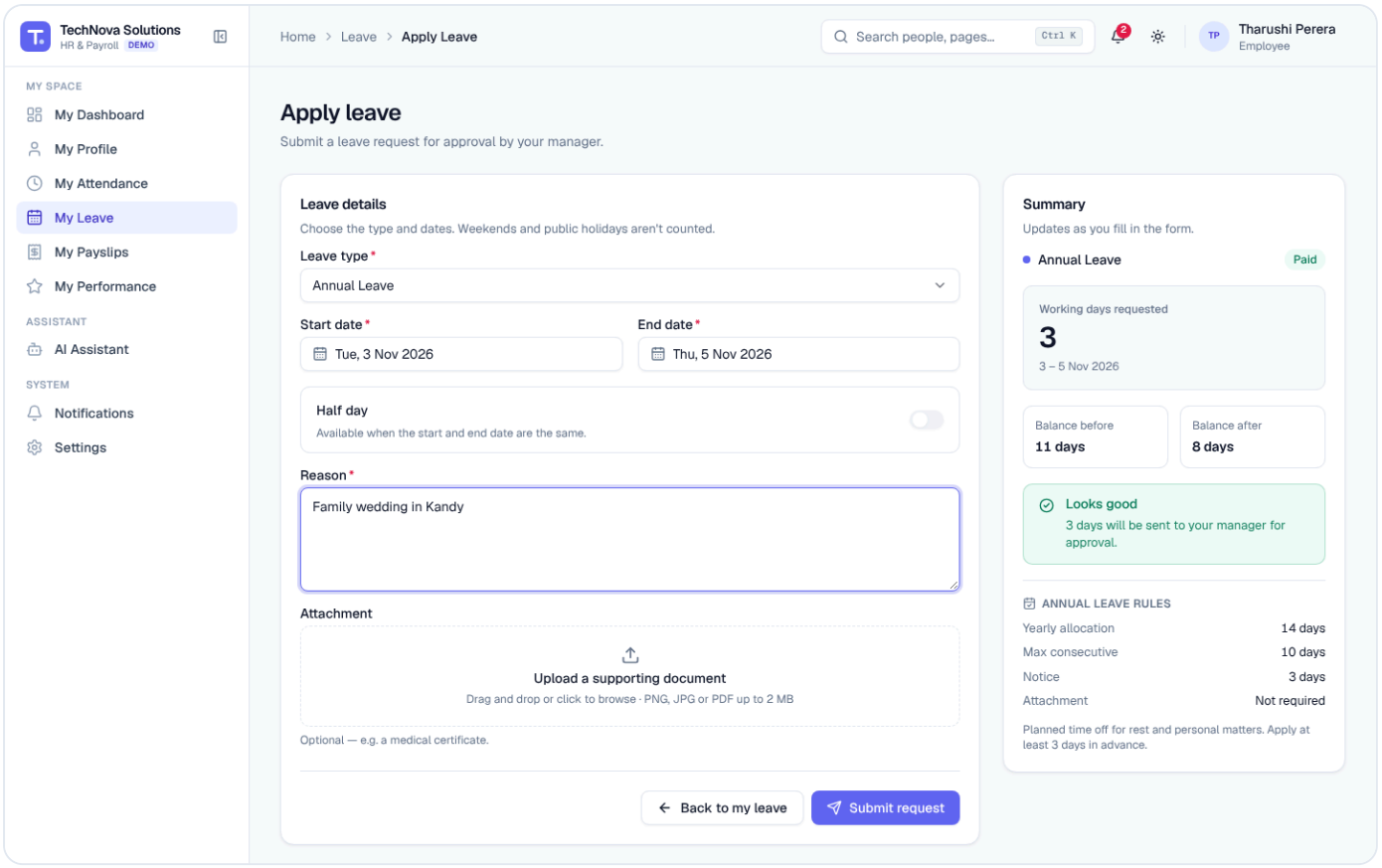
Navigation: Dashboard → Leave Management → Apply Leave (employees: My Leave → Apply leave)

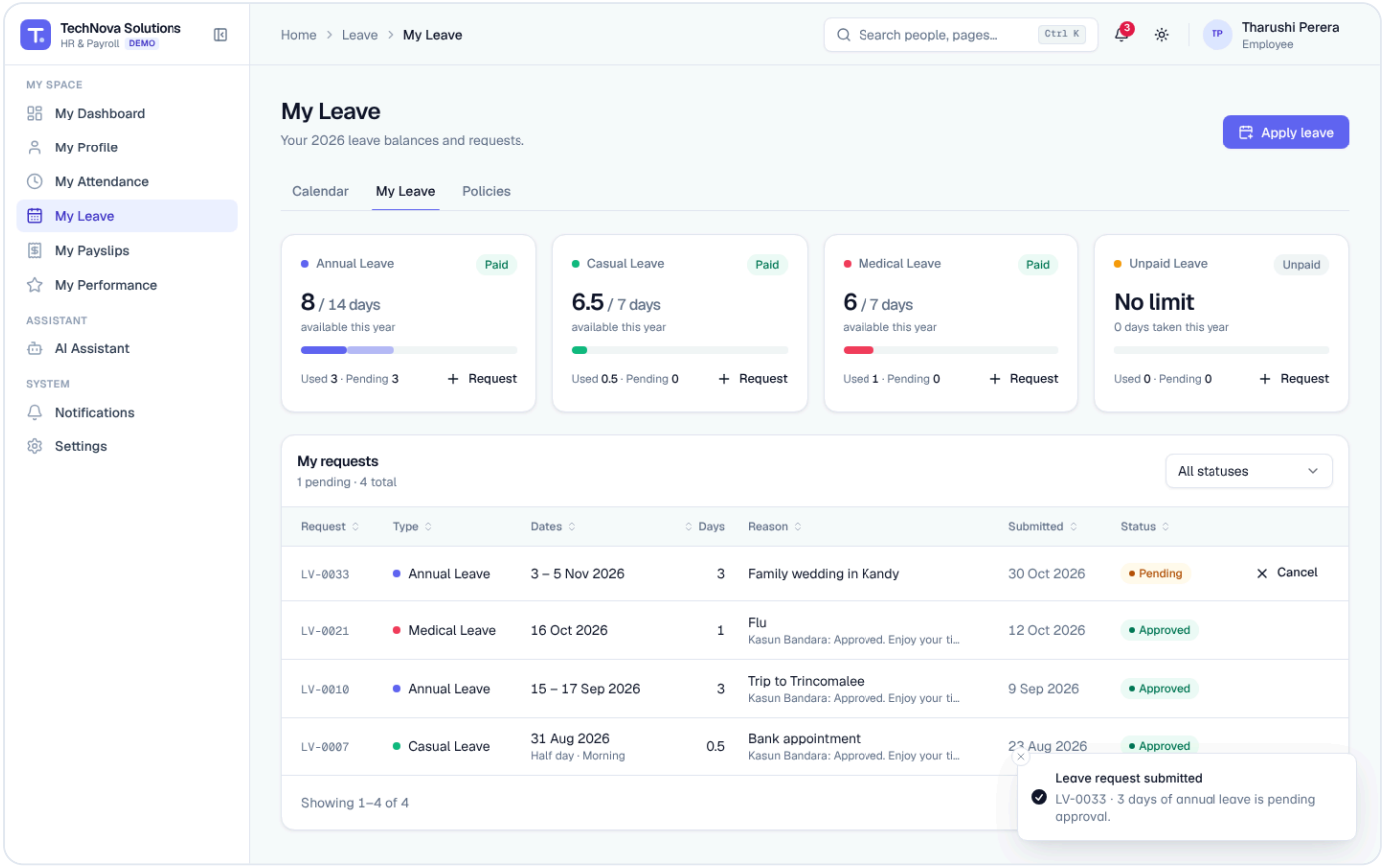
Steps:

1. Open the **Apply leave** page.
2. Click **Apply leave**.
3. Select the **Leave type**.
4. Select the **Start date** and **End date** (weekends, public holidays and past dates are disabled).
5. Optionally turn on **Half day** (start and end must be the same day) and choose Morning or Afternoon.
6. Enter a **Reason** and optionally attach a document.
7. Review the **Summary** panel: working days requested, balance before and after, and the leave-type rules.
8. Click **Submit request**.
9. Verify the success notification.

Expected Result: The leave request is created with **Pending** status, appears in *My requests*, and your manager and HR receive notifications.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [04 — Leave management]

Notes: The form blocks requests that exceed your balance, overlap an existing pending/approved request, or exceed the type's maximum consecutive days. Unpaid leave has no limit and is deducted pro rata in payroll.

Cancelling a request

Purpose: Withdraw a request you no longer need.

Who can use it: Everyone.

Navigation: My Leave → My requests → Cancel

Steps:

1. Click **Cancel** on a pending (or future approved) request.
2. Confirm with **Cancel request**.

Expected Result: The status changes to **Cancelled** and the days return to your balance.

Leave calendar and policies

Purpose: See who is away and read the rules.

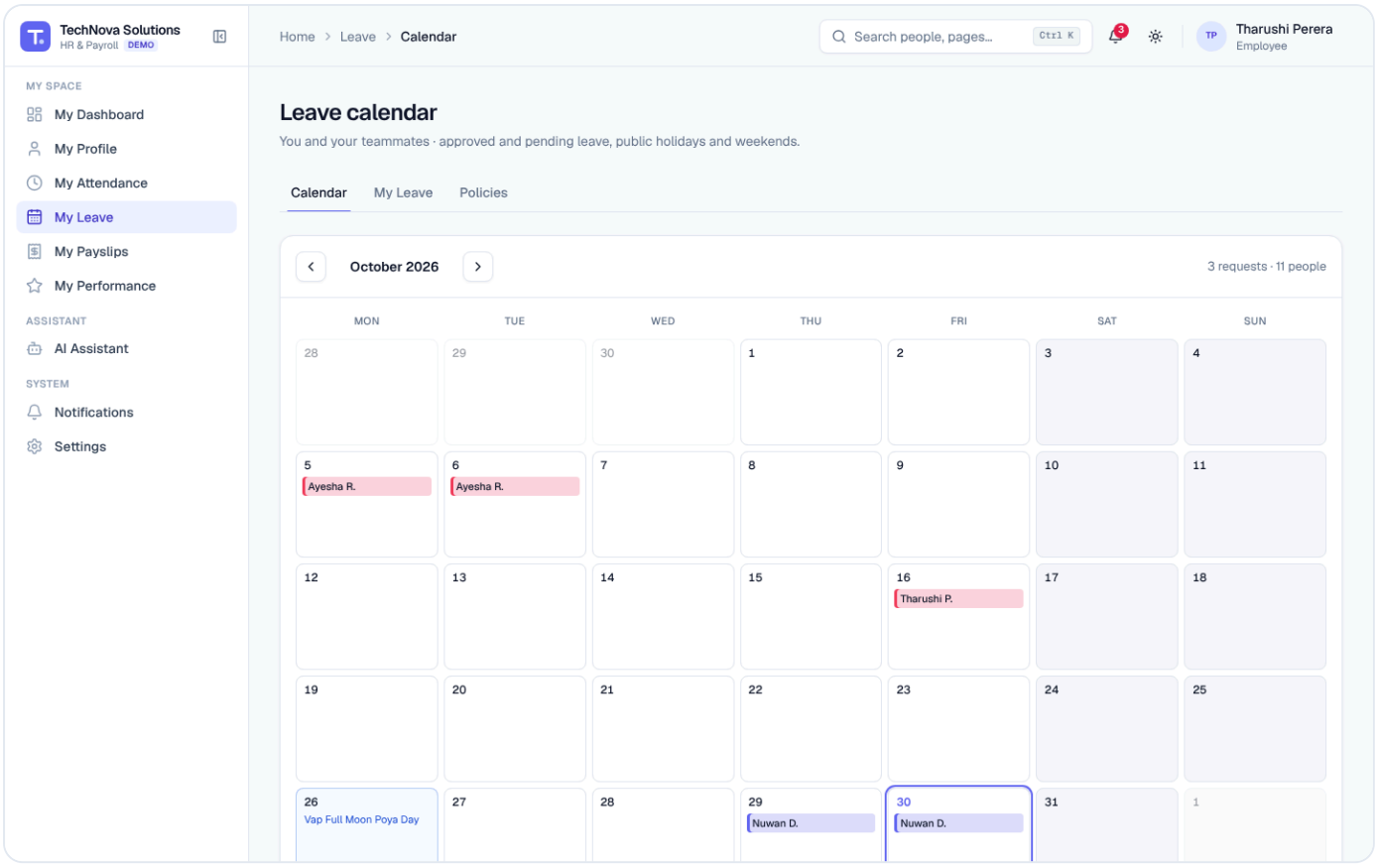
Who can use it: Everyone (scope depends on role).

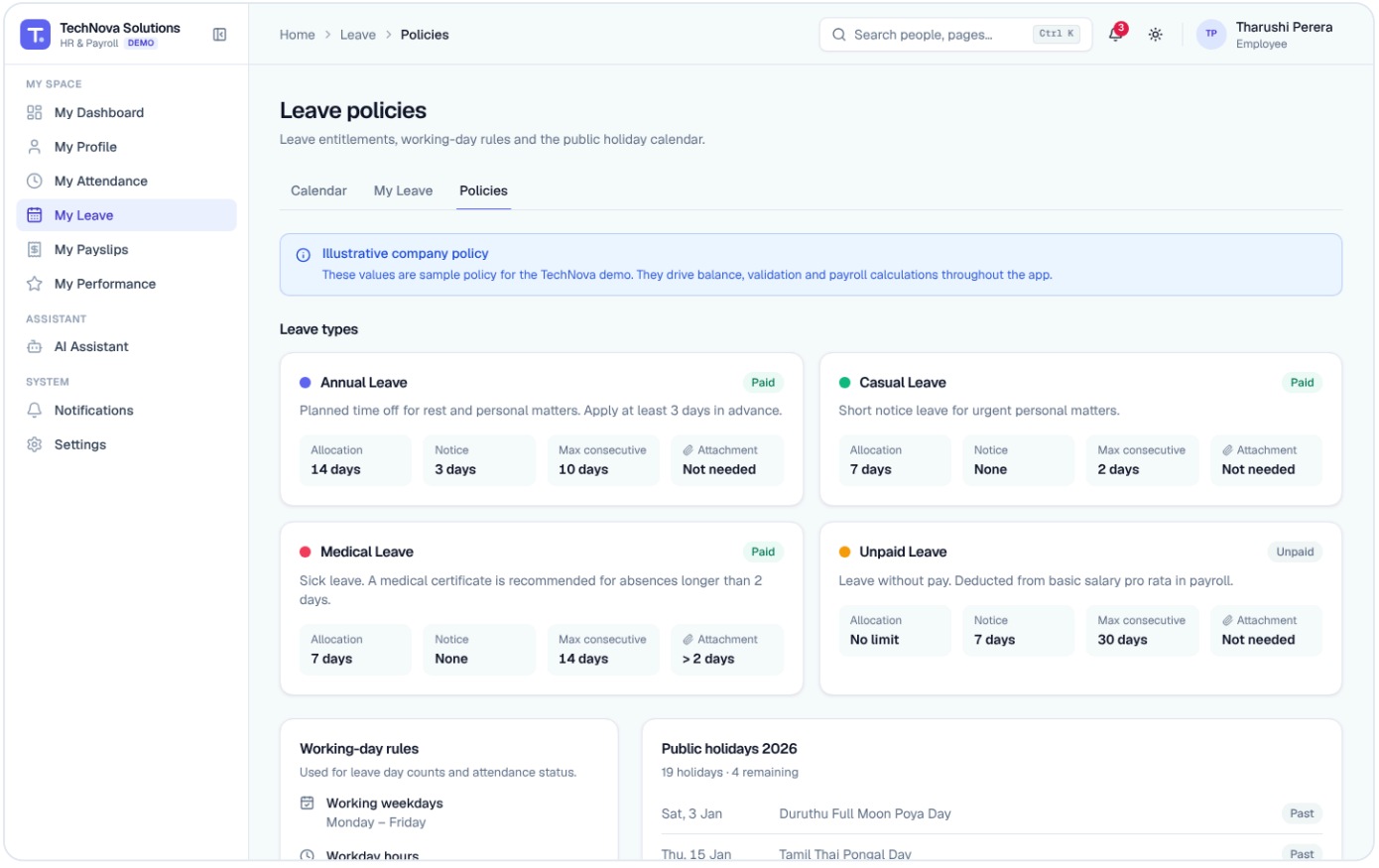
Navigation: Leave → Calendar / Policies

Steps:

1. On **Calendar**, move between months. Approved leave is shown as solid chips, pending leave as outlined chips, plus public holidays and weekends.
2. On **Policies**, review each leave type's allocation, notice period, maximum consecutive days and attachment rules, the working-day rules and the public holiday list.

Screenshot:





Notes: Policy values are illustrative and can be changed in **Settings → Leave policies**.

8. Leave approvals

Approving or rejecting a leave request

Purpose: Decide on leave requests from your people.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager (everyone), Team Lead (direct reports).

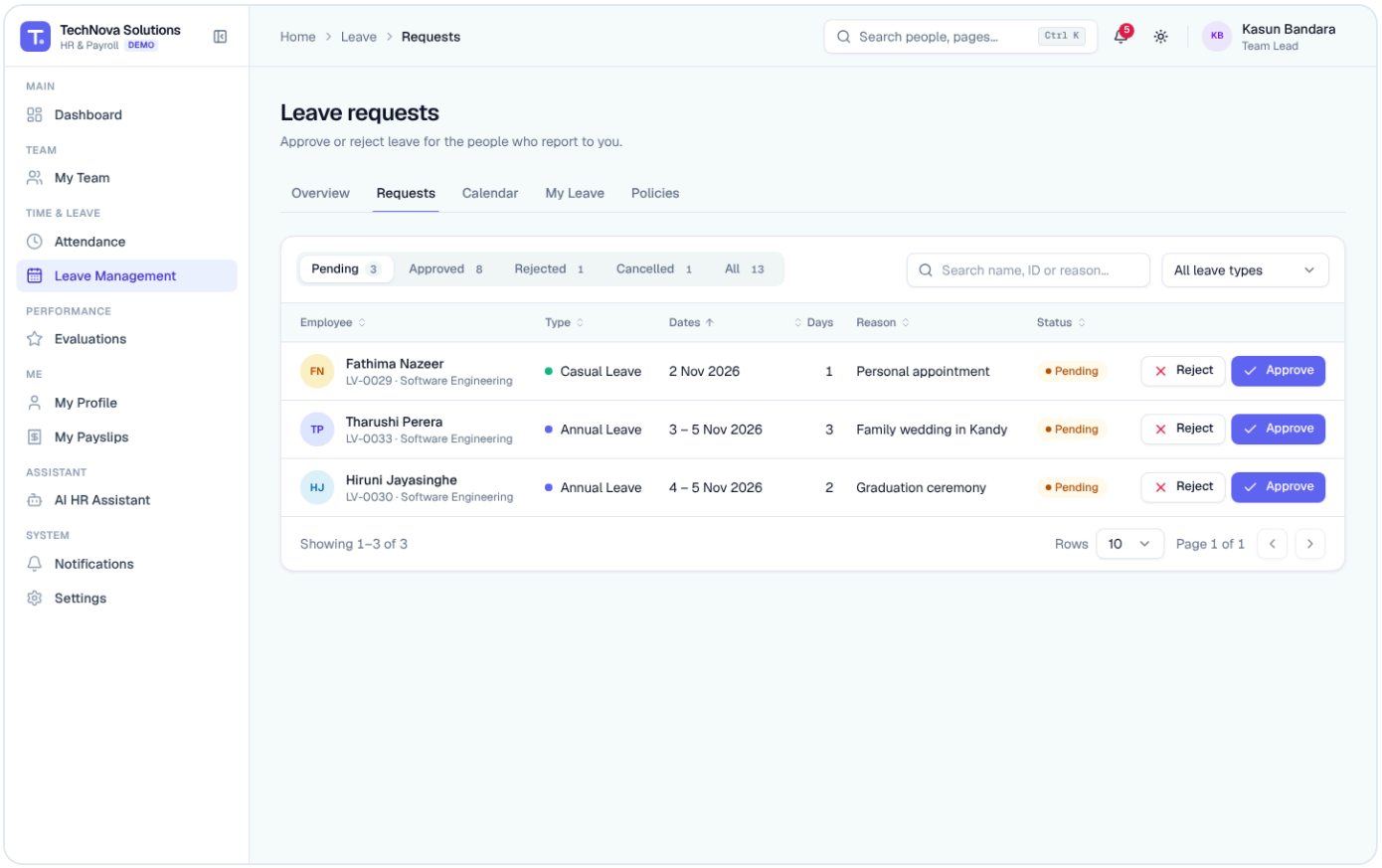
Navigation: Sidebar → Leave Management → Requests

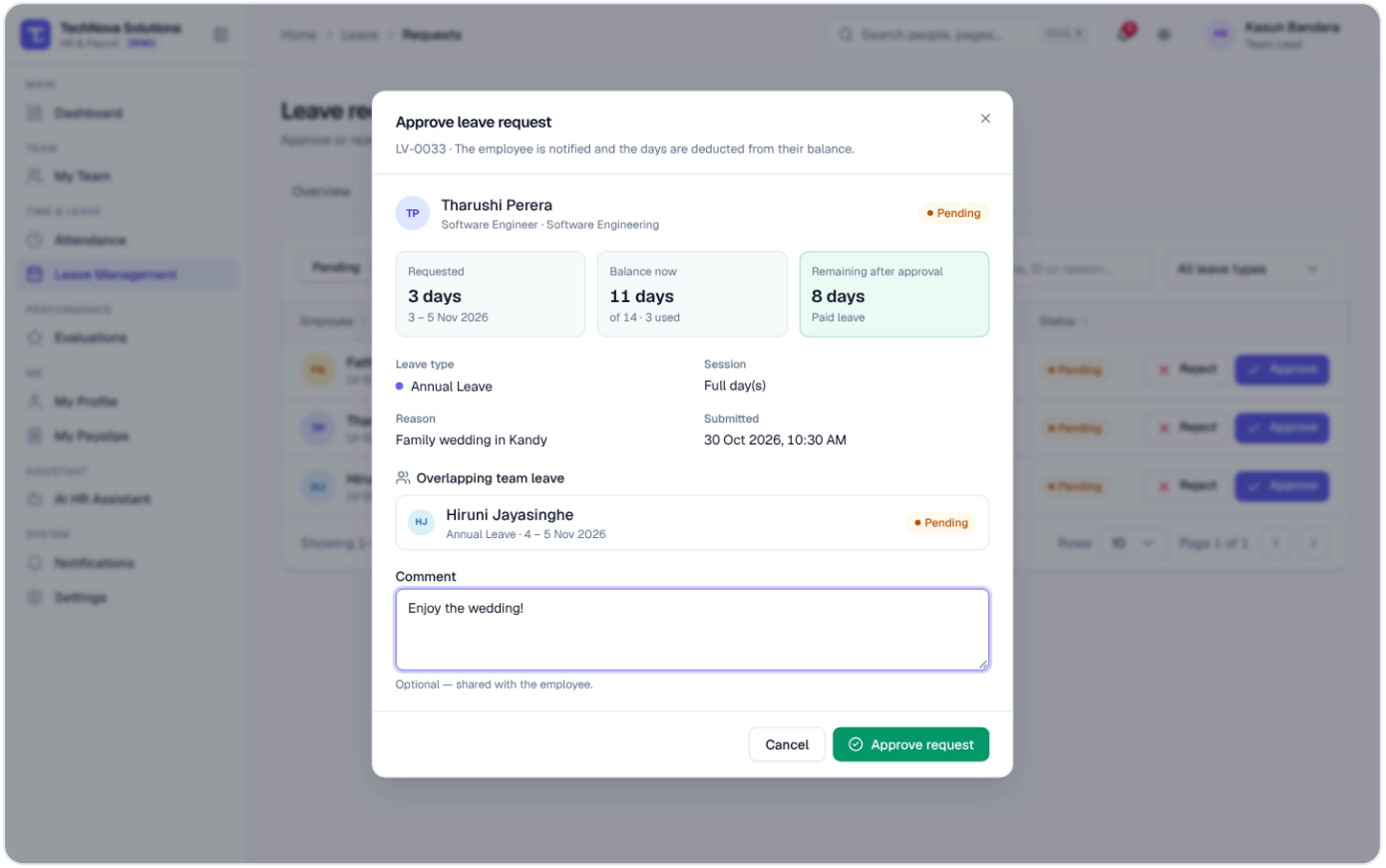
Steps:

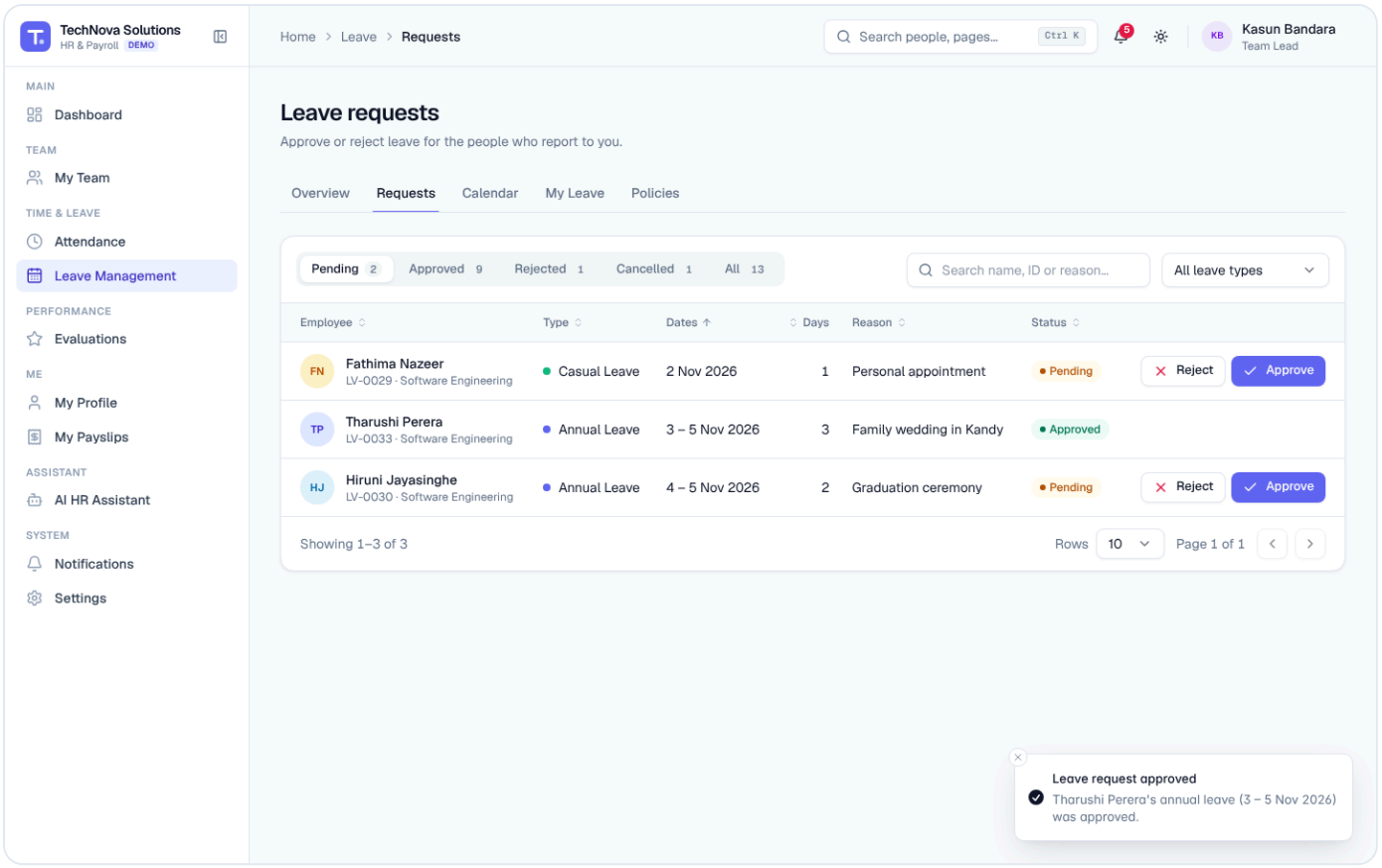
1. Open the **Pending** tab (the default). Search or filter by leave type if needed.
2. Click **Approve** (or **Reject**) on the request.
3. In the dialog, review the dates, the employee's remaining balance and any overlapping team leave.
4. Add a **Comment** (optional for approval, required for rejection).
5. Click **Approve request** (or **Reject request**).

Expected Result: The row shows the new status, the employee gets a notification and their balance updates. The employee sees the decision under *My Leave*.

Screenshot:


TechNova Solutions
HR & Payroll DEMO
Home > Leave > Requests
Search people, pages... Ctrl K
Kasun Bandara
Team Lead
MAIN
Dashboard
TEAM
My Team
TIME & LEAVE
Attendance
Leave Management
PERFORMANCE
Evaluations
ME
My Profile
My Payslips
ASSISTANT
AI HR Assistant
SYSTEM
Notifications
Settings
Leave requests
Approve or reject leave for the people who report to you.
Overview
Requests
Calendar
My Leave
Policies
Pending 3
Approved 8
Rejected 1
Cancelled 1
All 13
Search name, ID or reason...
All leave types
Employee
Type
Dates
Days
Reason
Status
FN
Fathima Nazeer
LV-0029 · Software Engineering
Casual Leave
2 Nov 2026
1
Personal appointment
Pending
Reject
Approve
TP
Tharushi Perera
LV-0033 · Software Engineering
Annual Leave
3 – 5 Nov 2026
3
Family wedding in Kandy
Pending
Reject
Approve
HJ
Hiruni Jayasinghe
LV-0030 · Software Engineering
Annual Leave
4 – 5 Nov 2026
2
Graduation ceremony
Pending
Reject
Approve
Showing 1–3 of 3
Rows 10
Page 1 of 1


Approve leave request
LV-0033 · The employee is notified and the days are deducted from their balance.
TP
Tharushi Perera
Software Engineer · Software Engineering
Pending
Requested
3 days
3 – 5 Nov 2026
Balance now
11 days
of 14 · 3 used
Remaining after approval
8 days
Paid leave
Leave type
Annual Leave
Session
Full day(s)
Reason
Family wedding in Kandy
Submitted
30 Oct 2026, 10:30 AM
Overlapping team leave
HJ
Hiruni Jayasinghe
Annual Leave · 4 – 5 Nov 2026
Pending
Comment
Enjoy the wedding!
Optional — shared with the employee.
Cancel
Approve request



Video Walkthrough: [04 — Leave management]

Leave overview

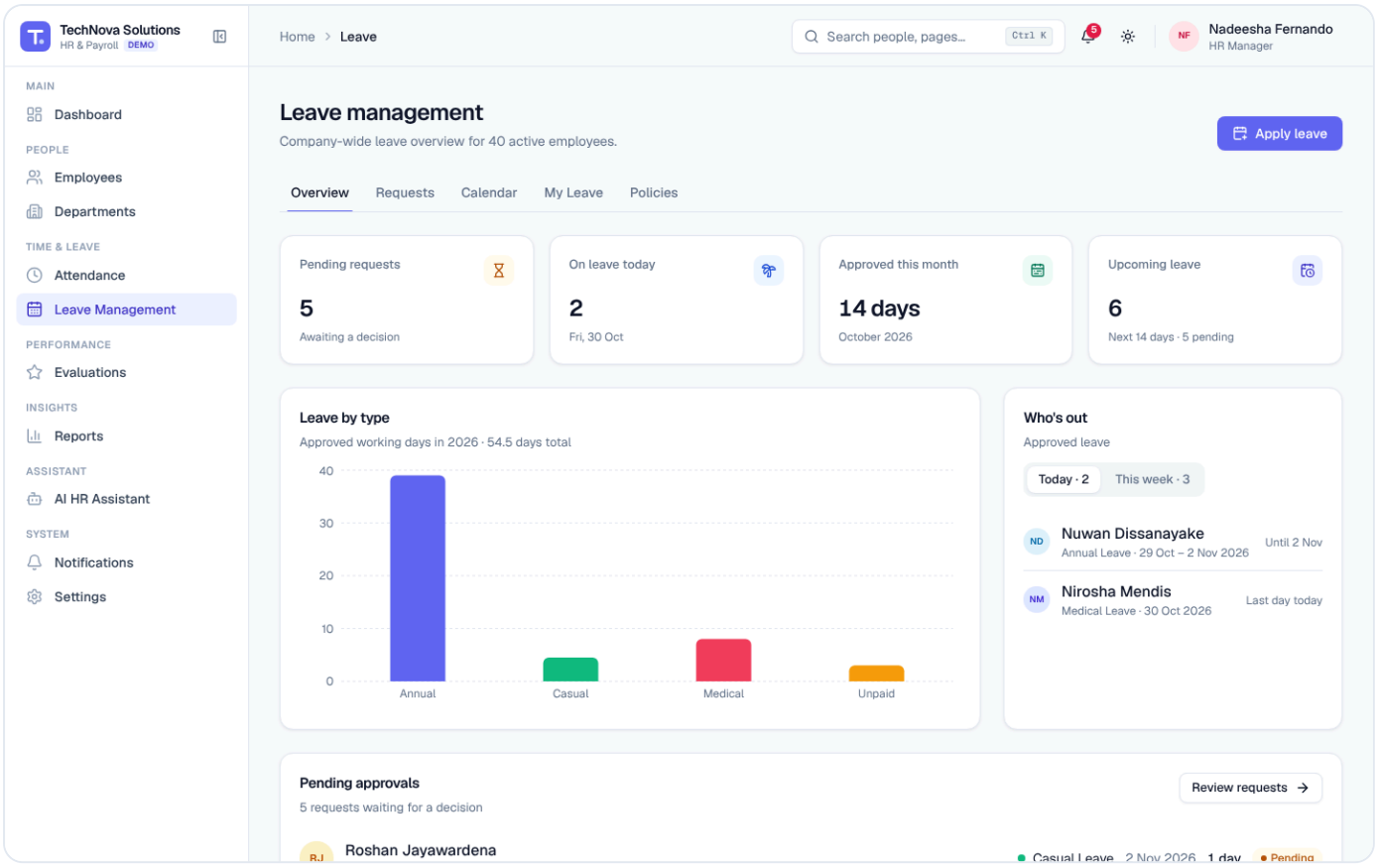
Purpose: Understand leave across the organisation.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager, Team Lead.

Navigation: Leave Management → Overview

Steps: Review pending requests, who is on leave today, approved days this month, upcoming leave, leave by type and who's out this week.

Screenshot:


TechNova Solutions
HR & Payroll DEMO
MAIN
Dashboard
PEOPLE
Employees
Departments
TIME & LEAVE
Attendance
Leave Management
PERFORMANCE
Evaluations
INSIGHTS
Reports
ASSISTANT
AI HR Assistant
SYSTEM
Notifications
Settings
Home > Leave
Search people, pages... Ctrl K
Nadeesha Fernando
HR Manager
Leave management
Company-wide leave overview for 40 active employees.
Apply leave
Overview
Requests
Calendar
My Leave
Policies
Pending requests
5
Awaiting a decision
On leave today
2
Fri, 30 Oct
Approved this month
14 days
October 2026
Upcoming leave
6
Next 14 days · 5 pending
Leave by type
Approved working days in 2026 · 54.5 days total
40
30
20
10
0
Annual
Casual
Medical
Unpaid
Who's out
Approved leave
Today · 2
This week · 3
Nuwan Dissanayake
Annual Leave · 29 Oct – 2 Nov 2026
Until 2 Nov
Nirosha Mendis
Medical Leave · 30 Oct 2026
Last day today
Pending approvals
5 requests waiting for a decision
Review requests
Roshan Jayawardena
Casual Leave 2 Nov 2026 1 day Pending

9. Payroll processing

Payroll dashboard

Purpose: See the payroll position at a glance.

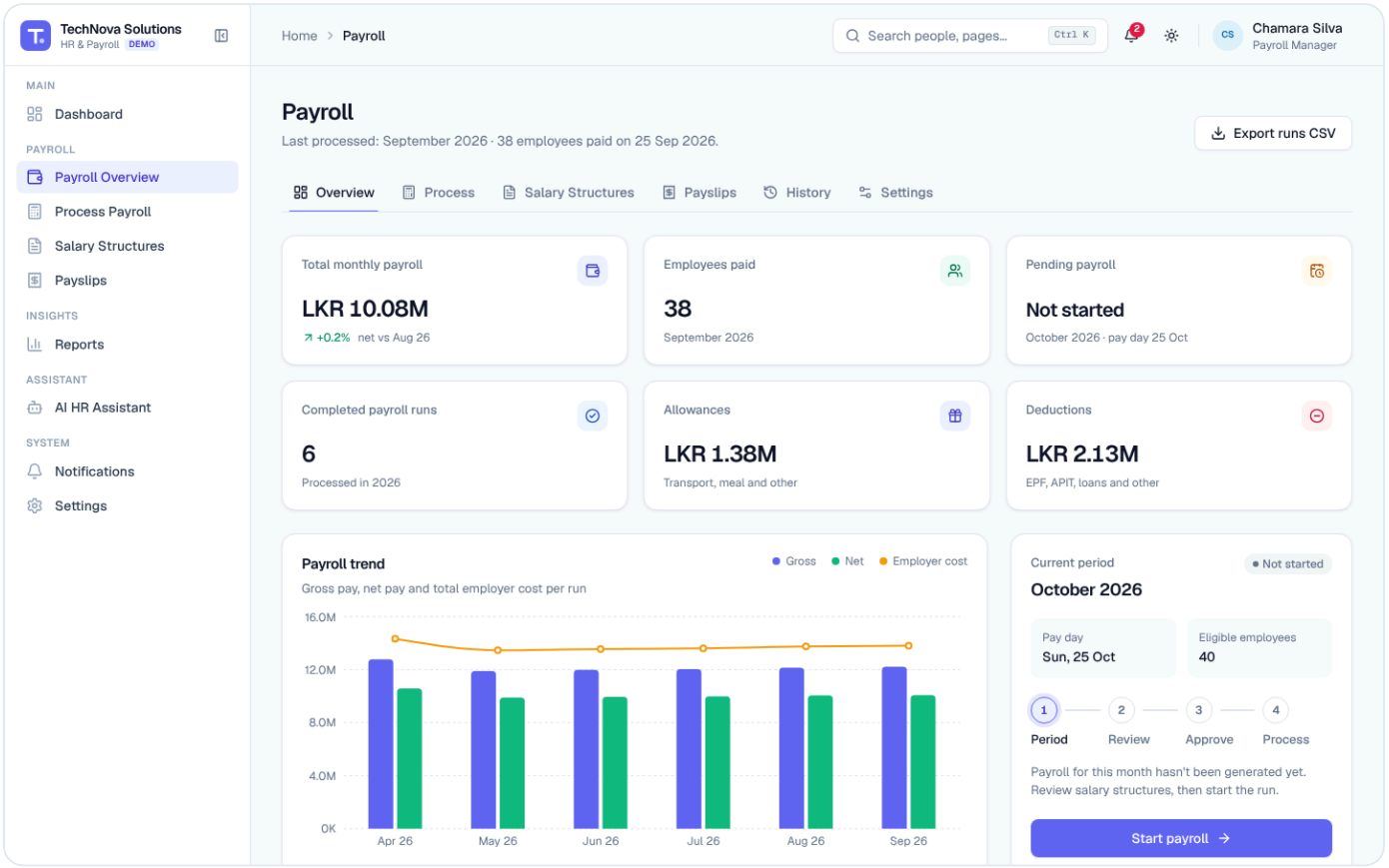
Who can use it: Admin, Payroll Manager.

Navigation: Sidebar → Payroll Overview

Steps:

1. Review **Total monthly payroll** (latest processed net, with change vs. the previous run), **Employees paid**, **Pending payroll** (current month status), **Completed payroll runs**, **Allowances** and **Deductions**.
2. Hover the **Payroll trend** chart (gross, net and employer cost per run).
3. Use the **Current period** card to start or continue this month's payroll.
4. Click **Export runs CSV** to download a summary of every run.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 05 — Payroll management

Running monthly payroll

Purpose: Calculate, review, approve and process salaries for a month, then generate payslips.

Who can use it: Admin, Payroll Manager (in this demo both may approve).

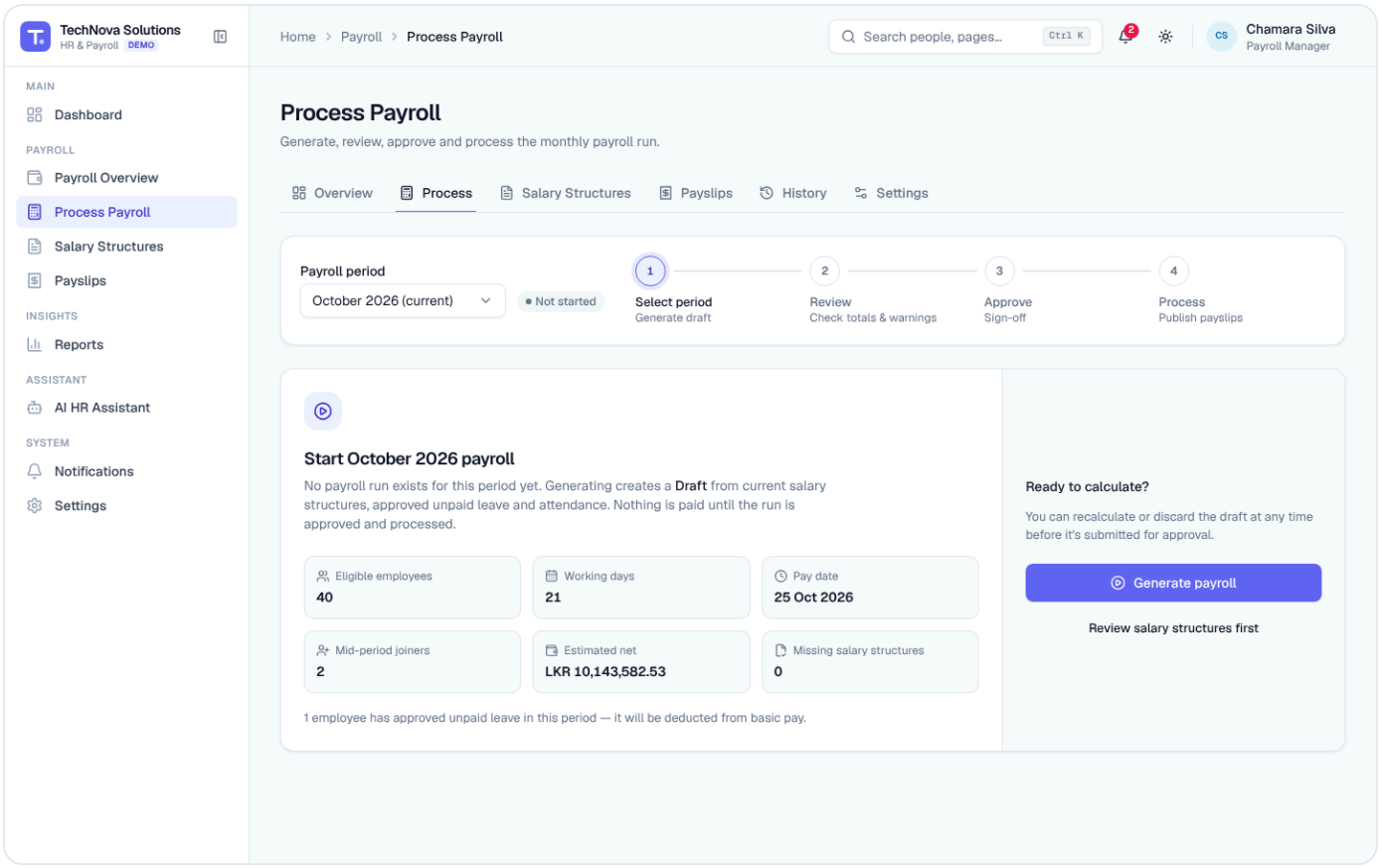
Navigation: Sidebar → Process Payroll

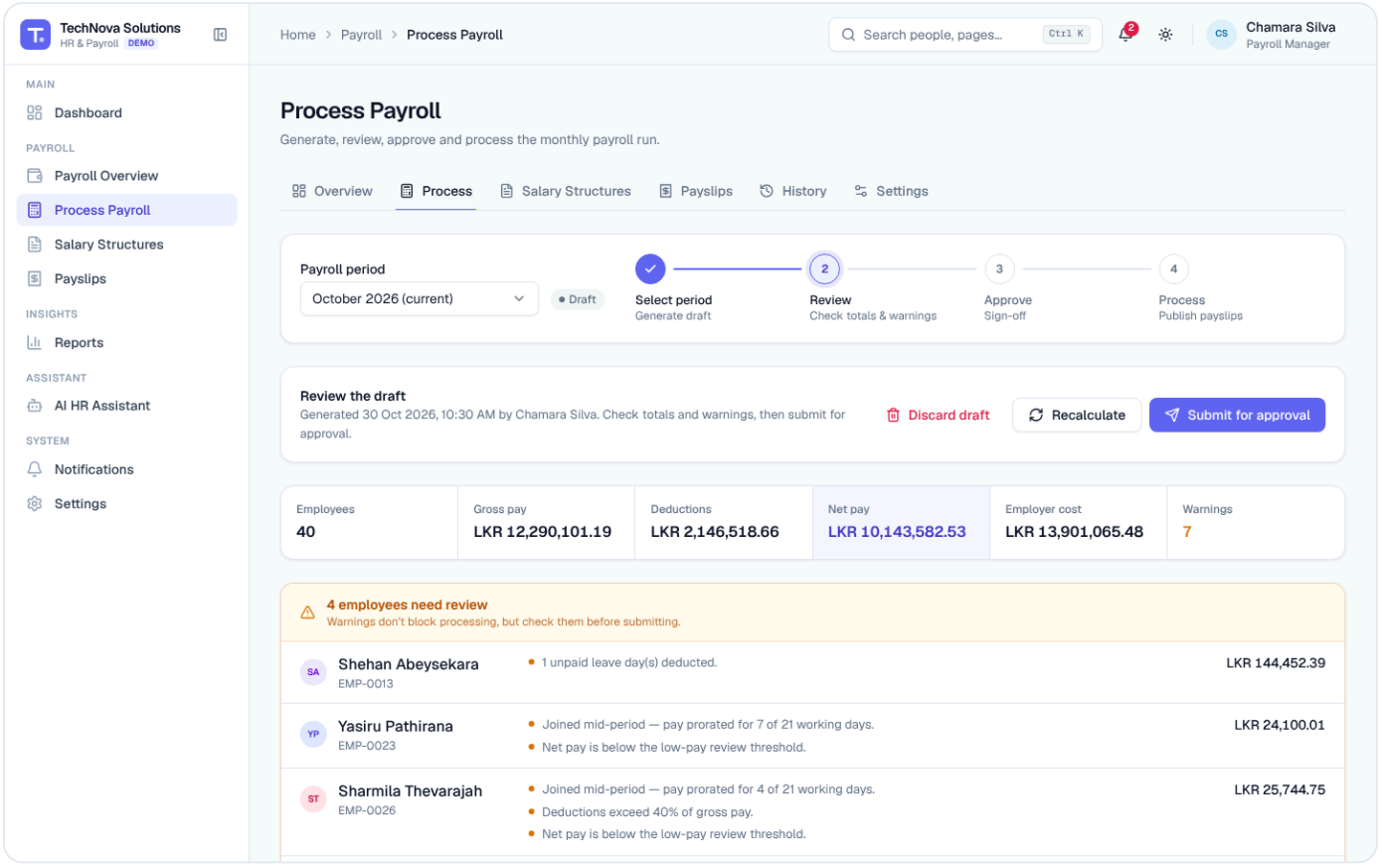
Steps:

1. Select the **Payroll period** (defaults to the current month).
2. Click **Generate payroll**. The deterministic engine calculates earnings, deductions and net pay for every eligible employee.
3. Review the totals strip (employees, gross, deductions, net, employer cost, warnings).
4. Review the **warnings** panel — for example mid-month joiners (pro-rated pay), unpaid leave deductions, unexplained absences or deductions above 40% of gross.
5. Search the preview table and click any row to open the full **Payroll breakdown**.
6. Use **Recalculate** after changing salary structures, or **Discard draft** to start again.
7. Click **Submit for approval** → status becomes **Pending Approval**.
8. Click **Approve payroll** and confirm → status becomes **Approved**.
9. Click **Process payroll**, read the confirmation (*Process payroll for October 2026?*) and click **Process payroll**.
10. Click **View payslips**.

Expected Result: The run is marked **Processed**, payslips are generated for every employee in the run, each employee is notified, and the dashboard and reports include the new month.

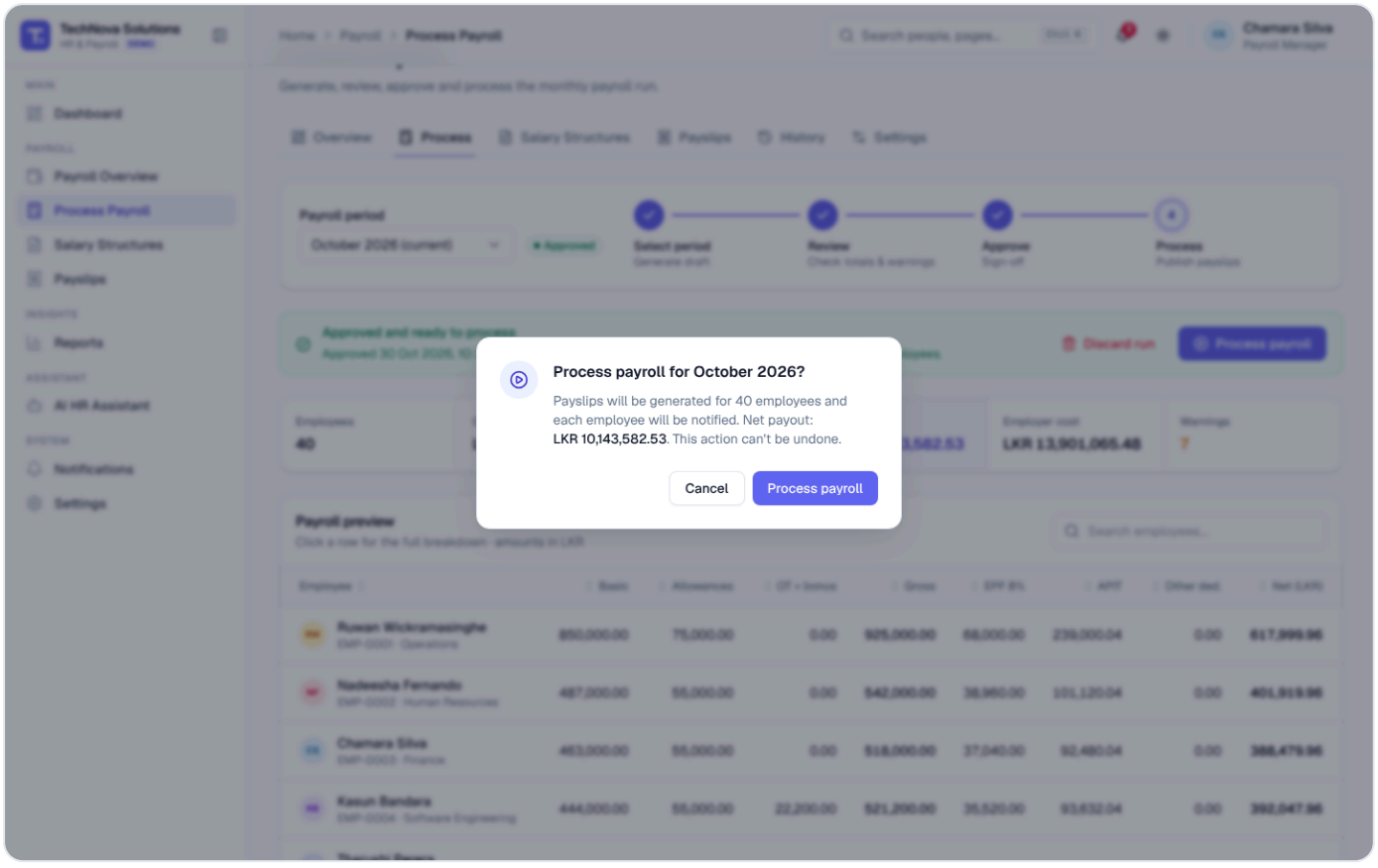
Screenshot:

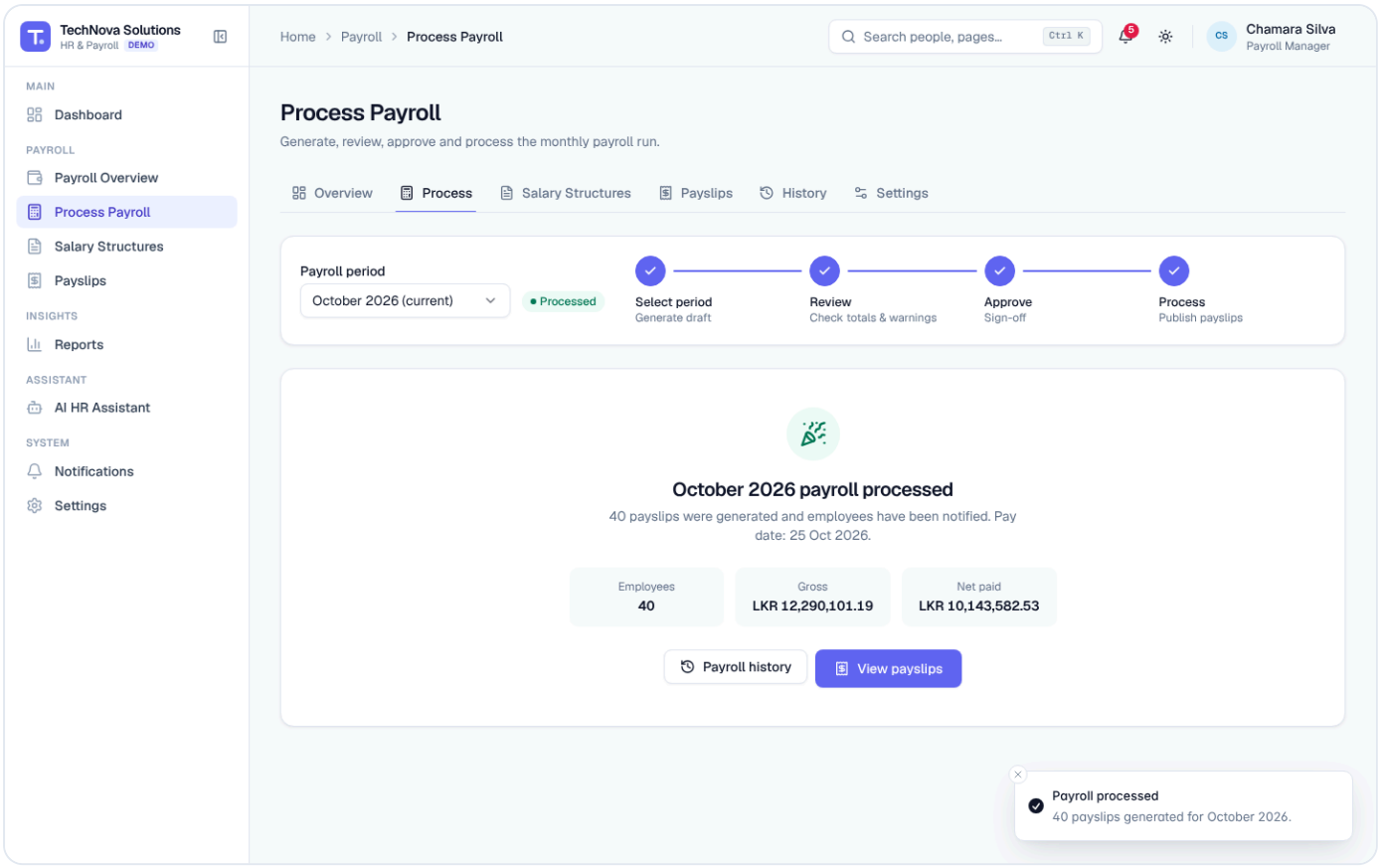

TechNova Solutions
HR & Payroll DEMO
MAIN
Dashboard
PAYROLL
Payroll Overview
Process Payroll
Salary Structures
Payslips
INSIGHTS
Reports
ASSISTANT
AI HR Assistant
SYSTEM
Notifications
Settings
Home > Payroll > Process Payroll
Search people, pages... Ctrl K
Chamara Silva
Payroll Manager
Process Payroll
Generate, review, approve and process the monthly payroll run.
Overview
Process
Salary Structures
Payslips
History
Settings
Payroll period
October 2026 (current)
Not started
1 Select period Generate draft
2 Review Check totals & warnings
3 Approve Sign-off
4 Process Publish payslips
Start October 2026 payroll
No payroll run exists for this period yet. Generating creates a Draft from current salary structures, approved unpaid leave and attendance. Nothing is paid until the run is approved and processed.
Eligible employees
40
Working days
21
Pay date
25 Oct 2026
Mid-period joiners
2
Estimated net
LKR 10,143,582.53
Missing salary structures
0
1 employee has approved unpaid leave in this period — it will be deducted from basic pay.
Ready to calculate?
You can recalculate or discard the draft at any time before it's submitted for approval.
Generate payroll
Review salary structures first


TechNova Solutions
HR & Payroll DEMO
MAIN
Dashboard
PAYROLL
Payroll Overview
Process Payroll
Salary Structures
Payslips
INSIGHTS
Reports
ASSISTANT
AI HR Assistant
SYSTEM
Notifications
Settings
Home > Payroll > Process Payroll
Search people, pages... Ctrl K
Chamara Silva
Payroll Manager
Process Payroll
Generate, review, approve and process the monthly payroll run.
Overview
Process
Salary Structures
Payslips
History
Settings
Payroll period
October 2026 (current)
Draft
Select period Generate draft
2 Review Check totals & warnings
3 Approve Sign-off
4 Process Publish payslips
Review the draft
Generated 30 Oct 2026, 10:30 AM by Chamara Silva. Check totals and warnings, then submit for approval.
Discard draft
Recalculate
Submit for approval
Employees 40
Gross pay LKR 12,290,101.19
Deductions LKR 2,146,518.66
Net pay LKR 10,143,582.53
Employer cost LKR 13,901,065.48
Warnings 7
4 employees need review
Warnings don't block processing, but check them before submitting.
Shehan Abeysekara EMP-0013
1 unpaid leave day(s) deducted.
LKR 144,452.39
Yasiru Pathirana EMP-0023
Joined mid-period — pay prorated for 7 of 21 working days.
Net pay is below the low-pay review threshold.
LKR 24,100.01
Sharmila Thevarajah EMP-0026
Joined mid-period — pay prorated for 4 of 21 working days.
Deductions exceed 40% of gross pay.
Net pay is below the low-pay review threshold.
LKR 25,744.75

4 employees need review
Warnings don't block processing, but check them before submitting.

SA Shehan Abeysekara EMP-0013	• 1 unpaid leave day(s) deducted.	LKR 144,452.39
YP Yasiru Pathirana EMP-0023	• Joined mid-period — pay prorated for 7 of 21 working days. • Net pay is below the low-pay review threshold.	LKR 24,100.01
ST Sharmila Thevarajah EMP-0026	• Joined mid-period — pay prorated for 4 of 21 working days. • Deductions exceed 40% of gross pay. • Net pay is below the low-pay review threshold.	LKR 25,744.75
TR Tharindu Rodrigo EMP-0036	• 3 unexplained absences recorded — verify before processing.	LKR 242,399.96





Video Walkthrough: 05 — Payroll management

Notes:

- Statuses: **Draft → Pending Approval → Approved → Processed**.
- A processed period can't be processed again — the page shows *This period has already been processed* and no Process button.
- Calculation (illustrative): gross = basic + allowances + overtime (basic ÷ 240 h × 1.5 × hours) + bonus. Deductions = EPF 8% of basic (after unpaid leave) + APIT (example monthly brackets) + loans + other deductions + unpaid leave (basic ÷ working days × days). Employer EPF 12% and ETF 3% are shown as employer cost.

Payroll history

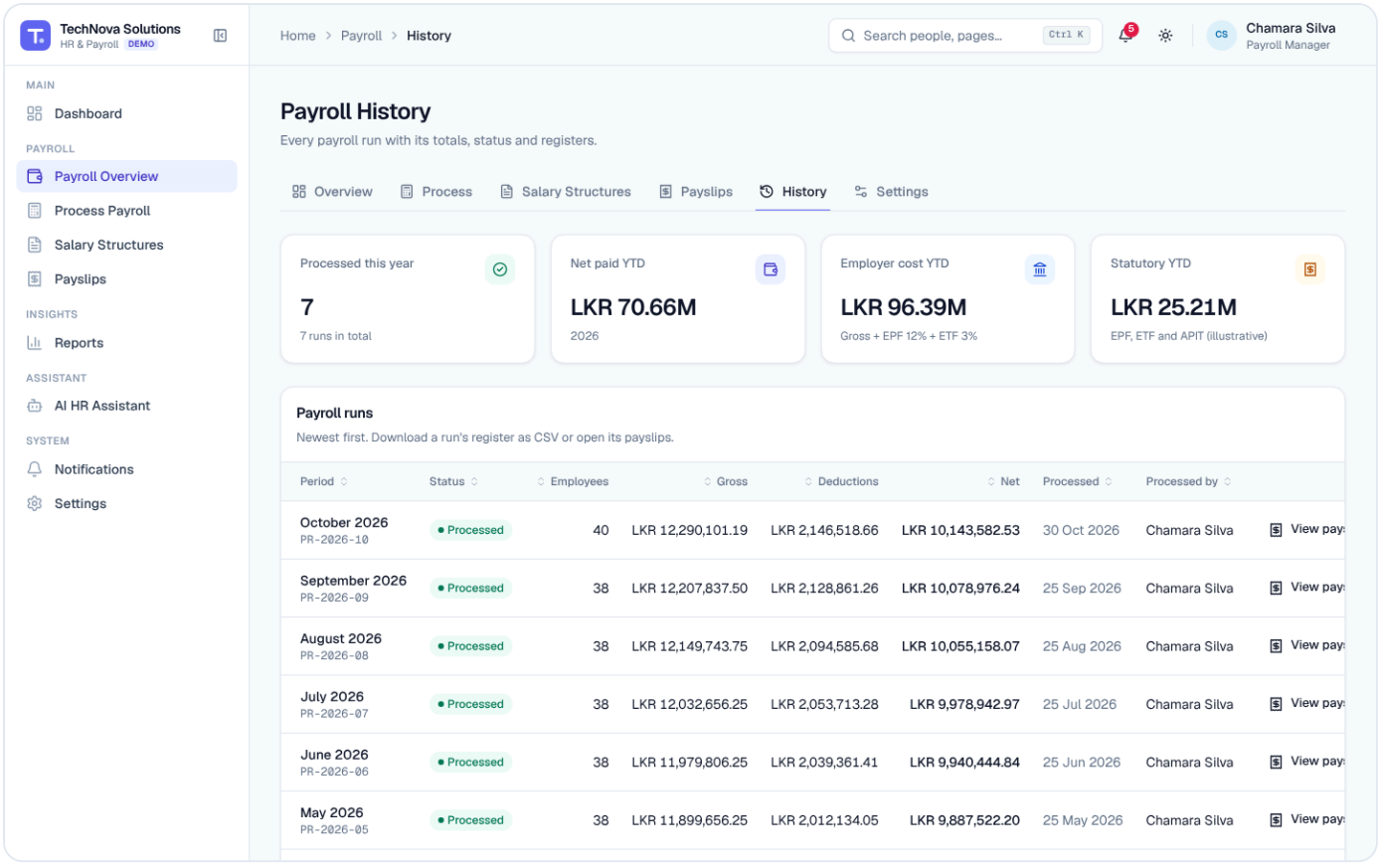
Purpose: Review past runs.

Who can use it: Admin, Payroll Manager.

Navigation: Payroll → History

Steps: Review each run's period, status, employee count, gross, deductions, net and who processed it. Use **View payslips for …** or **Download CSV for …** to export a payroll register.

Screenshot:


TechNova Solutions
HR & Payroll DEMO
Home > Payroll > History
Search people, pages... Ctrl K
Chamara Silva
Payroll Manager
MAIN
Dashboard
PAYROLL
Payroll Overview
Process Payroll
Salary Structures
Payslips
INSIGHTS
Reports
ASSISTANT
AI HR Assistant
SYSTEM
Notifications
Settings
Payroll History
Every payroll run with its totals, status and registers.
Overview
Process
Salary Structures
Payslips
History
Settings
Processed this year
7
7 runs in total
Net paid YTD
LKR 70.66M
2026
Employer cost YTD
LKR 96.39M
Gross + EPF 12% + ETF 3%
Statutory YTD
LKR 25.21M
EPF, ETF and APIT (illustrative)
Payroll runs
Newest first. Download a run's register as CSV or open its payslips.
Period
Status
Employees
Gross
Deductions
Net
Processed
Processed by
October 2026 PR-2026-10 Processed 40 LKR 12,290,101.19 LKR 2,146,518.66 LKR 10,143,582.53 30 Oct 2026 Chamara Silva View pays
September 2026 PR-2026-09 Processed 38 LKR 12,207,837.50 LKR 2,128,861.26 LKR 10,078,976.24 25 Sep 2026 Chamara Silva View pays
August 2026 PR-2026-08 Processed 38 LKR 12,149,743.75 LKR 2,094,585.68 LKR 10,055,158.07 25 Aug 2026 Chamara Silva View pays
July 2026 PR-2026-07 Processed 38 LKR 12,032,656.25 LKR 2,053,713.28 LKR 9,978,942.97 25 Jul 2026 Chamara Silva View pays
June 2026 PR-2026-06 Processed 38 LKR 11,979,806.25 LKR 2,039,361.41 LKR 9,940,444.84 25 Jun 2026 Chamara Silva View pays
May 2026 PR-2026-05 Processed 38 LKR 11,899,656.25 LKR 2,012,134.05 LKR 9,887,522.20 25 May 2026 Chamara Silva View pays

10. Salary structures

Editing an employee's salary structure

Purpose: Maintain each employee's pay components.

Who can use it: Admin, Payroll Manager.

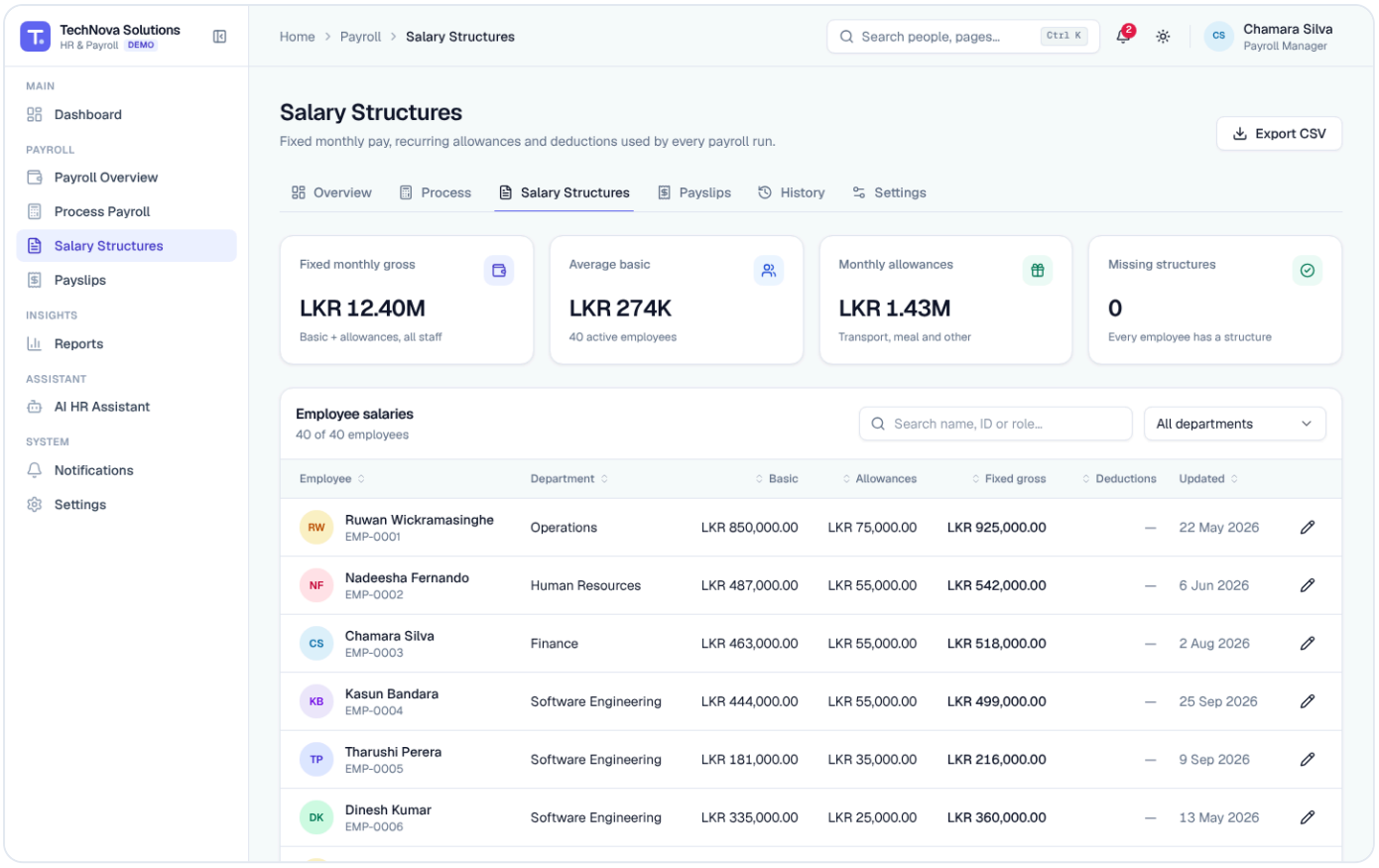
Navigation: Sidebar → Salary Structures

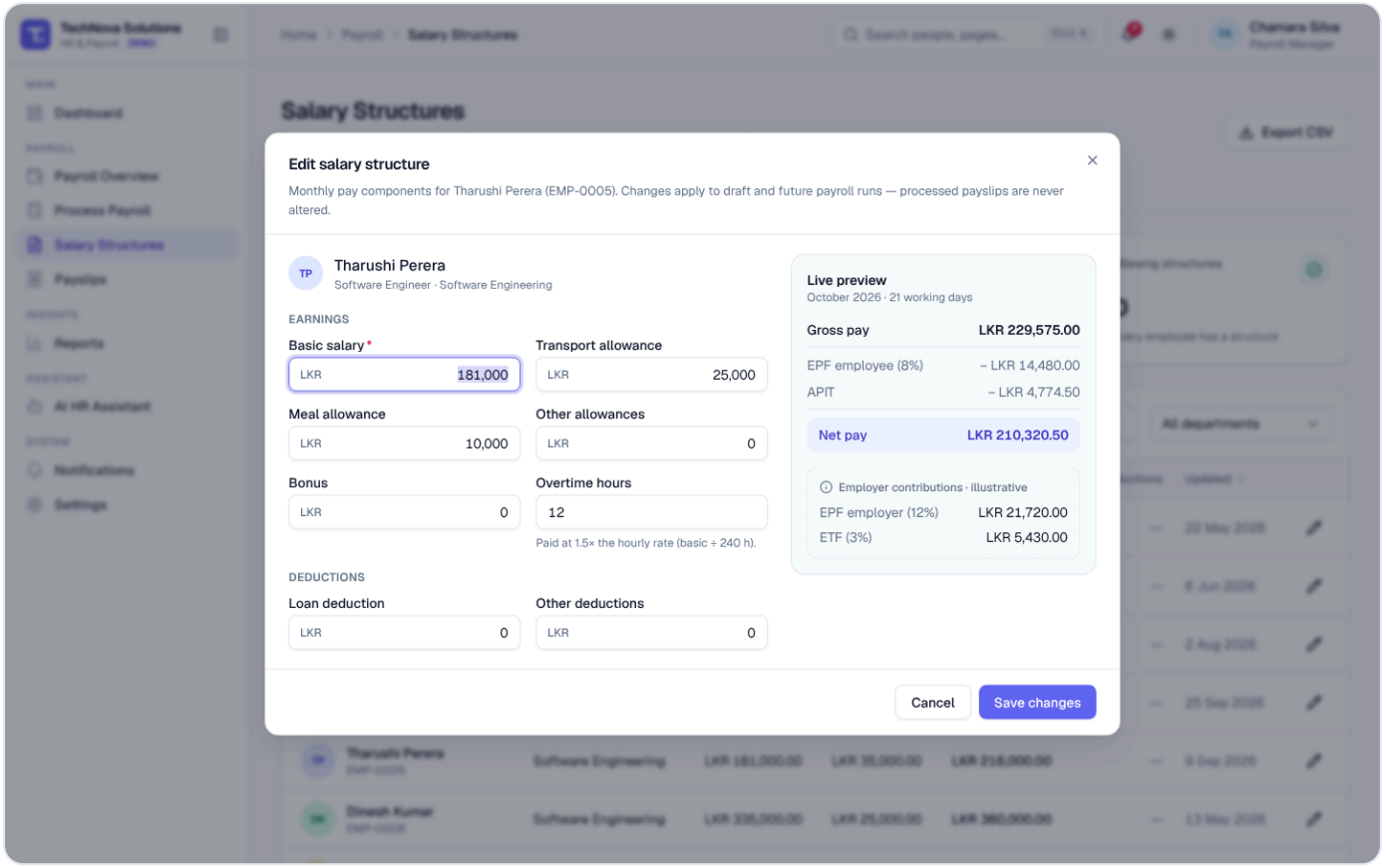
Steps:

1. Search or filter the **Employee salaries** table.
2. Click the edit button on a row (**Edit salary for EMP-…**).
3. Update **Basic salary**, **Transport allowance**, **Meal allowance**, **Other allowances**, **Bonus**, **Overtime hours**, **Loan deduction** or **Other deductions**.
4. Watch the **Live preview** (gross, EPF, APIT, net and employer contributions for the current month).
5. Click **Save changes**.

Expected Result: A "Salary structure updated" toast appears; the change applies to draft and future payroll runs (processed payslips are never altered).

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [05 — Payroll management]

Notes: All amounts must be zero or more. Click **Export CSV** to download the salary table.

Payroll settings

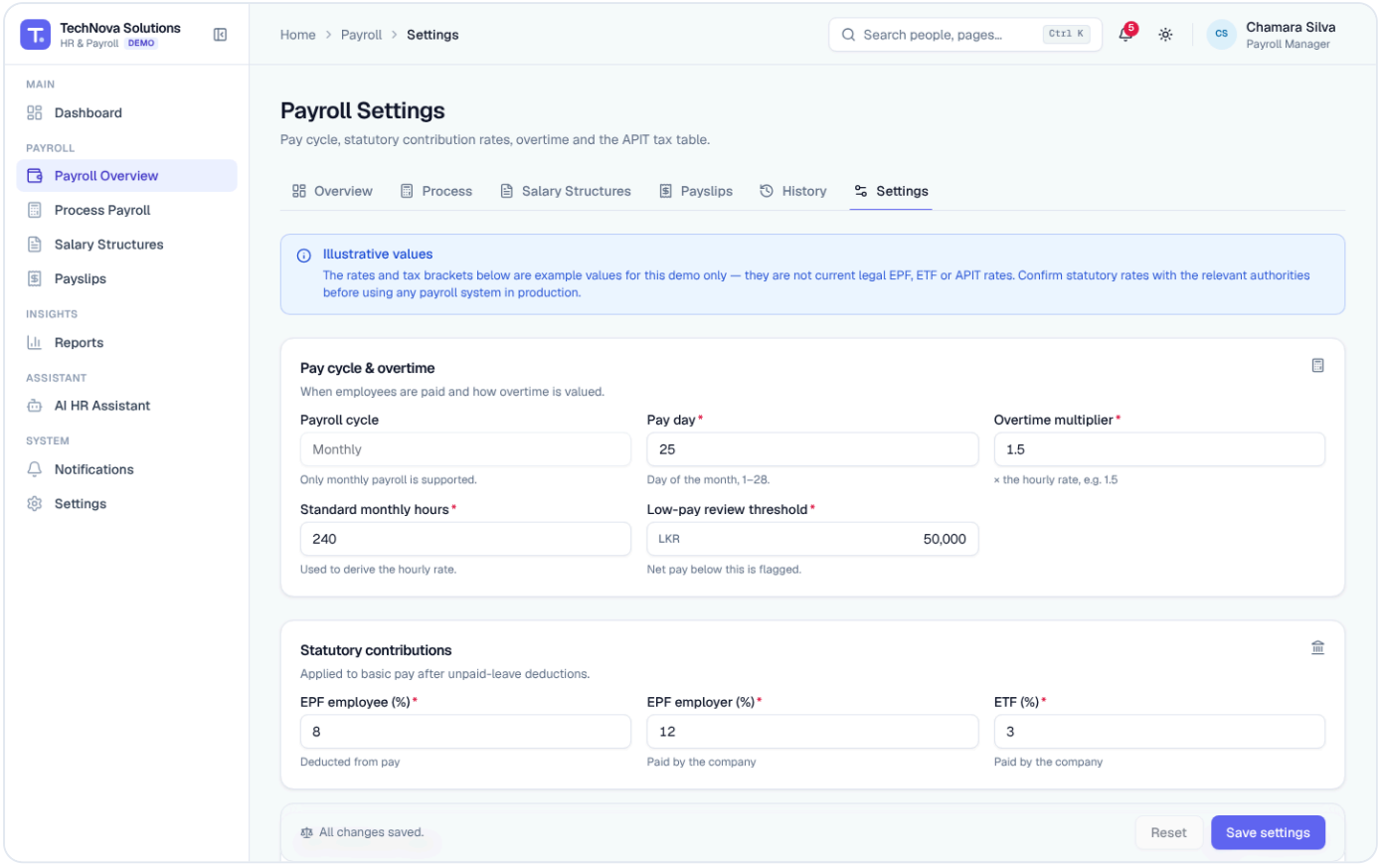
Purpose: Configure pay day, statutory example rates and APIT brackets.

Who can use it: Admin, Payroll Manager.

Navigation: Payroll → Settings (also Settings → Payroll)

Steps: Edit the pay day, overtime multiplier, standard monthly hours, low-pay review threshold, EPF/ETF percentages, enable/disable APIT and edit its brackets, then click **Save settings**.

Screenshot:



Notes: These are clearly labelled illustrative values, not current legal rates.

---

11. Payslips

Viewing, printing and downloading a payslip

Purpose: Access payslips generated by processed payroll runs.

Who can use it: Admin and Payroll Manager (all payslips); everyone else (their own — **My Payslips**).

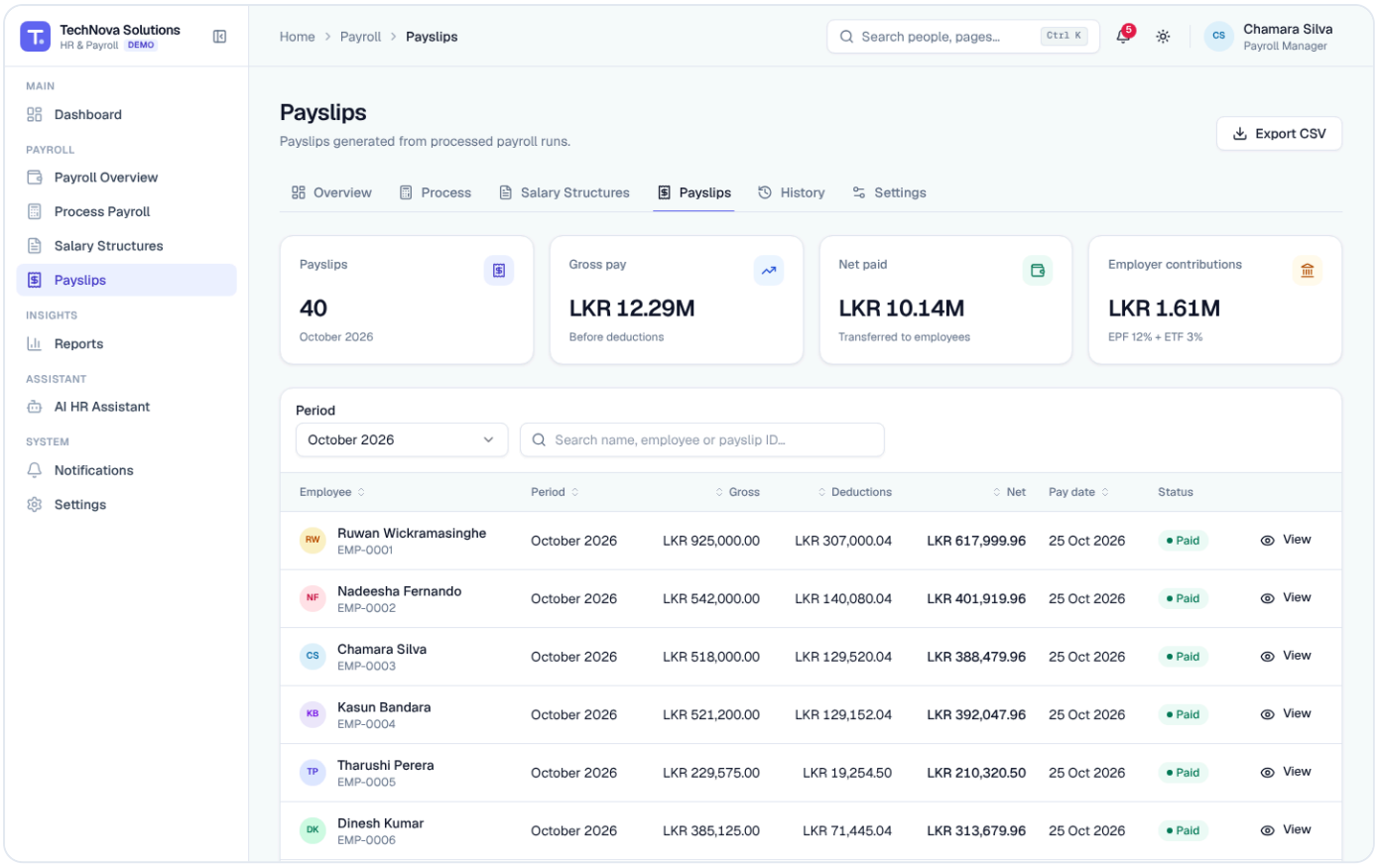
Navigation: Sidebar → Payslips / My Payslips

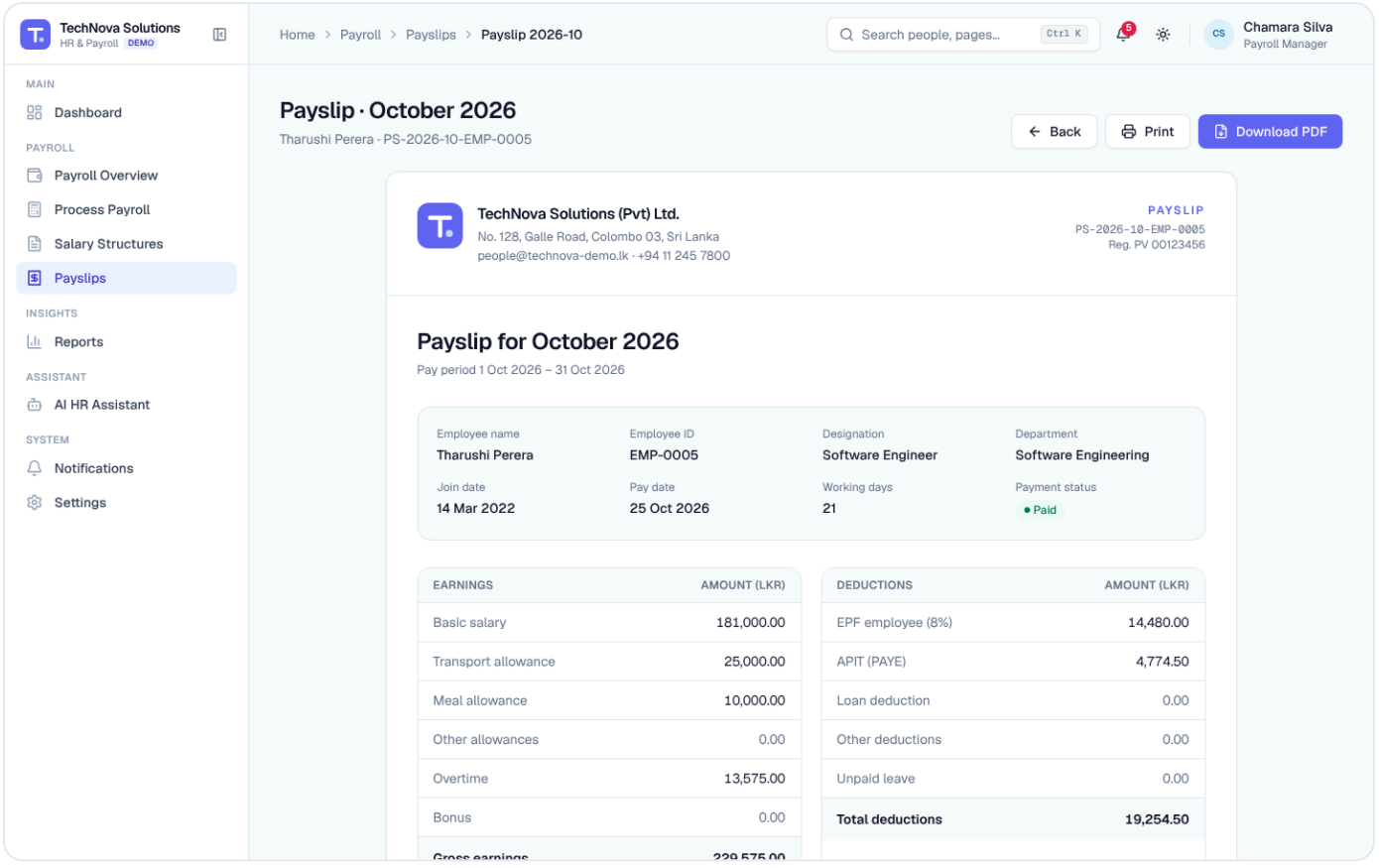
Steps:

1. Choose a **Period** and search (payroll roles), or open your **latest payslip** card (everyone else).
2. Click **View** on a payslip.
3. Review the company details, employee details, earnings, deductions, net pay and employer contributions.
4. Click **Print** for a clean printed copy, or **Download PDF** to save it.

Expected Result: A PDF named like `payslip-EMP-0005-2026-10.pdf` is downloaded and a toast confirms it.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [05 — Payroll management]

Notes: Opening someone else's payslip without permission shows an access message. Payslips print on white even in dark mode.

---

12. Performance evaluations

Creating and submitting an evaluation

Purpose: Record a manager review on a 1–5 scale across seven criteria.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager, Team Lead (direct reports).

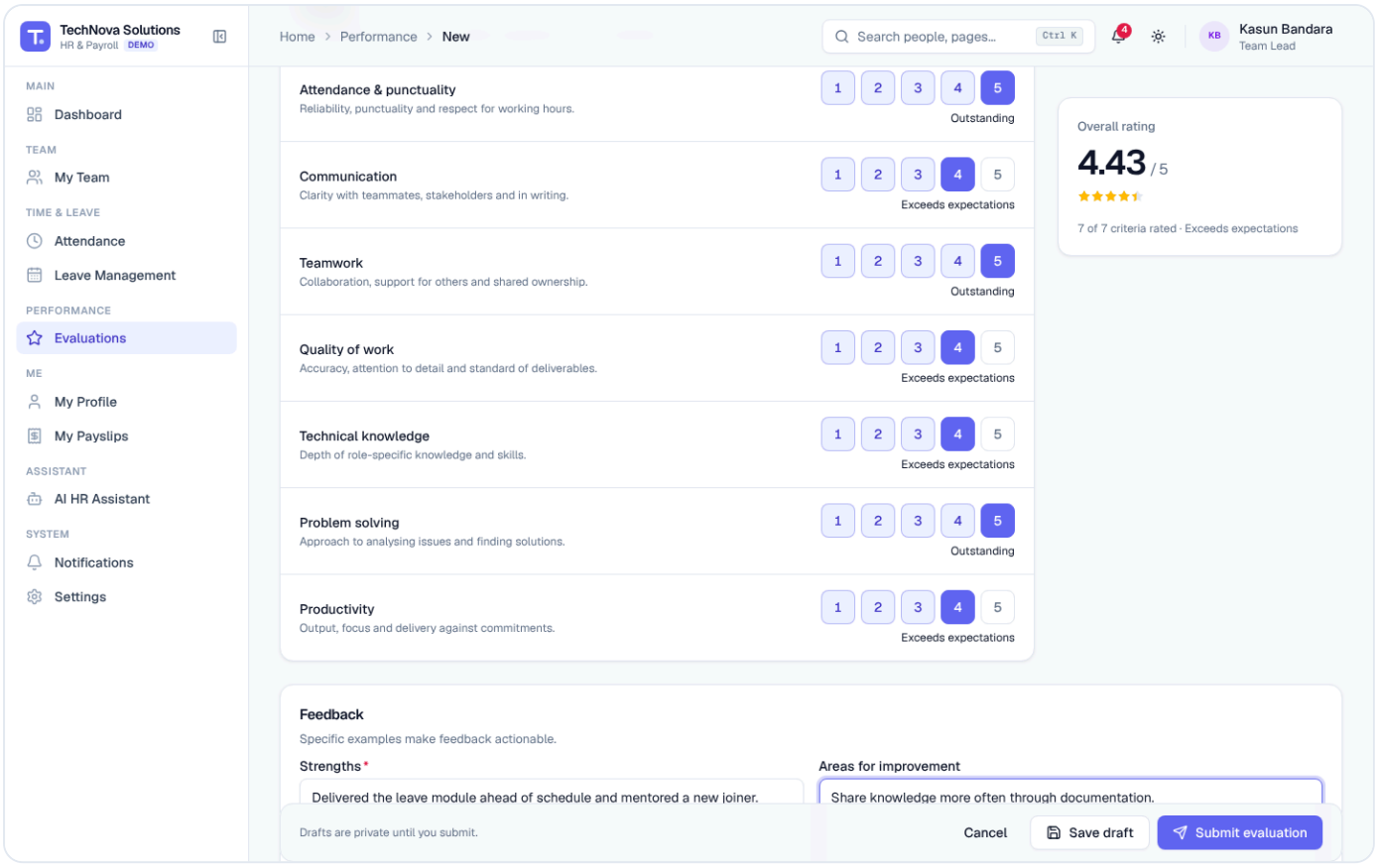
Navigation: Sidebar → Evaluations → New evaluation

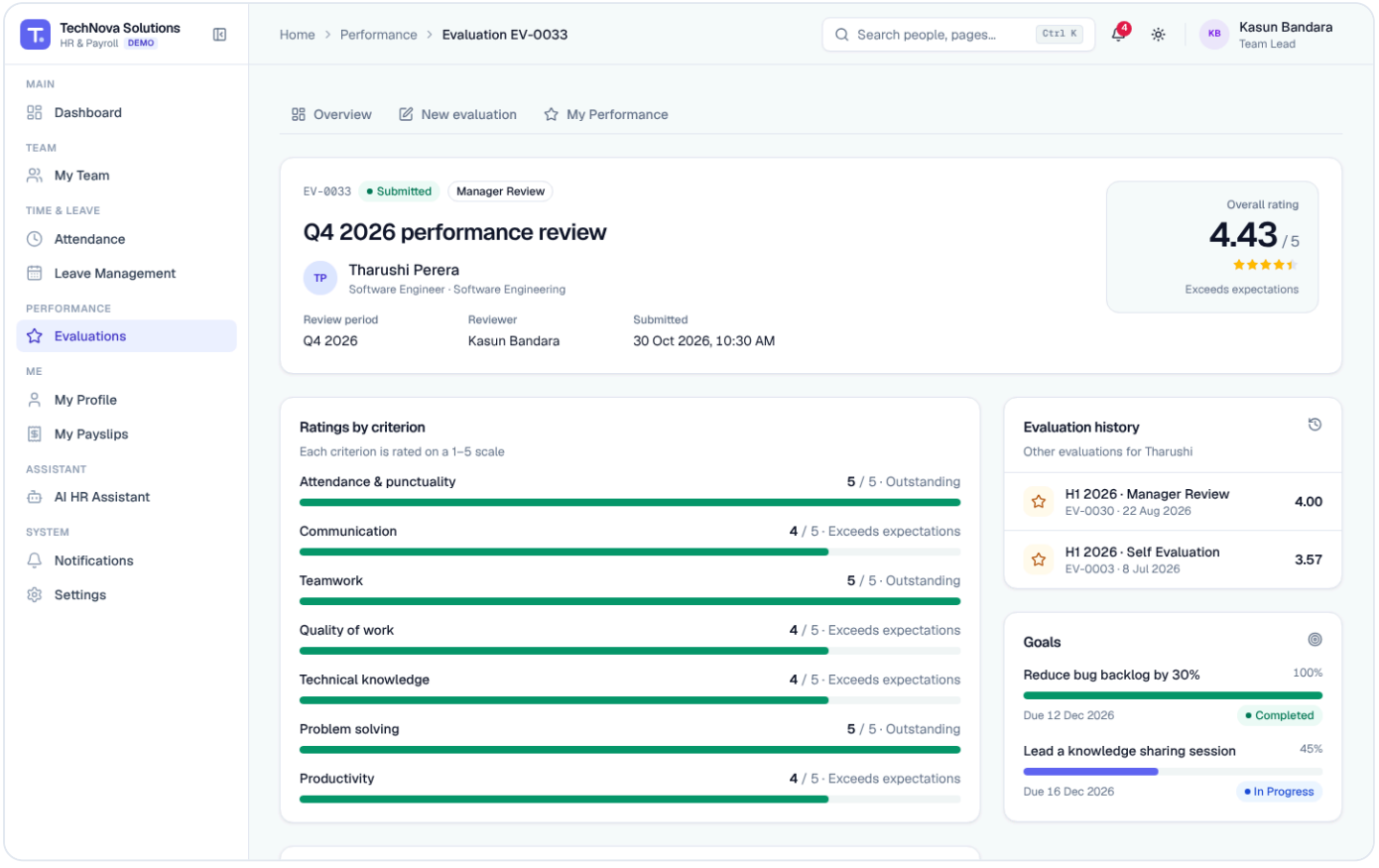
Steps:

1. Click **New evaluation** (or **Start review** next to someone in *Due for review*).
2. Choose the **Employee**, **Review type** and **Review period**.
3. Rate each criterion from 1 to 5: Attendance & punctuality, Communication, Teamwork, Quality of work, Technical knowledge, Problem solving and Productivity. The **Overall rating** updates live.
4. Write **Strengths**, **Areas for improvement** and **Comments**.
5. Click **Save draft** to finish later, or **Submit evaluation**.

Expected Result: The evaluation details page opens with the overall rating and per-criterion bars; the employee and HR are notified.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [06 — Performance management]

Notes: Submitting requires all seven ratings and at least one strength. Drafts can be edited or deleted from the details page.

Performance overview

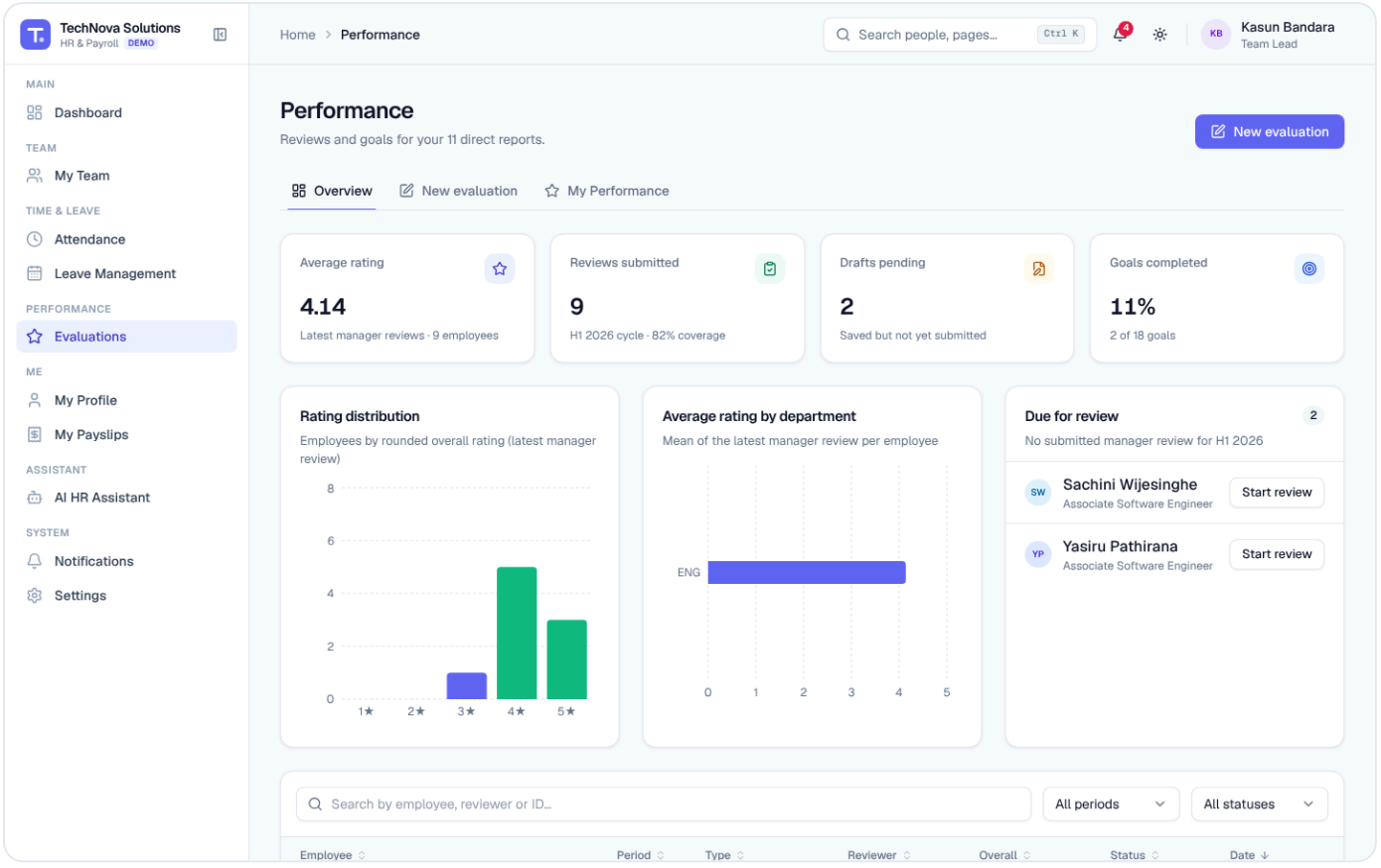
Purpose: Track review progress and ratings.

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager, Team Lead.

Navigation: Evaluations → Overview

Steps: Review average rating, reviews submitted, drafts and goal completion, the rating distribution and department averages, then search or filter the evaluations list.

Screenshot:



My performance and goals

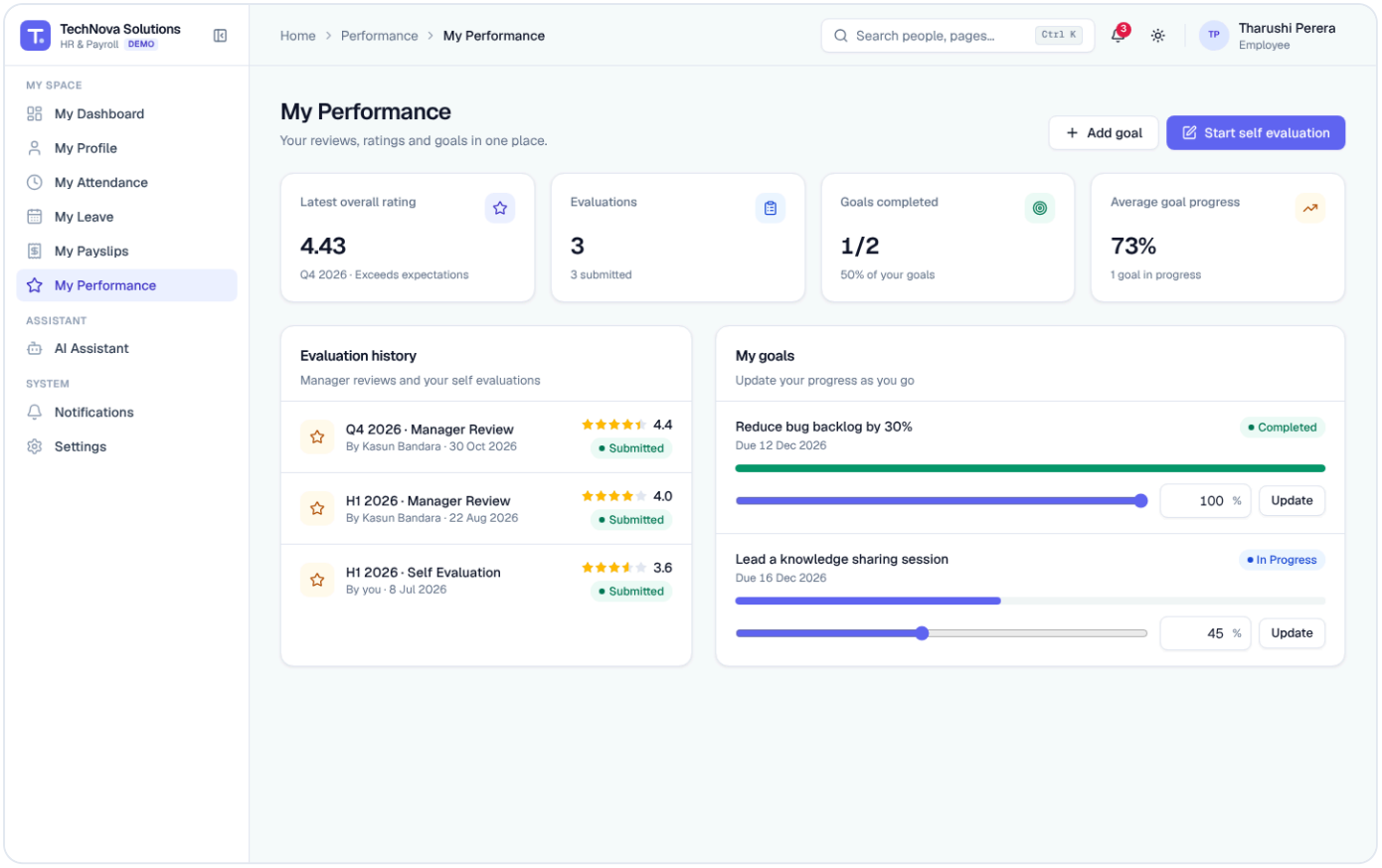
Purpose: See your reviews and track your goals.

Who can use it: Everyone.

Navigation: My Performance

Steps: Review your latest rating and history, update goal progress and click **Update**, click **Add goal** to create a goal, or **Start self evaluation**.

Screenshot:



13. Employee self-service

Employee dashboard

Purpose: Give employees everything they need without contacting HR.

Who can use it: Employee (and the "My ..." pages for every role).

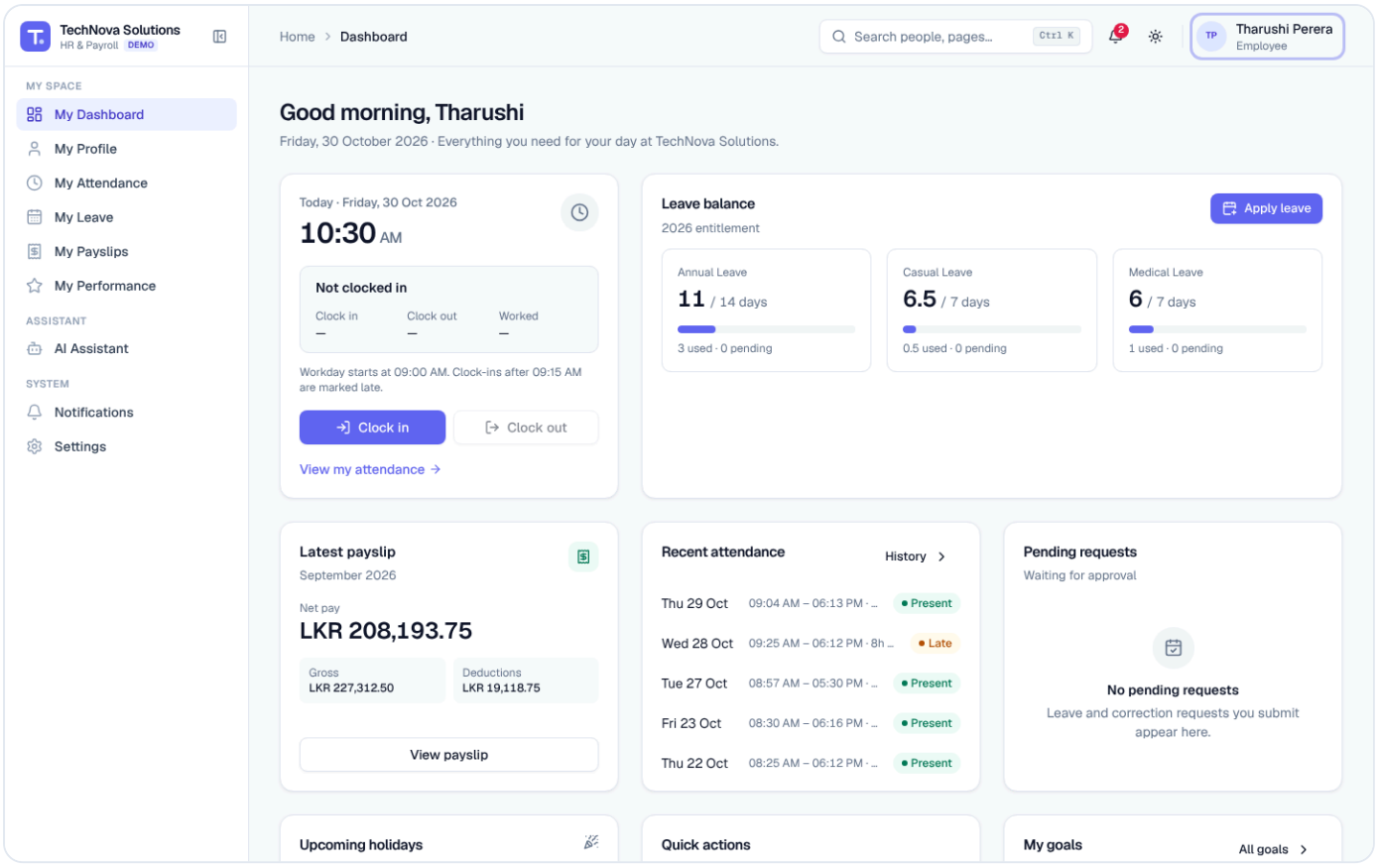
Navigation: Sidebar → My Dashboard

Steps:

1. Read the welcome greeting and today's date.
2. Use the clock card to **Clock in** / **Clock out**.
3. Check your **Leave balance** and click **Apply leave**.
4. Open your **Latest payslip**.
5. Review **Recent attendance**, **Pending requests**, **Upcoming holidays** and **My goals**.
6. Use **Quick actions** or the **AI HR Assistant** shortcuts.

Expected Result: Common tasks — attendance, leave, payslips, profile updates — can be completed directly.

Screenshot:



Video Walkthrough: 08 — Employee self-service

Updating your contact details

Purpose: Keep your phone, address, emergency contact and photo current.

Who can use it: Everyone.

Navigation: My Profile → Update contact details

Steps: Edit the fields, optionally upload a new photo, and click **Save details**.

Expected Result: Your profile updates immediately and HR sees the new details.

See the Employee Guide for a complete self-service walkthrough.

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14. AI HR Assistant

Asking questions

Purpose: Get instant answers from live HR records.

Who can use it: Everyone. Answers respect the current role's permissions.

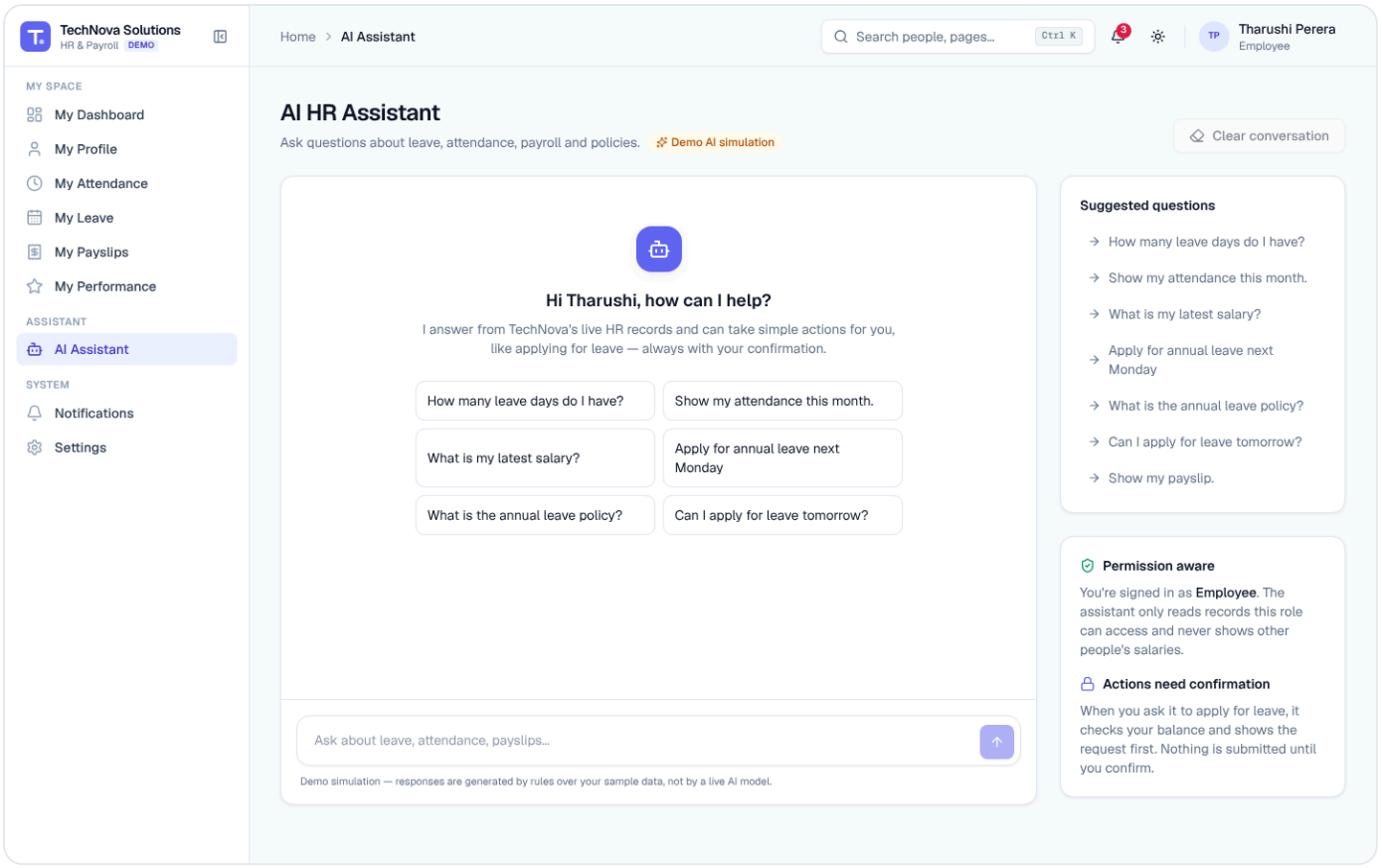
Navigation: Sidebar → AI HR Assistant / AI Assistant

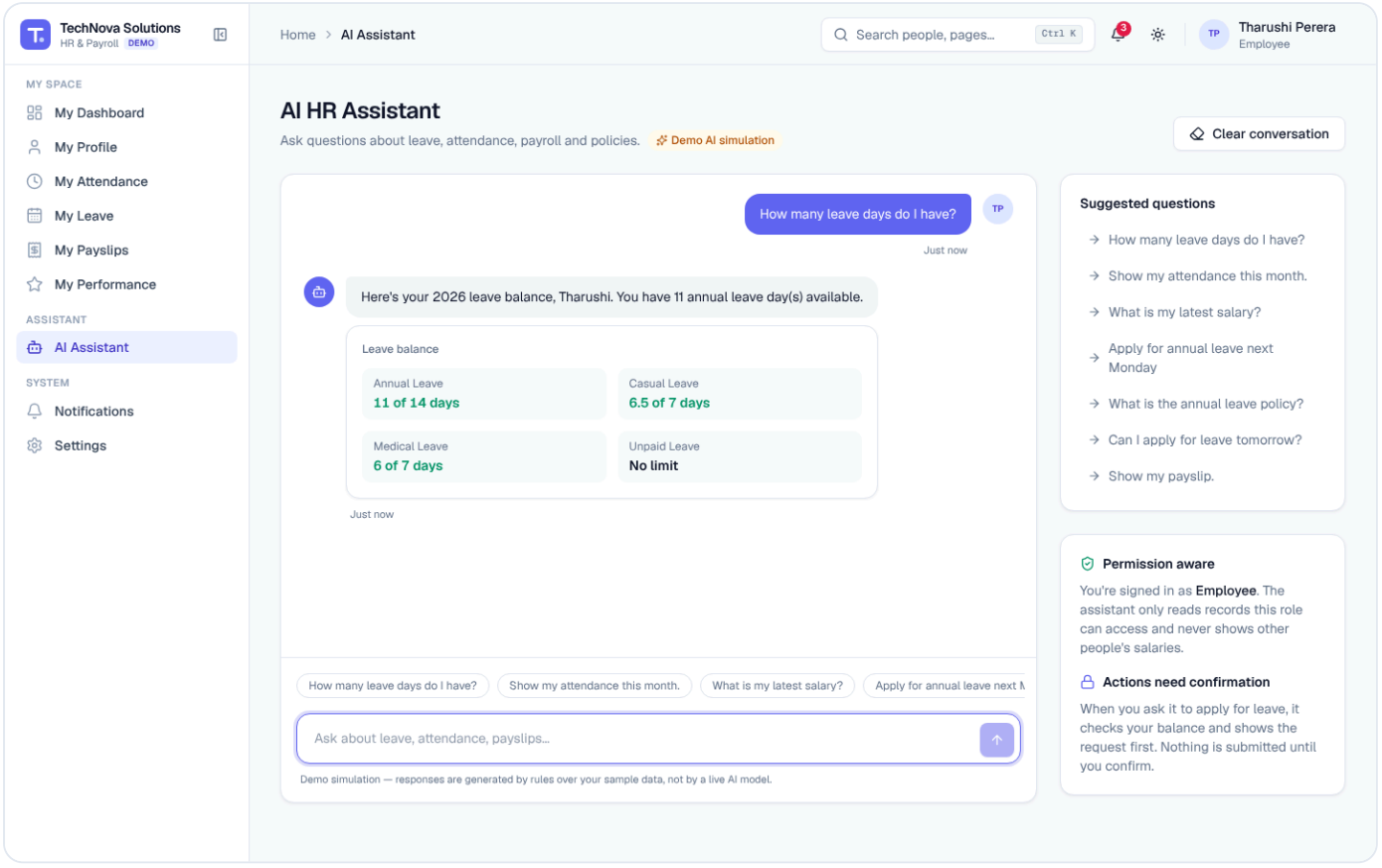
Steps:

1. Click a suggested question or type your own in **Ask about leave, attendance, payslips...** and press Enter.
2. Watch the typing indicator, then read the answer and its result card (figures, tables and links).
3. Click **Clear conversation** to start over.

Expected Result: Answers come from the same data as the rest of the app — e.g. "How many leave days do I have?" shows your real balances.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [07 — AI HR Assistant]

Example questions:

Role	Try asking
Employee	How many leave days do I have? · Show my attendance this month. · What is my latest salary? · Can I apply for leave tomorrow? · Show my payslip. · What is the annual leave policy?
HR Manager	How many employees are absent today? · Show pending leave requests. · Which employees joined this month? · Summarize employee attendance. · How many employees work in IT?
Payroll Manager	What is this month's total payroll? · Are there any payroll calculation warnings? · Show pending payroll records. · Summarize salary expenses.

Applying for leave through the assistant

Purpose: Let the assistant prepare and submit a leave request for you.

Who can use it: Everyone (for themselves).

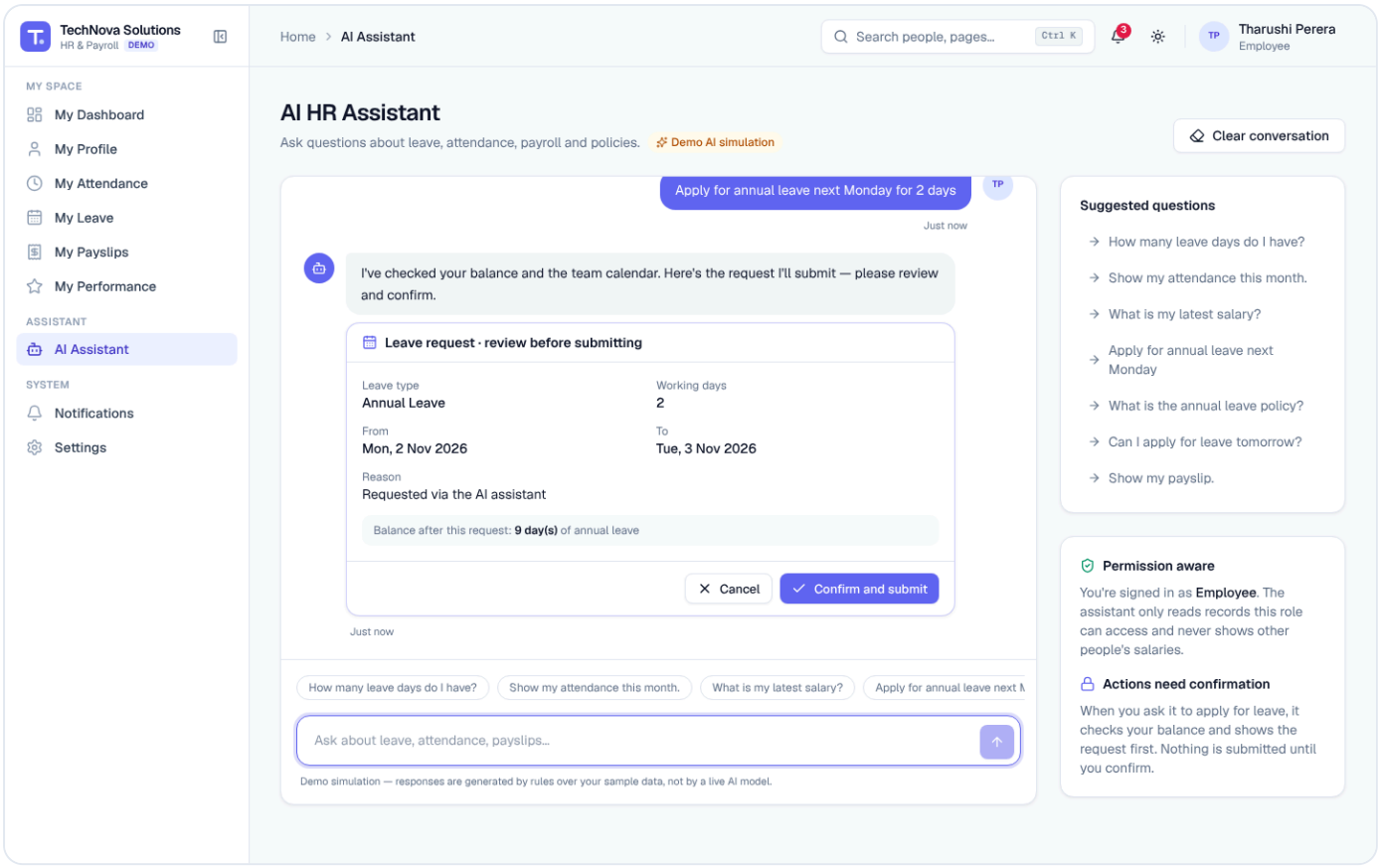
Navigation: AI Assistant

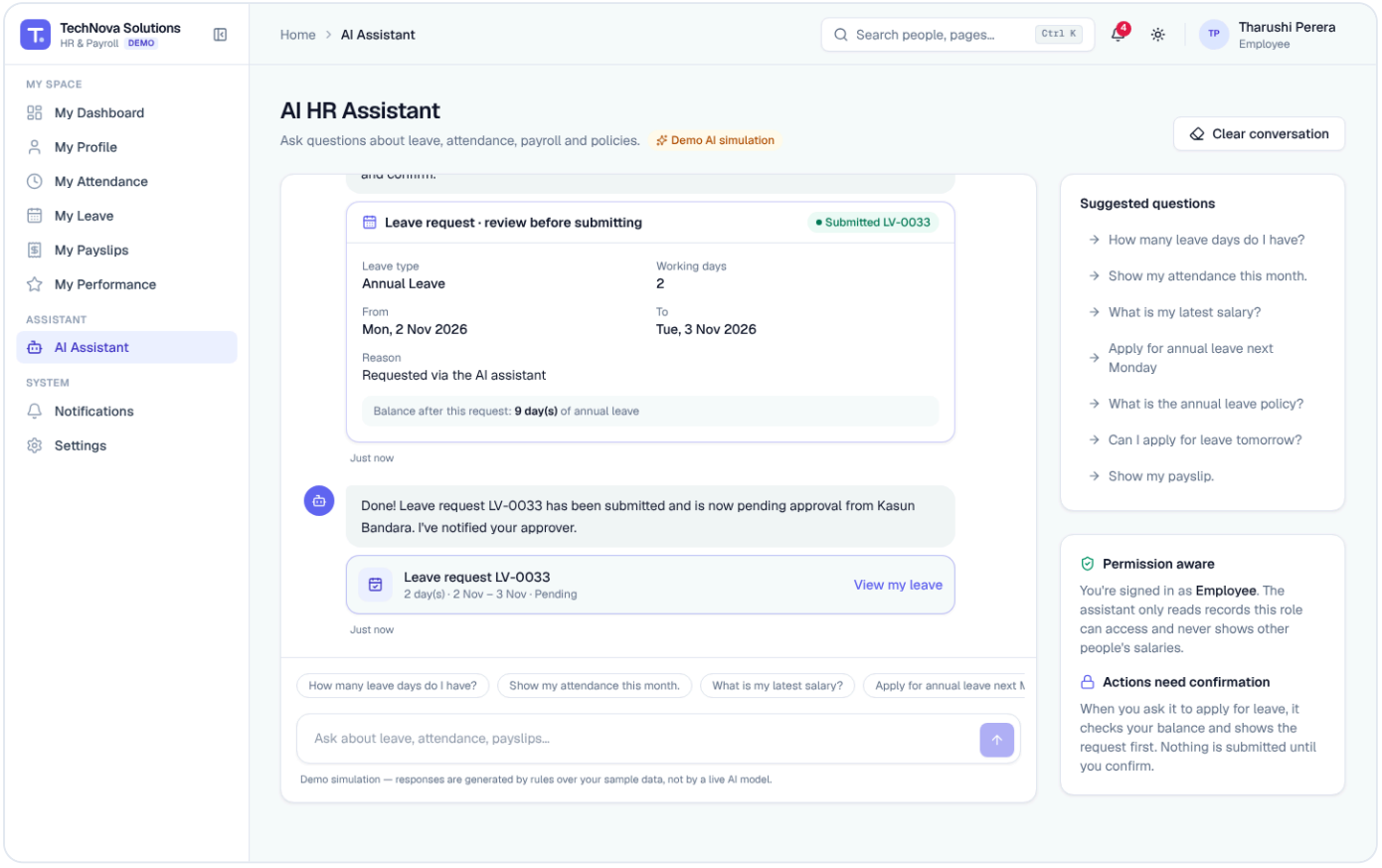
Steps:

1. Type a request such as **Apply for annual leave next Monday for 2 days** (you can also say "sick leave", "casual leave on 6 Nov", "from 3 Nov to 5 Nov").
2. The assistant identifies you, checks your balance and the rules, and shows a **Leave request · review before submitting** card with type, dates, working days, reason and balance after.
3. Click **Confirm and submit** (or **Cancel**).

Expected Result: A leave request (e.g. `LV-0033`) is created with **Pending** status and source "AI Assistant", your approver is notified, and the assistant links to **View my leave**.

Screenshot:





Video Walkthrough: [07 — AI HR Assistant]

Notes: This is a clearly labelled **demo simulation** built with deterministic rules — no external AI service is called and salary figures always come from the payroll engine. Questions outside your role's permissions are politely declined.

---

15. Reports

Running, filtering and exporting a report

Purpose: Analyse HR and payroll data and share it.

Who can use it: Admin (all reports), HR Manager (Employee, Attendance, Leave), Payroll Manager (Payroll).

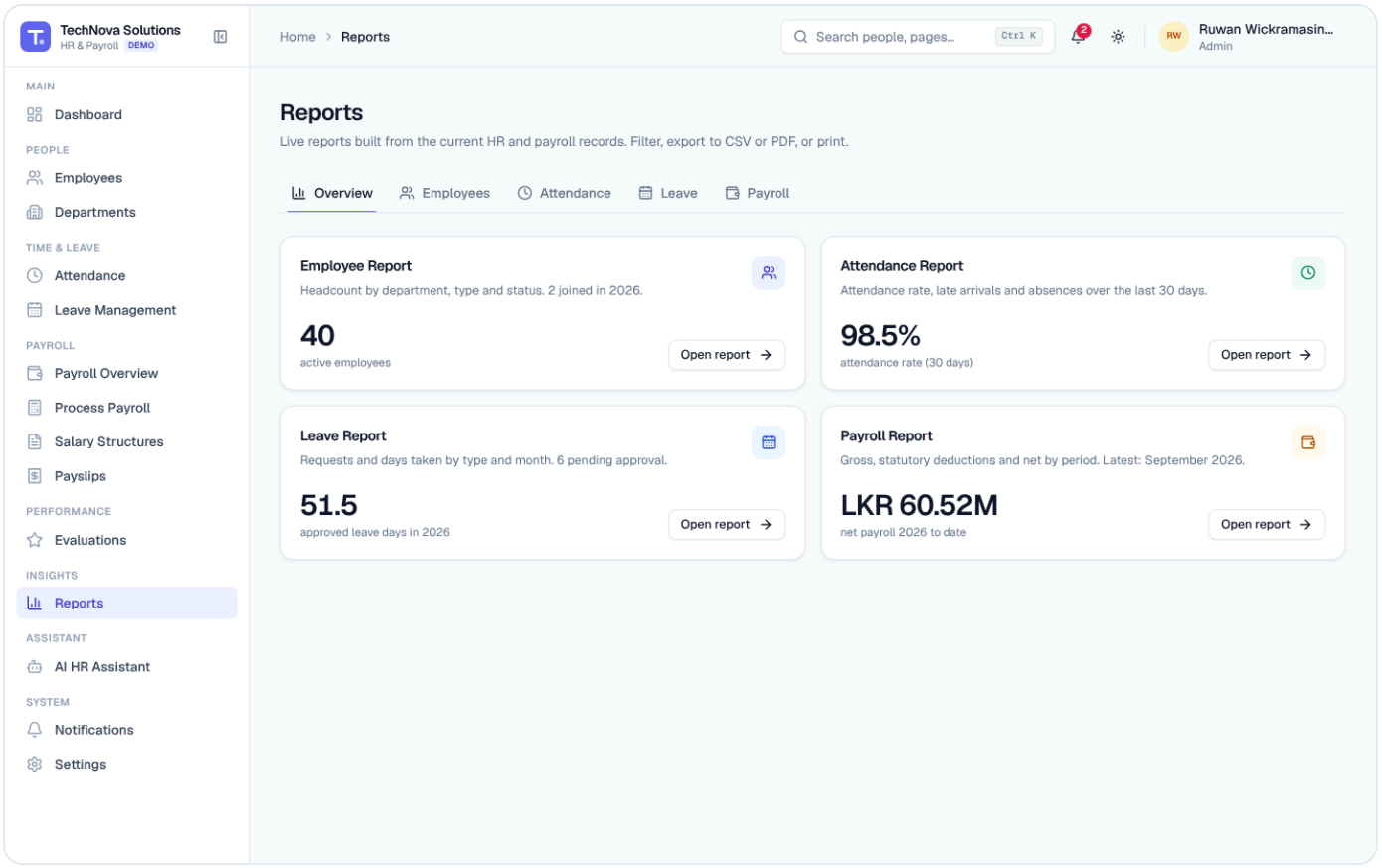
Navigation: Sidebar → Reports

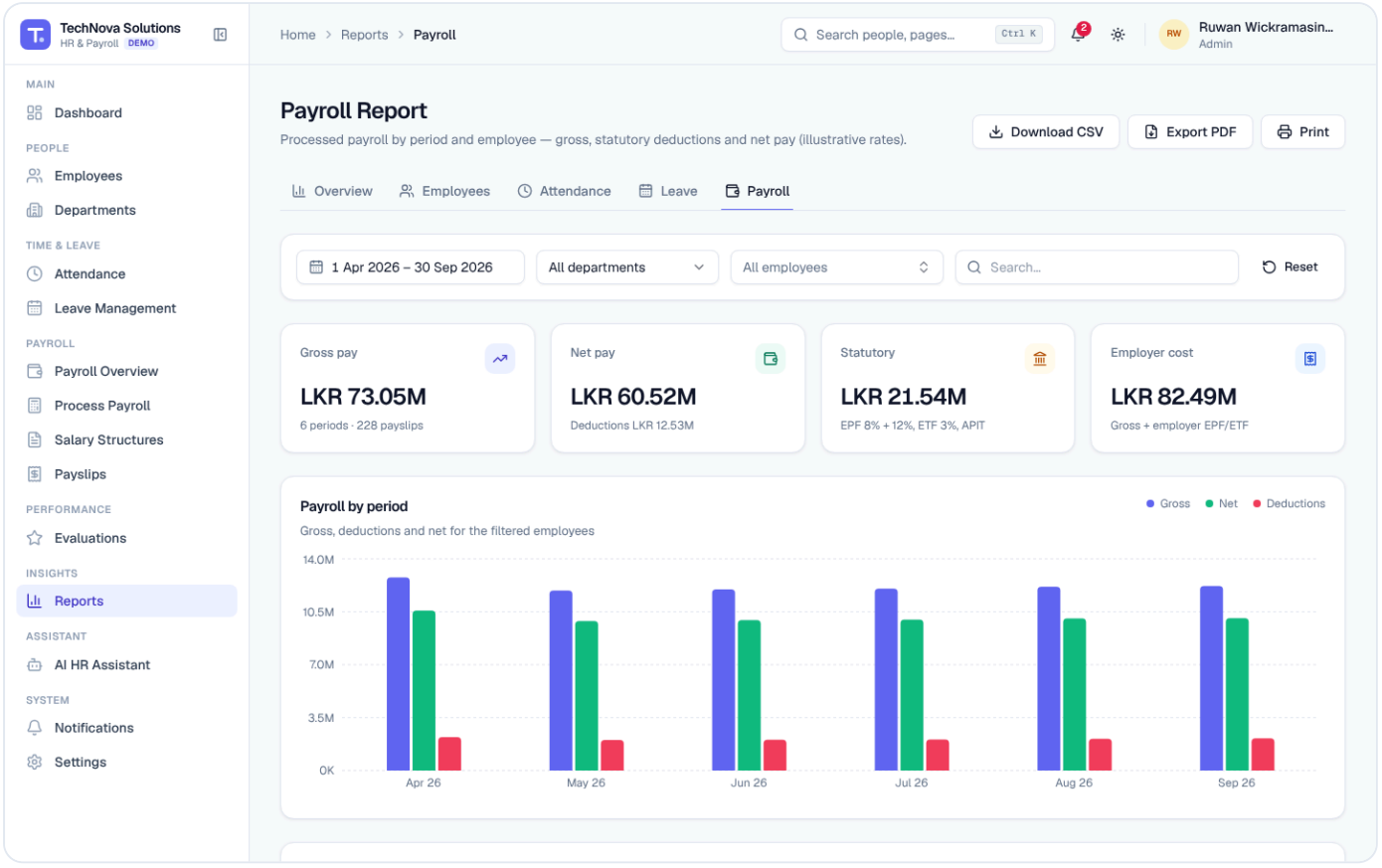
Steps:

1. On **Reports**, click **Open report** on Employee, Attendance, Leave or Payroll.
2. Filter by date range, **Department**, **Employee** and search text (plus report-specific filters such as leave status or type).
3. Review the KPI strip, chart and table.
4. Click **Download CSV**, **Export PDF** or **Print**.

Expected Result: Real files are downloaded (for example `payroll-report-2026-10-30.csv`). When no records match, an empty state explains why.

Screenshot:





Notes: All figures are calculated from the live demo data.

16. Notifications

Reading notifications

Purpose: Stay informed about requests, approvals and payroll.

Who can use it: Everyone.

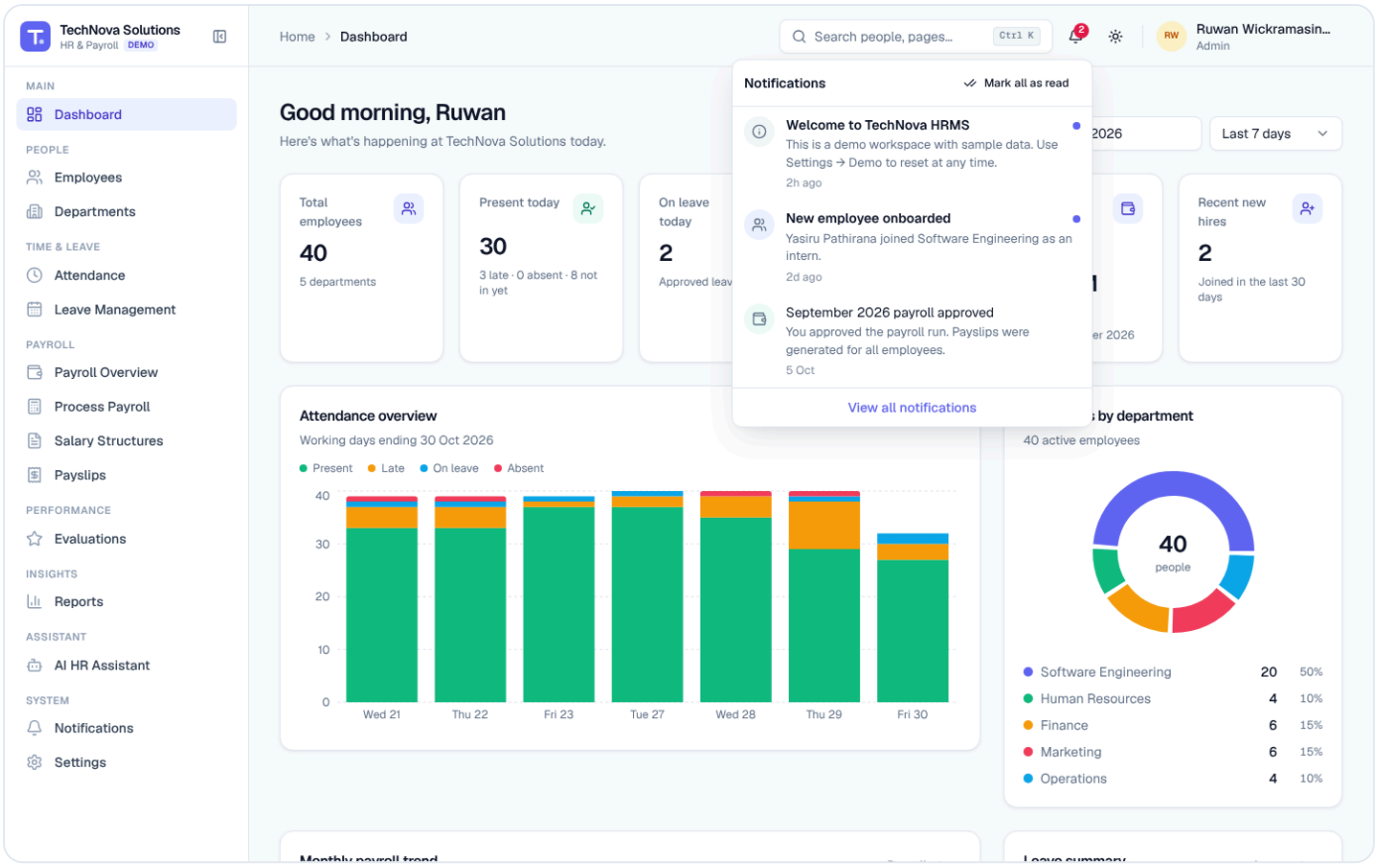
Navigation: Bell icon in the header → View all notifications

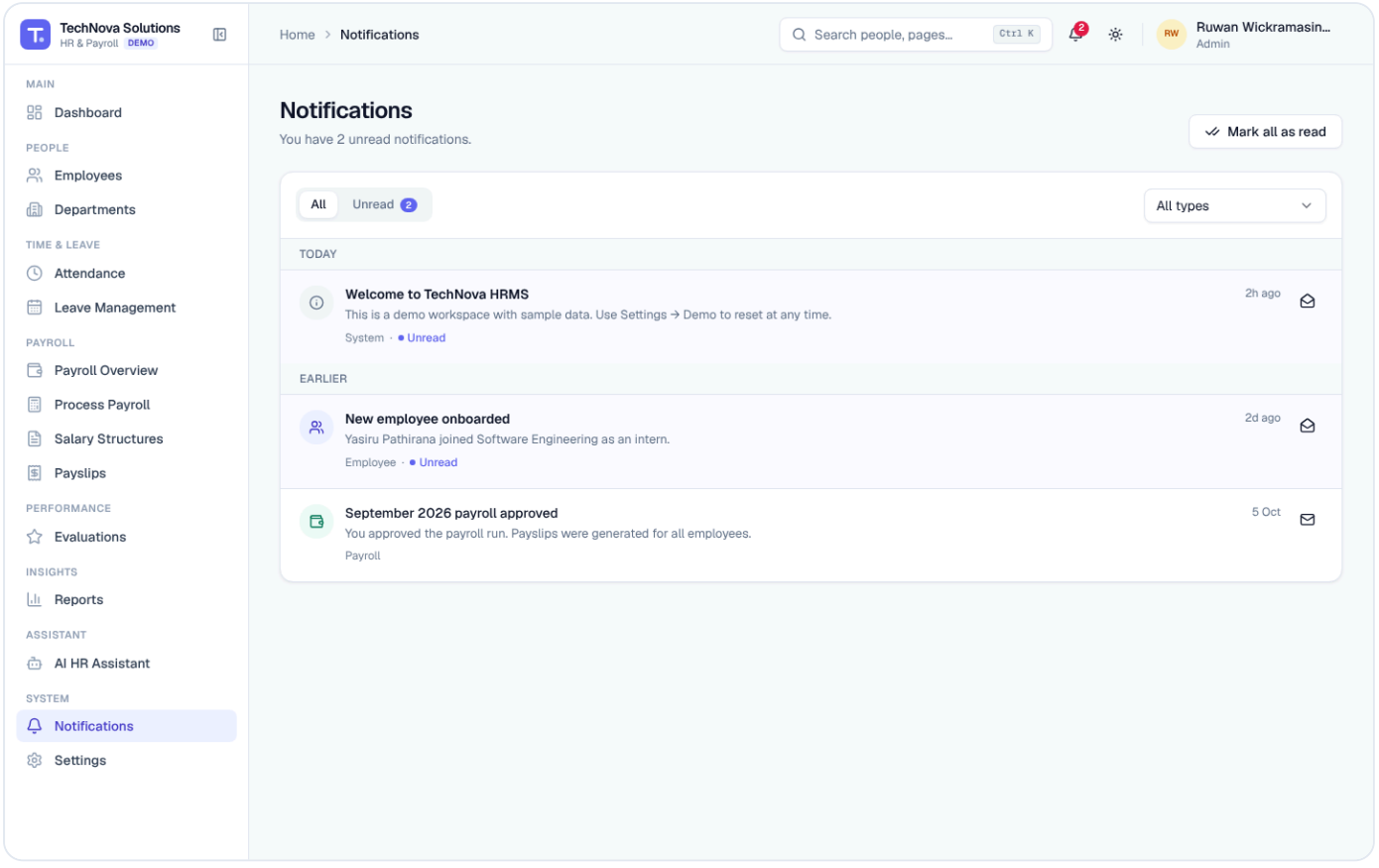
Steps:

1. The bell shows your unread count. Click it to see recent notifications; click one to open the related page (it is marked as read).
2. Click **Mark all as read** in the dropdown or on the Notifications page.
3. On the **Notifications** page, filter by **All / Unread** and by type, and mark individual items read or unread.

Expected Result: The unread badge updates immediately.

Screenshot:





Notes: Notifications are created by real actions — leave submitted/approved/rejected, payroll processed, payslip generated, attendance corrections and performance reviews. You can mute

types in **Settings → Preferences**.

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17. Settings

Organization settings

Purpose: Maintain company details and branding.

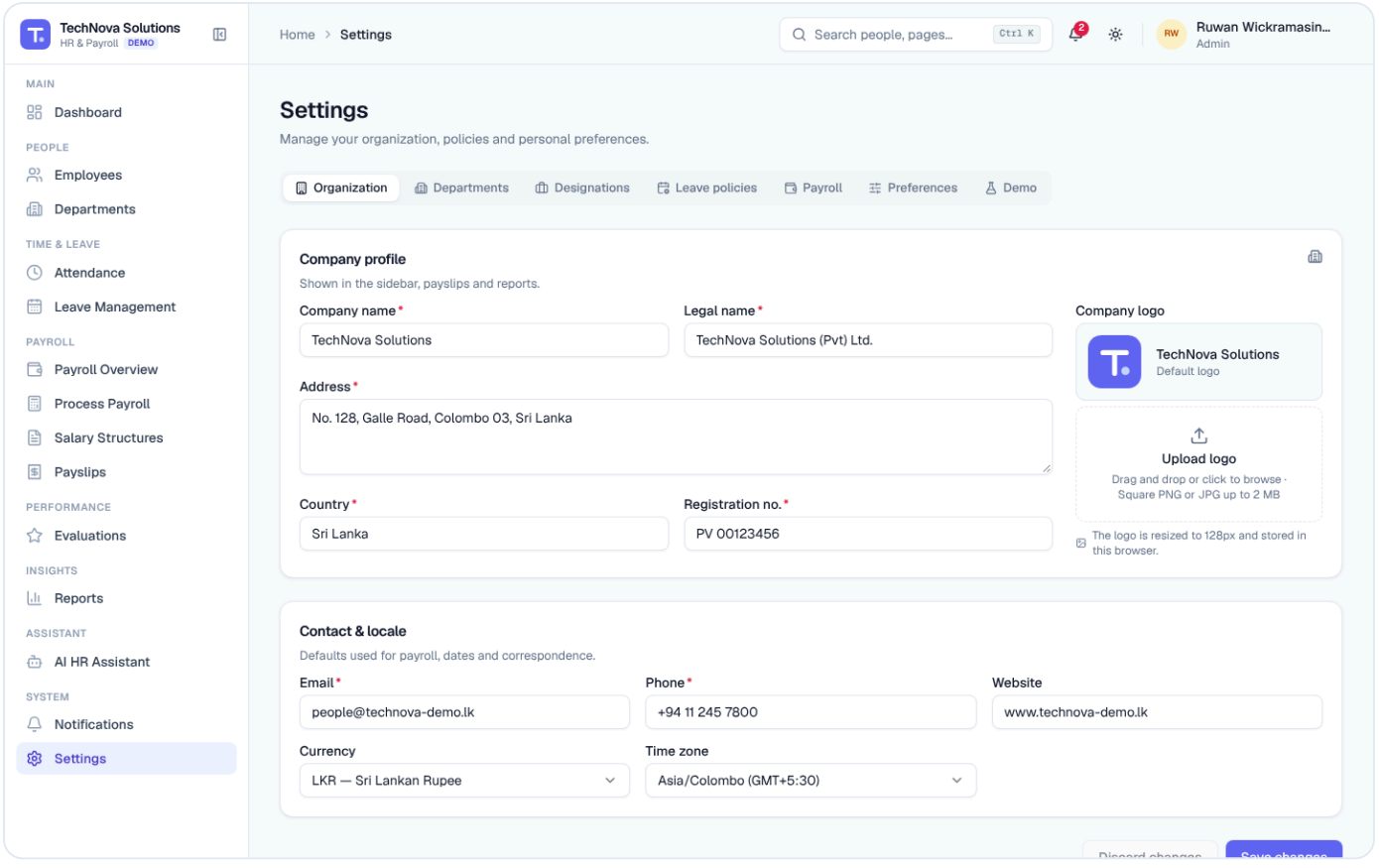
Who can use it: Admin.

Navigation: Settings → Organization

Steps: Edit company name, legal name, address, country, currency, time zone, contact details, registration number and website; upload a logo; click **Save changes**.

Expected Result: The sidebar brand and payslips use the new name and logo immediately.

Screenshot:



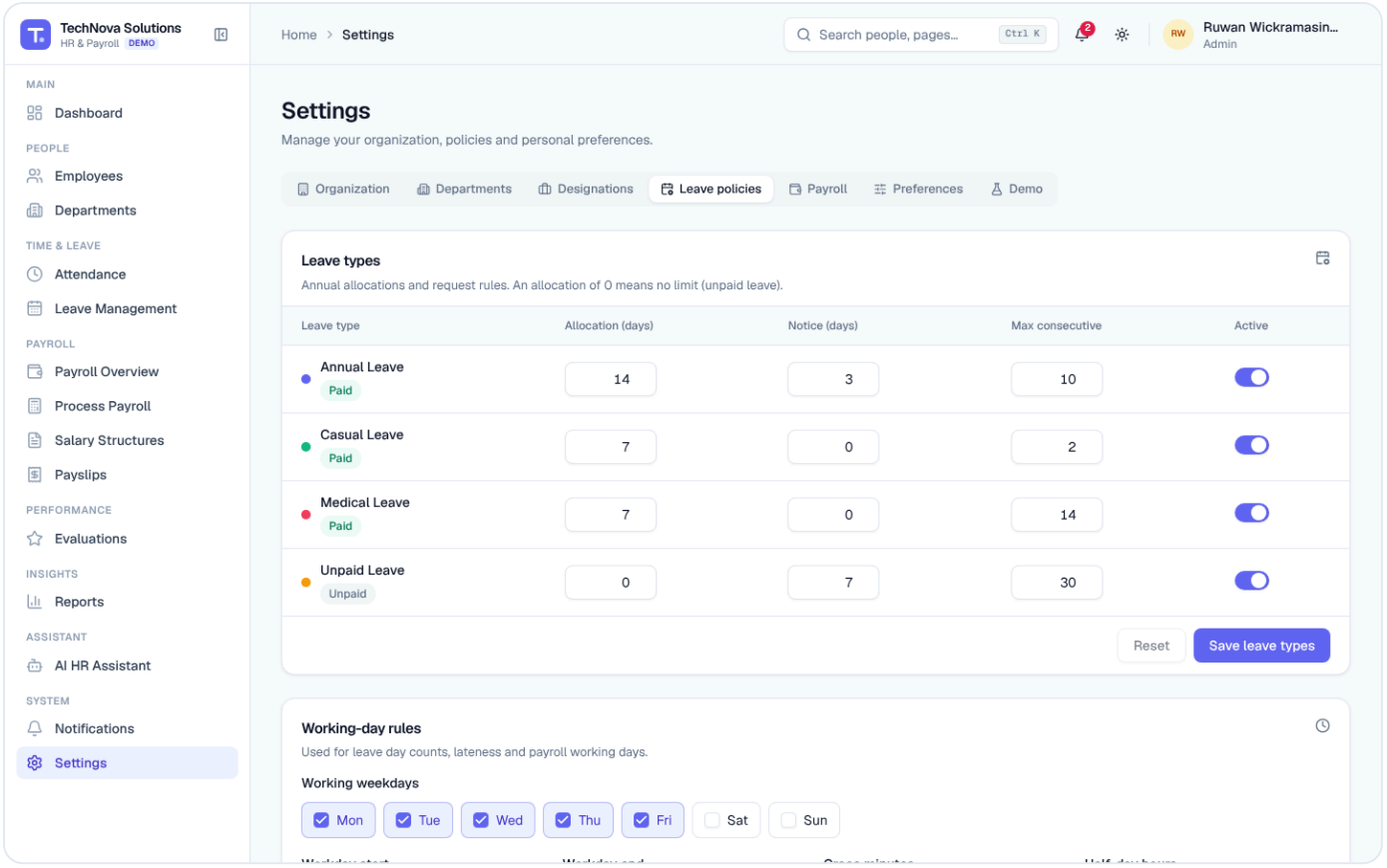
Leave policies and working-day rules

Who can use it: Admin, HR Manager.

Navigation: Settings → Leave policies

Steps: Edit allocation, notice days and maximum consecutive days per leave type and toggle types on or off (**Save leave types**); choose working weekdays, workday start/end, grace minutes and half-day hours (**Save working-day rules**).

Screenshot:



Preferences and demo management

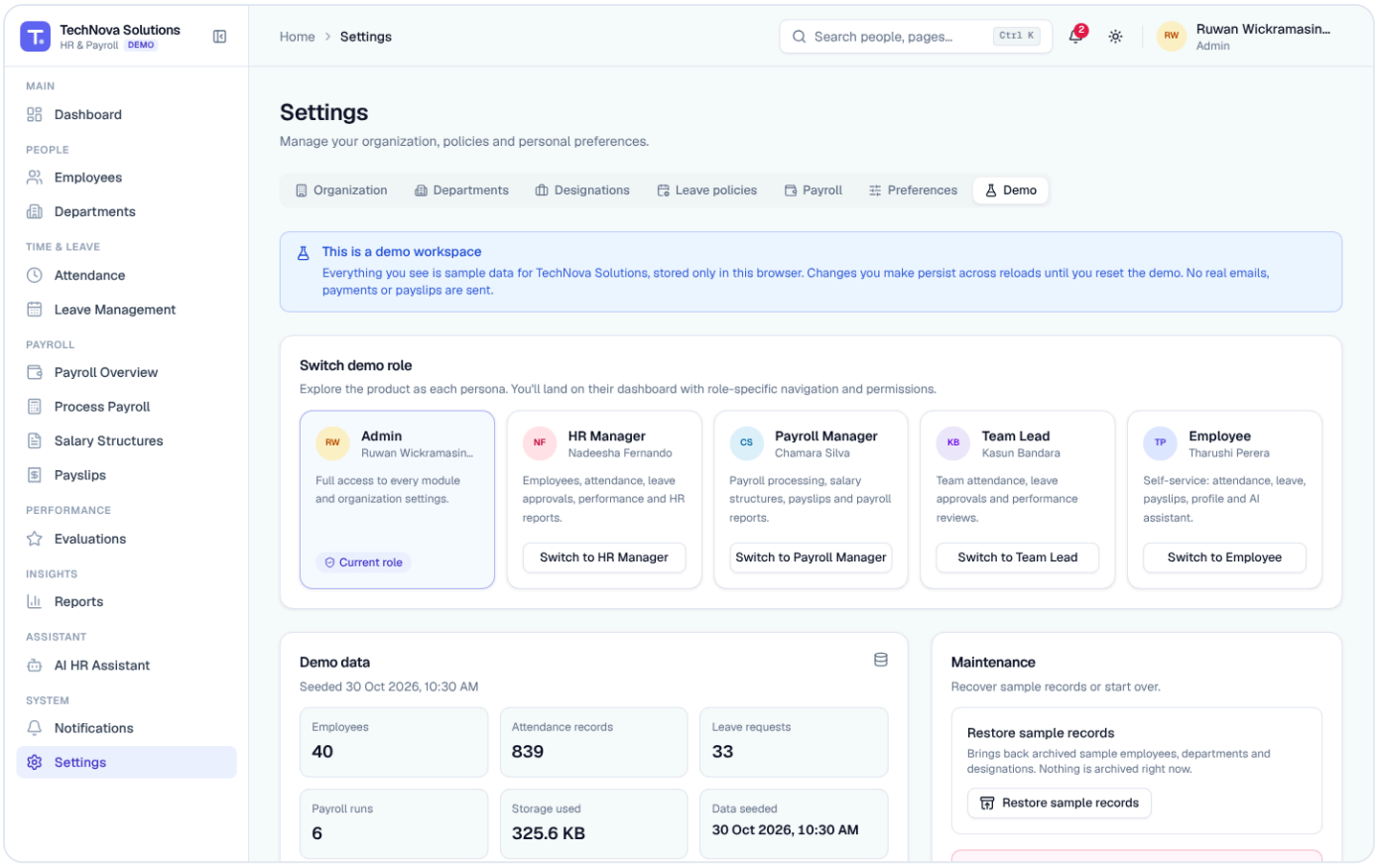
Who can use it: Everyone.

Navigation: Settings → Preferences / Demo

Steps:

1. **Preferences:** choose a theme and turn notification types on or off (changes save instantly).
2. **Demo:** switch to another demo role, **Reset demo data** (with confirmation) or **Restore sample records**, and review data statistics.

Screenshot:


TechNova Solutions
HR & Payroll
DEMO
MAIN
Dashboard
PEOPLE
Employees
Departments
TIME & LEAVE
Attendance
Leave Management
PAYROLL
Payroll Overview
Process Payroll
Salary Structures
Payslips
PERFORMANCE
Evaluations
INSIGHTS
Reports
ASSISTANT
AI HR Assistant
SYSTEM
Notifications
Settings
Home > Settings
Search people, pages... Ctrl K
Ruwan Wickramasin...
Admin
Settings
Manage your organization, policies and personal preferences.
Organization
Departments
Designations
Leave policies
Payroll
Preferences
Demo
This is a demo workspace
Everything you see is sample data for TechNova Solutions, stored only in this browser. Changes you make persist across reloads until you reset the demo. No real emails, payments or payslips are sent.
Switch demo role
Explore the product as each persona. You'll land on their dashboard with role-specific navigation and permissions.
Admin
Ruwan Wickramasin...
Full access to every module and organization settings.
Current role
HR Manager
Nadeesha Fernando
Employees, attendance, leave approvals, performance and HR reports.
Switch to HR Manager
Payroll Manager
Chamara Silva
Payroll processing, salary structures, payslips and payroll reports.
Switch to Payroll Manager
Team Lead
Kasun Bandara
Team attendance, leave approvals and performance reviews.
Switch to Team Lead
Employee
Tharushi Perera
Self-service: attendance, leave, payslips, profile and AI assistant.
Switch to Employee
Demo data
Seeded 30 Oct 2026, 10:30 AM
Employees
40
Attendance records
839
Leave requests
33
Payroll runs
6
Storage used
325.6 KB
Data seeded
30 Oct 2026, 10:30 AM
Maintenance
Recover sample records or start over.
Restore sample records
Brings back archived sample employees, departments and designations. Nothing is archived right now.
Restore sample records

18. Light and dark themes

Changing the theme

Purpose: Use the interface in light, dark or your system's theme.

Who can use it: Everyone.

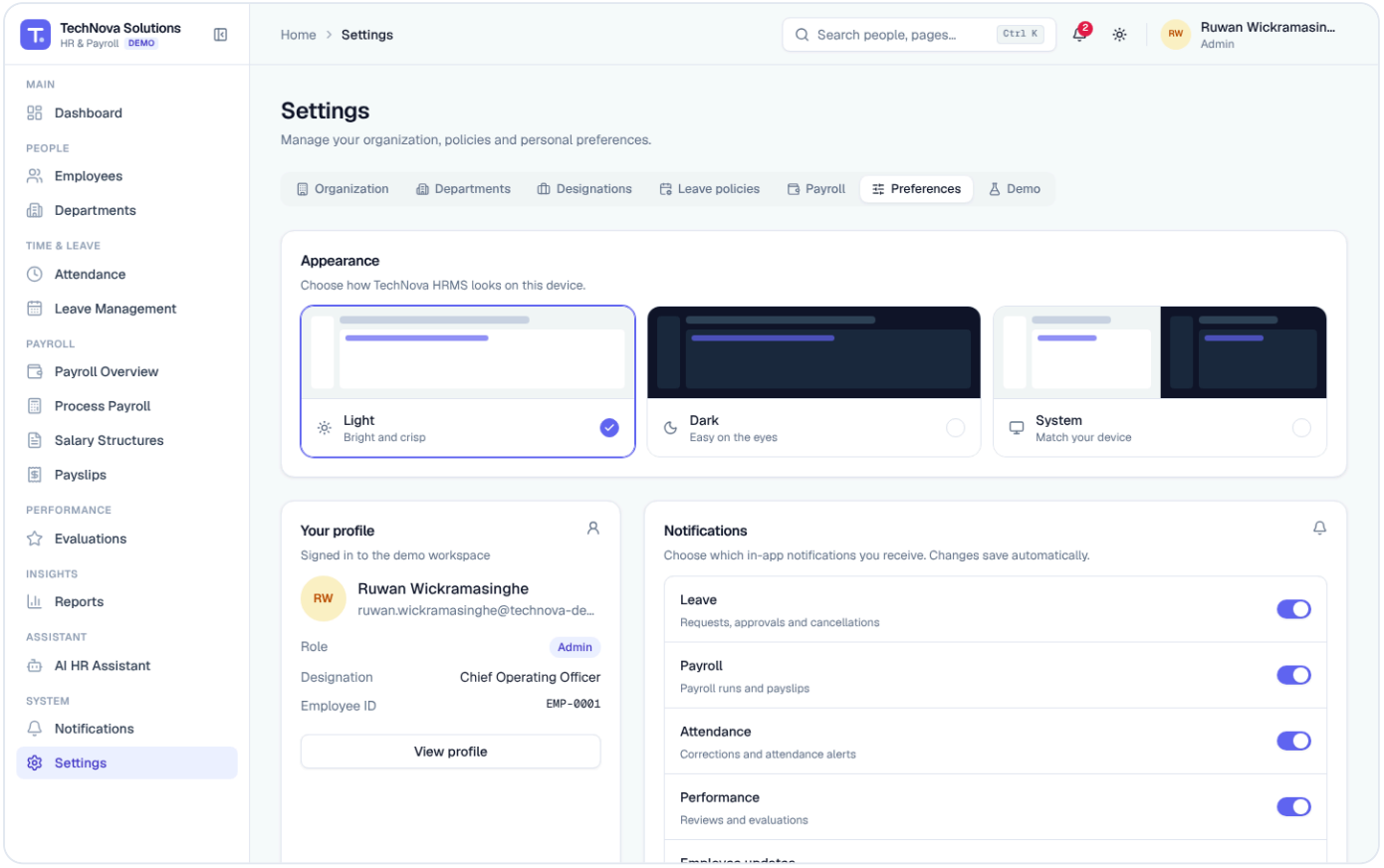
Navigation: Header sun/moon button, or Settings → Preferences

Steps:

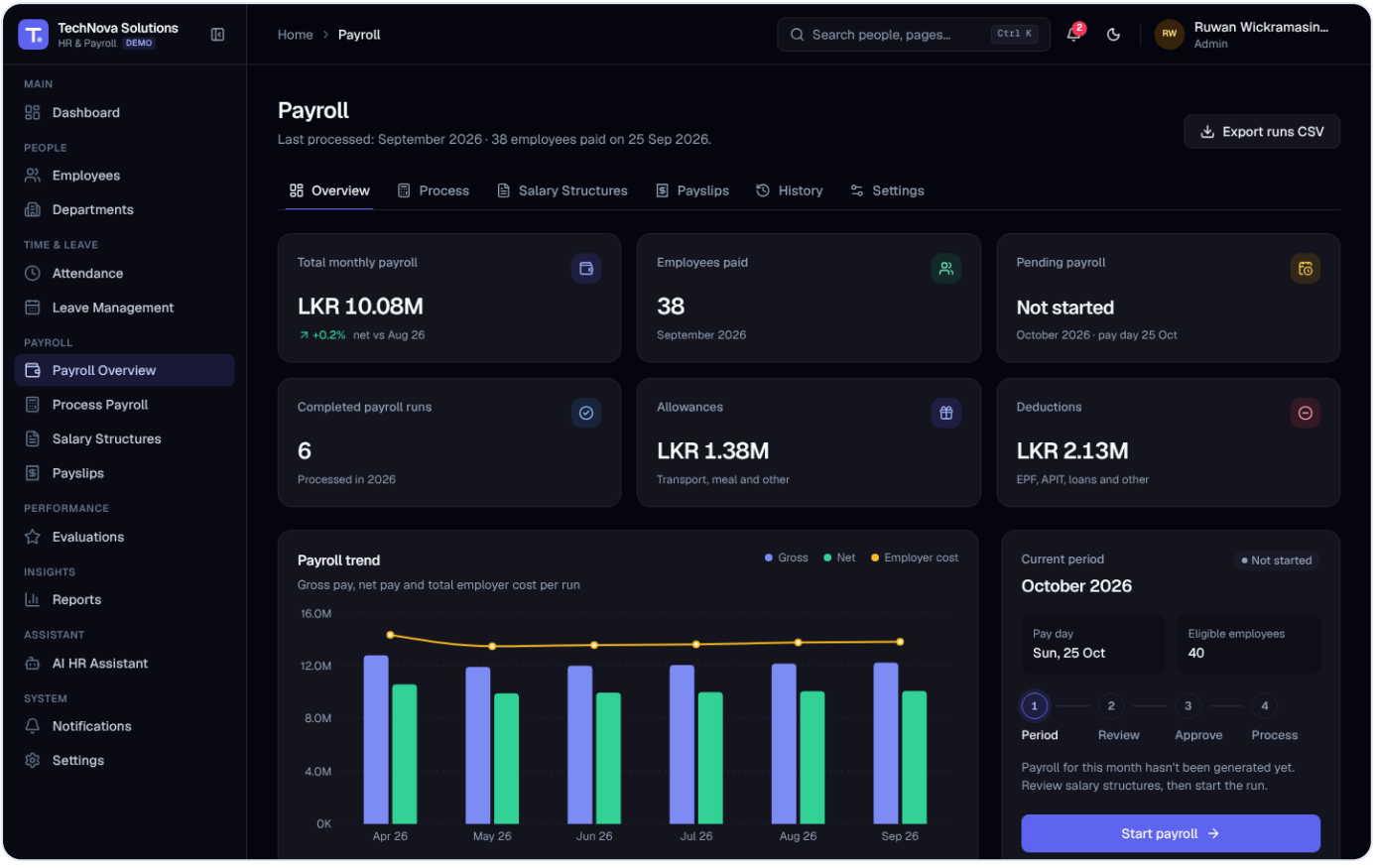
1. Click the theme button in the header.
2. Choose **Light**, **Dark** or **System**.

Expected Result: The whole interface — charts, dialogs, dropdowns, date pickers and notifications — switches instantly and the choice is remembered.

Screenshot:







Video Walkthrough: 01 — Application overview

19. Mobile usage

Using TechNova HR on a phone or tablet

Purpose: Complete common tasks on smaller screens.

Who can use it: Everyone.

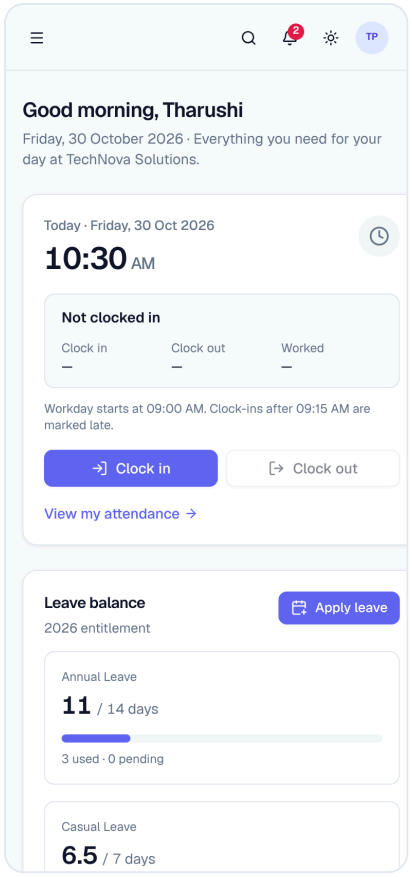
Navigation: Same as desktop.

Steps:

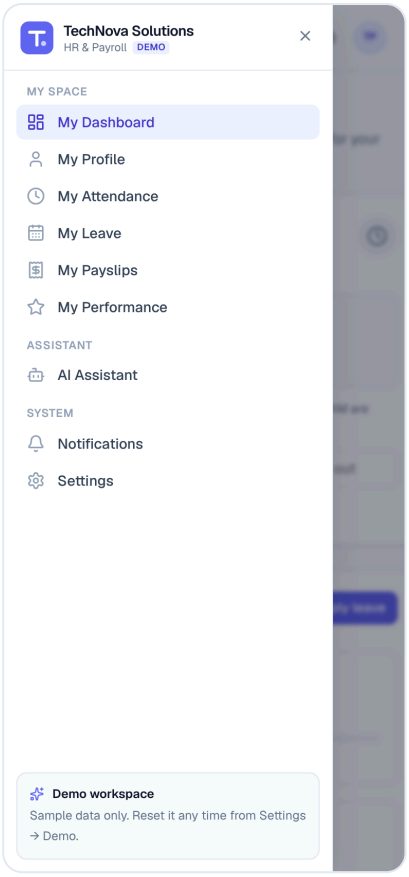
1. On phones, tap the **menu** button (☰) in the top-left to open the navigation drawer; tap a page to go there.
2. Dashboards stack into a single column; forms become single-column; tables scroll horizontally inside their card and hide secondary columns.
3. Dialogs open as bottom sheets with large touch targets.
4. On tablets the sidebar becomes a compact icon rail.

Screenshot:

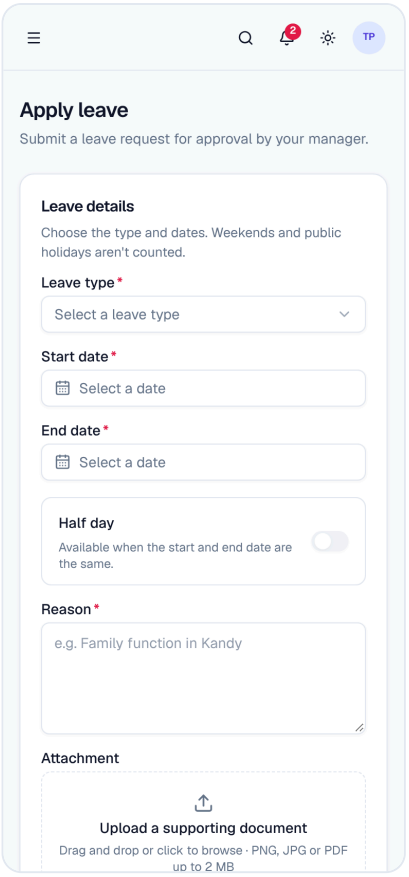
Phone dashboard

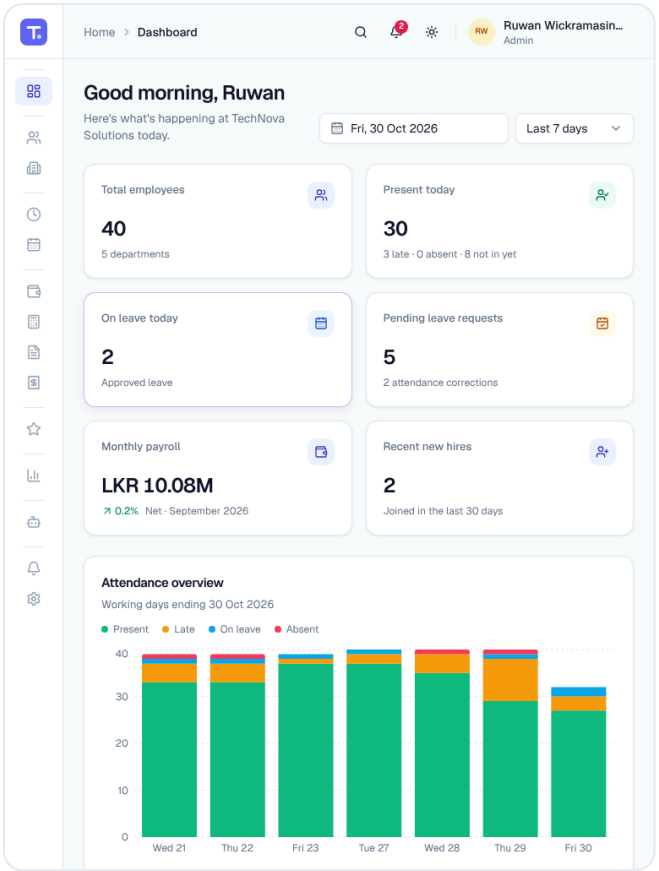


Navigation drawer



Apply leave





Notes: No page scrolls sideways on a 390 px wide phone — this is checked automatically by the Playwright test suite.

---

20. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Dashboard numbers show zero people present	The sample data is dated to the day it was generated. Go to **Settings → Demo → Reset demo data**.
"Those credentials don't match a demo account"	Click a demo account card, or use password `demo1234` with a demo email.
A page says you don't have access	Your current role can't open that module. Switch role from the profile menu.
Clock in is disabled	It's a weekend, a public holiday, you're on approved leave, or you've already clocked in today.
Leave request can't be submitted	Read the message in the Summary panel: insufficient balance, overlapping request, no working days in the range, or too many consecutive days.
Payroll can't be processed	Runs must go through Generate → Submit for approval → Approve → Process. A month that is already processed can't be processed again.
I want a clean slate	**Settings → Demo → Reset demo data**, or clear the site's browser storage.
Changes disappeared	Data is stored in this browser only; a different browser or private window starts with fresh sample data.
Playwright can't find a browser	Run `npx playwright install chromium`.
Port 3000 is in use	Stop the other process, or run `npx next dev -p 3001` (tests expect port 3000).